

TUESDAY, AUGUST 18, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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GS-II
BY DR. SATVIK BHAN
Starting from
23rd
August, 2026
9540886666
B-20, 2nd Floor, ORN, New Delhi

Happening today

- **KERALA'S VIZHINJAM** International Seaport will begin full-scale export-import operations, a major milestone in maritime and economic development.
- **INDIA-THAILAND** Joint Military Exercise begins in Thailand, with focus on operations in jungle and semi-urban terrain.

EXPRESS special

March to July, Govt sent one blocking order to social media firms every minute

Over half sent to Instagram which was key protest platform; Oct 2024-25, daily takedown average was six, shows Sahyog

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 17

● Blocking orders

From March–July 2026

Instagram	-1,00,000
Facebook	-80,000
YouTube	-15,000
TOTAL	-1,95,000

SOURCE: INTERNAL GOVT DATA; NOTE: EACH BLOCKING ORDER MAY COVER MULTIPLE PIECES OF CONTENT OR ACCOUNTS

Jantar Mantar, which began in early June and was called off on
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BRINGS TOGETHER ORGANISATIONAL EXPERIENCE, ENERGY, GRASSROOTS CONNECT: PM

BJP rejig: Goyal treasurer, Smriti, Ram Madhav back

KEY INCLUSIONS AND EXCLUSIONS

IN

RAM MADHAV, 61: National vice president. An author, RSS ideologue, he was

BJP national general secretary from 2014 to 2020 and played crucial role in formation of BJP-PDP government in J&K

SMRITI IRANI, 50: National general secretary. She's a former Lok Sabha MP & Union Minister

BHARTI PAWAR, 47: One of the six women national vice-presidents appointed. She's a former Union Minister and a tribal leader from Maharashtra

MANPREET SINGH BADAL, 64: National vice president. Seen as one of BJP's leading

faces for the coming Assembly elections in Punjab

VISHNU DATT SHARMA, 55:

All Cells Coordinator. Former BJP state chief of MP, considered a rival to incumbent CM Mohan Yadav in state unit

SWADESH SINGH, 46: National secretary. An emerging face who has been inducted in the team from the Yuva Morcha; considered close to party chief Nitin Nabin

HEMANG JOSHI, 35: Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha president. A young face from Gujarat, he is considered to enjoy confidence of party's top brass

OUT

AMIT MALVIYA He was chief of the BJP's National IT Department, co-incharge for West Bengal and member of the National Executive

TEJASVI SURYA, 36: He was chief of the BJYM. A second-time Lok Sabha MP from Bangalore South, his exit is being interpreted as the party hitting the refresh button on its youth wing



Protesters celebrate in Ranchi, Monday; they said the agitation would continue until their demand for a CBI probe was fulfilled. PTI

Amid protests, Soren cancels key exam, scraps all tests held by outsourced agency

Rahul writes to CM, urges him to meet protesters

Shubham Tigga & Manoj CG
Ranchi, New Delhi, August 17

JHARKHAND CHIEF Minister Hemant Soren on Monday said the state Cabinet has decided to cancel the result for the JSSC-CGL examination, and all exams conducted by testing agency TDPL, in a bid to end a deadlock that has embroiled his government for weeks now. He also ordered a probe into examinations conducted by the state government since 2014.

Soren said ongoing investigations had revealed "shocking" facts and suggested a larger network involving com-

panies linked to the examinations. Earlier in the day, alliance partner Congress had urged Soren to engage with protesting students.

The protesters, however, said they would continue their agitation as long as their demand for a CBI probe into all exams in question remains unfulfilled.

The Soren government's latest decision was, meanwhile, met with resistance from another quarter: those who had qualified for the now-cancelled exam. A group of candidates who had secured government jobs gathered outside Project Bhavan, arguing that they should not be made to suffer for alleged irregularities for which they were not responsible. The administration deployed security personnel as the candidates
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Party bid to hit Refresh in the wake of protests, run-up to key state polls

Vikas Pathak & Liz Mathew
New Delhi, August 17

THE BJP'S organisational overhaul signals the return of leaders who had been sidelined, replaces the social media in-charge, and brings in a new youth wing president — all changes that are being viewed within the party as a much-needed refresh after the recent CJP protests and be-

fore crucial state elections. As expected, the party has inducted several leaders from UP and Punjab ahead of polls in the two states.

Among the key changes, the inclusion of Smriti Irani as general secretary is being seen by party insiders as not just a rehabilitation but also a move to add teeth to the party's campaign ahead of the
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



NATION

PAGE 9

TWISHA DEATH: AIIMS DELHI FINDS 'NO INJURY SUGGESTIVE OF ASSAULT'

A third of names could be deleted in Delhi's draft SIR roll of electors

Devansh Mittal

New Delhi, August 17

EVERY THIRD name could be stuck off in the draft electoral roll for Delhi that will be published next week, official data suggest.

At 8 pm on Monday, the last day of the 'enumeration' phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in

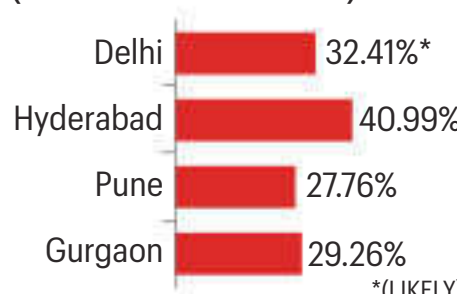


Ayush stuns top seed

Ayush Shetty after defeating top seed and defending champion Shi Yuqi of China 21-14, 13-21, 21-19 in the first round of the Badminton World Championships in New Delhi, Monday. PTI

REPORT, PAGE 20

● DELETED IN CITIES (in the draft electoral roll)



THE CITY

PAGE 4

BEHIND DELETIONS: DUPLICATION, RELOCATION

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● MEN IDENTIFIED AS HEALTH SCHEME BENEFICIARIES WERE RETIRED GOVT EMPLOYEES

I-Day tableau to showcase knee surgery success in Punjab on a shaky footing

Kanchan Vasdev & Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, August 17

THE PUNJAB government is claiming it was operating on, so to speak, a kneed-to-know basis. As per the Opposition, that claim has no legs.

On Saturday, a tableau by the state Health Department at the Independence Day parade in Ferozepur, attended by Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, featured five men dancing the bhangra and ident-

ified by the announcer as "beneficiaries who had undergone knee-replacement surgeries under the Mukhmantri Sehat Bima Yojana".

Only, the five are retired Health Department employees, who were dancing on sturdy knees very much their own.

As the facts trickled out, Ferozepur Civil Surgeon Dr Meenakshi Dhingra said they did nothing wrong. The participants, she said, were "part of a symbolic
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Five people, identified by the announcer as 'beneficiaries' of the scheme, dance at the I-Day parade in Ferozepur. EXPRESS

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Taking stock

Odisha CM Mohan Charan Majhi inspects the flood-affected areas of Kasapa and Tarapada panchayats in Jajpur. IMD forecast said more than 2.37 lakh people have been evacuated to safety and sheltered in nearly 300 relief camps on river embankments. PTI

'No teachers, poor food': After boys, 200 girls block busy road in Lucknow

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 17

AROUND 200 schoolgirls blocked the Lucknow-Dubbagal Bypass in the pouring rain on Monday, some sitting in front of vehicles and others holding hands to form a human chain.

The students of Jai Prakash Narayan Sarvodaya Vidyalaya for Girls were protesting over a shortage of teachers, poor-quality food and other grievances, and demanded that senior officials come to the spot.

The protest, which lasted nearly two hours, brought traffic on the busy stretch to a standstill. It came three days after more than 100 boys from the school's boys' campus staged a protest over similar grievances.

A police team reached the spot and tried to persuade the students to clear the road. Most left, but around 50 refused to budge. Senior officials from the Welfare Department and the district administration later arrived and spoke to the students. They subsequently took the students back to the school, where they heard their grievances and sought to address the issues they had raised.

Speaking to the media, he

cial Welfare Officer Sanjiv Singh said, "... We spoke to them, and they raised issues regarding the school's internal management — specifically, they complained about the warden's behaviour and demanded her removal; sought permission to use mobile phones; and asked for a change in class timings... We have reasoned with them and will sit down at the school to consider their demands and take appropriate action..."

On August 14, the boys had blocked Mohan Road during the protest. Uttar Pradesh Welfare Department Minister Asim Arun, who was travelling through the area, found his vehicle caught in the traffic jam caused by the protest. He intervened and spoke to the students.

The boys and girls sections of Jai Prakash Narayan Sarvodaya Vidyalaya operate from separate campuses and buildings. The school is run by the UP Welfare Department. Monday's protest sparked criticism from the Opposition.

on X: "After Gen Z, now Gen Alpha is also on the streets — this is clear proof of how much the BJP has ruined the education system."

CLARIFICATION

● In the Ric

archaeologist Pallavee Gokhale's full quote is as following, "Today, with artificial intelligence, machine learning and data science at the forefront, many believe these technologies can finally help solve the problem. However, the real test lies in truly integrating the archaeological context and explaining the same, interpreting the signs."



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EXPRESSspecial

Zero tolerance to violence against minors in custody — directive to cops amid concerns

Several incidents and allegations were raised before the Juvenile Justice Board

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 17

THERE IS zero tolerance to any form of custodial violence — mental or physical — against minors involved in any criminal incidents and they can't be questioned at unauthorised locations where CCTV surveillance can be avoided. These instructions are part of a recent city-wide directive to district officers issued by the Delhi Police's Special Police Unit for Women and Children (SPUWAC) amid allegations of ill-treatment of juvenile offenders. *The Indian Express* has learnt.

In the order issued on August 10, Nabam Gunget, Joint Commissioner of Police, SPUWAC, directed all district police units, as well as the Railway and Metro police, to ensure “zero tolerance” towards torture or any physical or psychological ill-treatment of juveniles.

The directive was issued after concerns were raised during proceedings before the Juvenile Justice Board-VII over alleged instances of custodial violence and ill-treatment of juveniles in a number of cases.

According to the communication, the Board flagged instances where juveniles were allegedly taken outside police stations to keep them away from CCTV coverage. Such practices, the order noted, could leave children vulnerable to physical or psychological abuse. The Board also raised

another concern — in some cases, allegations of custodial violence were reportedly being investigated by the police officer against whom the allegations had been made. The SPUWAC order termed such a practice “unacceptable” and directed that allegations of violence or ill-treatment be dealt with “promptly, objectively and impartially” by a senior officer independent of the allegations.

Incidents that sparked concerns

The instructions come against the backdrop of several cases in Delhi in which questions were raised over the treatment and safety of juveniles — both while they are in police custody and after they are sent to institutions meant for their care and rehabilitation.

In May, Delhi Police initiated an inquiry after a video surfaced showing a teenager allegedly being taken to Sarai Rohilla police station and being man-handled.

Police said the teenager was involved in an accident case and had been apprehended after his parents allegedly failed to comply with repeated notices. The police said the video was from May 25, when the teenager was produced before the JJB via video-conferencing from the police station, and that it was being ascertained whether a juvenile welfare officer was present as required.

There have also been cases involving alleged mistreatment inside juvenile homes and observation facilities. In 2010, the JJB directed police to register a case against the superintendent of a Delhi government juvenile home after a boy complained that he had been beaten by older inmates and subsequently allegedly pressured to withdraw

his complaint. The Board recorded that the child appeared terrified and later broke down while recounting what had happened.

In another incident, a 16-year-old boy was allegedly sexually assaulted by two fellow inmates at a correction home in Northwest Delhi in 2017. Police registered a case after the boy disclosed the alleged assaults to welfare officers at the facility.

The death of a 17-year-old boy following an alleged assault by fellow inmates at a government-run juvenile home in the Majnu ka Tila area in June 2025 had also prompted the National Human Rights Commission to take suo motu cognisance and seek reports from the Delhi Chief Secretary and the Delhi Police Commissioner.

The latest SPUWAC order, however, is specifically focused on the conduct of police personnel dealing with juveniles. The directive also calls for regular orientation and sensitisation programmes for investigating officers, Child Welfare Police Officers and other personnel who deal with juveniles. The training is to cover child-friendly policing and legal safeguards.

What the rules say

The Delhi Juvenile Justice Rules already require the Special Juvenile Police Unit to oversee the handling of juveniles and provide that a police officer found guilty, after due inquiry, of mentally or physically torturing a child can face removal from service apart from prosecution. The rules also require the JJB, at the beginning of an inquiry, to satisfy itself that a juvenile has not been subjected to ill-treatment by police or any other person and to take corrective steps if such treatment is found.



‘Freedom from garbage’ campaign

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, in presence of Union MoS Harsh Malhotra and others, launched ‘Delhi Ko Kude Se Azadi-Swachhta Abhiyan 2026’ on Monday. The campaign is set to continue till October 2 and wards performing best will receive incentives of up to Rs 1 crore, she said. AMIT MEHRA

Months before Saket building collapse, owner was warned over illegal construction: Cops

Pragynesh
New Delhi, August 17

THREE MONTHS before his wife Parvati, 55, died in a building collapse in South Delhi's Saket in May, Jai Raj Ojha claimed that he had warned the building owner that it may crumble due to the illegal construction of two additional floors. Parvati, who owned a make-shift canteen near the building, popular among students in the areas as “Auntie Wala Kitchen”, was among the six people who died in the May 30 incident.

Police sources have told *The Indian Express* that Jai Raj's testimony is among the 15 recorded in a 300-page chargesheet, including those of nine people who were injured during the collapse. The court is yet to take cognizance of the chargesheet filed last week.

The four-storey building was located in Said-ul-Ajaib village near the Saket Metro Station.

The chargesheet alleges that owner Karanvir Sejwal, 71, had constructed the building in 2014, and flouted building norms even then, including not having a building plan, said a police officer. Sejwal was traced

to his farmhouse in Southwest Delhi's Vasant Kunj two days after the incident and arrested, police said.

The chargesheet, according to sources, also alleges that a structural stability assessment had not been done before Sejwal hired contractors Manish Khatri and Avinash to build two additional floors atop the building. Both Khatri and Avinash have also been named in the chargesheet. The duo were allegedly given a contract of Rs 1.8 crore in January to build two halls, but allegedly did not involve architects before laying out new pillars to connect the floors to the already weak building.

“The accused knew that they were flouting norms and were using substandard material in an already weak structure. They were warned by one of the deceased and her husband about it as well, and still went ahead with the construction,” said a police officer.

About three months before the incident, work started on constructing two additional floors on the building — which housed a co-working space and a commercial office — allegedly against the permissible limit. On May 30, while construc-

tion work was ongoing, the building collapsed like a house of cards, killing six and injuring eight. The debris fell on an adjacent tin shed, which housed Parvati's makeshift eatery for students studying in a medical coaching centre on the third floor of the building. Other deceased were identified as Ravi (24), Kapil (28), Nalin Ray (23), Alok (24), Ekta (24), and Parvati (35). All the dead were in the canteen at the time.

Parvati's eatery was said to have been the go-to place for students living as paying guests and tenants in the area. Parvati “auntie” was popular among the youngsters, as much for the parathas her kitchen served as for her care and affection.

Even as the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) suspended two junior officials, Assistant Engineer Sudesh Singh Chauhan and Junior Engineer Amar Jain, of Building Department 2 of its South Zone jurisdiction, none of them find a mention in the chargesheet, claims another officer. However, senior officers said that a supplementary chargesheet will be filed, detailing the role of government departments in the collapse.

Delhi govt notifies SoP to ease licensing process for cinema halls

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 17

THE DELHI government has notified a long-pending Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) to eliminate unnecessary delays in the licensing process and address coordination issues between different departments by providing applicants with a clear, accountable and technology-driven mechanism, said Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday.

Gupta said that the new SOP was finalised in 2015, but was never implemented by the previous Aam Aadmi Party-led government. “The SOP was issued as part of the process of complying with the directions of the Supreme Court relating to the Uphar Cinema tragedy...The SOP had been finalised in 2015 and could have been easily implemented by the then AAP government... However, it was not implemented due to its inaction and anti-Delhi mindset,” CM Gupta said.

Officials said that with the current notification, the long-standing practice of obtaining separate No Objection Certificates (NOCs) from different departments has been done away with and an integrated single-window system has been introduced.

Officials said that under the new SOP, the first committee to be constituted will be the District Licensing Committee (DLC) under the Revenue department that will take the final decision on licensing.

The committee will be headed by the Deputy Commissioner (Revenue)/District Magistrate and will also have representatives from the police, Delhi Fire Services, Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), Delhi Development Authority, Delhi Jal Board and other agencies.

Officials added that under the old system, applicants had to obtain separate NOCs from various agencies for a cinematograph licence.

Bhagwant Mann video row: One more gets bail as Gurgaon court flags lack of evidence yet again

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, August 17

A GURGAON court on Monday granted regular bail to Pankaj Yadav, the third accused arrested in connection with a case of alleged fabrication of forensic reports concerning a purported “objectionable” video of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann.

Bhagwant Mann had claimed that the individual seen in the said video was not him.

Yadav is the proprietor of Cyber Yaan, a training centre in Delhi's Tilak Nagar, one of the labs allegedly used to prepare a report showing the video in question was AI-generated.

All three men arrested by the Haryana Police in the case so far, including Yadav, are currently out on bail.

The FIR in the case was registered on June 23 at Gurgaon Sector 29 police station based on a complaint filed by one Jaspreet Singh, a digital forensics worker from Sirsa.

He alleged that he was summoned on June 15 and 16 to Hotel Crowne Plaza in Gurgaon where two senior Punjab Police officers “pressured” him and forcibly handed him Rs 10 lakh



Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann

to obtain tailored forensic reports stating that the video was AI-generated, manipulated, and did not feature the Punjab Chief Minister. The Gurgaon police, however, are yet to summon or question the two senior officers who were also allegedly also spotted in a footage of the hotel's CCTV camera.

Additional Sessions Judge Sudeep Goel, while granting bail to Yadav (35), held that the police had invoked the stringent provisions related to organised crime under Section 111 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita or BNS without foundational evidence.

Criticising the prosecution's approach, the court observed: “Without legally admissible accusations, allegations, or evidence, the State cannot arrest a suspect to fish evidence against them or use such a suspect as custodial bait by any hook, line, and sinker to bring the case into the fold of S. 111 of BNS.”

The Judge further remarked: “Without legally admissible prima facie evidence, the State cannot make any suspect undergo custodial interrogation to hunt for such evidence against the suspect or others. The evidence must be gathered first to make out a prima facie case within the scope of S. 111 of BNS, and such evidence alone would justify custodial interrogation to carry out further investigation.”

The Indian Express earlier reported that investigators had gathered substantial technical evidence, including CCTV footage from the hotel, guest stay logs, food and beverage bills, and an alleged money trail linking the two senior Punjab Police officers — a Deputy Inspector General and a Superintendent of Police (SP) — one of whom was addressed as “bade sahib” in the complaint.

निविदा सूचना

पीएम श्री केन्द्रीय विद्यालय क्रमांक-2 दिल्ली छावनी द्वारा विद्यालय भवन एवं स्टाफ क्वार्टर्स के मरम्मत, फर्नीचर मरम्मत, बैड/वाद्य यंत्रों के मरम्मत, कैंटीन, किराये पर टेंट सामग्री, खेलकूद सामग्री, स्टेशनरी, मुद्रण (प्रिंटिंग) कार्य, प्लेक्स एवं बैनर, फूल एवं पौधों की आपूर्ति, फोटोग्राफी एवं वीडियोग्राफी, ड्रेस एवं ज्वेलरी (किराये पर) तथा आयरर एवं जीएसटी संबंधी सेवाओं हेतु प्रतिष्ठित एवं पंजीकृत फर्मों से मुहरबंद प्रतियुक्त निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। विस्तृत निविदा प्रपत्र विद्यालय कार्यालय से प्रत्येक कार्य दिवस में प्राप्त किया जा सकता है। विधिवत भरी हुई मुहरबंद निविदाएं विद्यालय में दिनांक 08.09.2026 प्रायः 05 बजे तक विद्यालय कार्यालय में अनिवार्य रूप से प्राप्त हो जानी चाहिए।

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PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of general public, allottees and stakeholders of the real estate project "Orchid IVY-2" situated at sector 51 being developed by promoter namely M/s Orchid Infrastructure Developers Private Limited

1. This is to inform the general public, allottees, stakeholders, and concerned authorities that the promoter of the project namely "Orchid IVY-2" has applied for change of the bank accounts.

2. The above-mentioned project is registered with the HARERA Gurugram vide registration no. **GGM/646/378/2022/121** dated 13.12.2022 and the registration is valid up to **31.12.2026**.

3. Existing Bank Account and New Bank Account Details are as follow:

Bank Name	ICICI Bank	RBL Bank
Branch address	Unit no. 1, Solitaire Plaza, MG Road, DLF Phase-III, Gurgaon, Haryana	ABW Tower, IFFCO Chowk, Gurgaon, Haryana
IFSC	ICIC0002451	RATN0000116
Master account	777705001662	409002615104
FREE account	777705001663	409002615098
Free account	777705001669	409002615074

4. The promoter has submitted a request for change of the designated bank accounts before the Authority, which is presently under consideration.

5. This notice is being issued for information purposes only to the general public, allottees, and stakeholders in respect of the above-mentioned project.

Sd/- Secretary
For Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 18.08.2026

• Skywatch

Forecast: August 18, 2026
Generally cloudy sky. Very light to light rain.
MAX: 32-34
0.2°C above normal
MIN: 23-25
1.5°C above normal

• **Sunrise:** 5:53 AM (August 19)

• **Sunset:** 6:58 PM (August 18)

• **Moonrise:** 12:13 AM (August 19)

• **Moonset:** 10:11 PM (August 18)

• AQITracker

Bawana Poor AQI: 231	Mundka Moderate AQI: 138
Aya Nagar Satisfactory AQI: 84	Najafgarh Satisfactory AQI: 76

● Good (0-50)

● Satisfactory (51-100)

● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)

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UN-AIDED

Sr.No.	Cadre	Subject	Total No. of Posts	Post for Reserved for
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3	Assistant Professor	History	01	01-OPEN
4	Assistant Professor	English	01	01-OPEN
5	Assistant Professor	Economics	01	01-OPEN
6	Assistant Professor	Political Science	01	01-OPEN
7	Assistant Professor	Sociology	01	01-OPEN
8	Librarian	---	01	OPEN-01

The posts for the reserved category candidates will be filled by the same category candidates. (Domicile of State of Maharashtra) belonging to that particular category only.
Reservation for women will be as per **University Circular No. BCC/16/741998 dated 10th March, 1998, 4% reservation shall be for the persons with disability as per University Circular No. Special Cell/ICC/2019-20/05 dated 05th July, 2019.** Candidates having knowledge of Marathi will be preferred.
Qualification, Pay Scales and other requirement are as prescribed by the UGC Notification dated 18 July, 2018, Government of Maharashtra Resolution No. Misc-2018/C.R.56/18/JUNI-1, dated 8th March, 2019 and University circular No. TAAS/CT/ICC/2018-19/1241 dated 26th March, 2019 and revised from time to time "The Government Resolution & Circular are available on the website: mu.ac.in.
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				Min	Max
Deputy Vice President (DVP) – Cyber Innovation & Simulation Lab	1	Deputy Vice President (DVP) – Cyber Innovation & Simulation Lab	1	35	45
Deputy Vice President (DVP) – Citizen Centric Initiatives	1	Deputy Vice President (DVP) – Citizen Centric Initiatives	1	35	45
Deputy Vice President (DVP) – Cyber Security	2	Deputy Vice President (DVP) – Cyber Security	2	35	45

(Regular Position)

Name of Post	Vacancy	Grade	Age (As on 31.07.2026)	
			Min	Max
Deputy Manager- AI- Specialist	25	MMGS-II	25	35
Deputy Manager- Cyber Security Analyst	3			
Deputy Manager- IT Security Expert	2			

Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/12 (Regular Position)

Name of Post	Vacancy	Grade	Age (As on 31.07.2026)	
			Min	Max
Manager (Manpower Planning & Recruitment)	1	MMGS-III	28	40
Manager (Learning & Development)	1	MMGS-III	28	40

Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/13 (Contractual Position)

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Govt plans high-rises for bureaucrats near Def Col, Mayur Vihar

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 17

DELHI’S GOVERNMENT housing colonies could soon get a major makeover, with the government planning to redevelop those under the Public Works Department (PWD) pool as high-rise buildings.

PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the government will demolish the existing flats and construct multi-storeyed flats as per the Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) policy.

Gulabi Bagh in North Delhi, Kalyanwas in Mayur Vihar and Bahapur near Defence Colony are likely to be the first colonies taken up under the plan.

It will be on the lines of the Centre’s General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA) and will be self-financed.

The plan

At Gulabi Bagh and Kalyanwas, commercial projects will be developed alongside residential spaces. Singh said that under the TOD policy, around 10% of the total area should be utilised for commercial purposes.

“So, 10% of flats at Gulabi Bagh and Kalyanwas are planned for commercial use to help recover the redevelopment costs. We also have plans to use the entire permissible FAR (Floor Area Ratio) at these two locations and build high-rise buildings. We will keep flats for officials and staff, as per the requirement, and the remaining will be sold,” he added.

Revenue generated from these projects will also be used to finance the development of the new Delhi Secretariat complex at ITO, Singh further said.

Unlike Gulabi Bagh and Kalyanwas, the Bahapur project will be purely residential. The existing flats are in poor condition and require immediate redevelopment, Singh said.

“In Bahapur, 160 Type V and Type VI flats, with bedrooms, halls and kitchens, will be constructed. The tender for this project will be floated by next week. As there is an immediate requirement here,



Parvesh Sahib Singh

these will be for residential purposes,” Singh said.

This project is expected to cost around Rs 400 crore and will soon be placed before the Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) for approval.

What will be built

■ Kalyanwas, Mayur Vihar: The government has 32 acres of land here. Around 70 lakh sq ft of space is planned, including commercial development.

■ Gulabi Bagh: Around 2.25 crore sq ft of space is planned.

■ Bahapur: Around four lakh sq ft of space is planned.

Singh said the projects will be developed on a self-financing model, with the government recovering its construction costs through the sale of flats and commercial space. “These projects will be developed on a self-financing model by selling flats and commercial space to private players. The government’s construction cost will be recovered from what we sell. There will be a certain percentage that will remain with the government,” he said.

Singh said officials posted in Delhi often face difficulties in finding suitable government accommodation. “Delhi government residential complexes are not in a very good condition, due to which several officials opt for transfers. We want our staff and bureaucrats also to have good accommodation and living space,” he said.

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Unlike Gulabi Bagh and Kalyanwas, the Bahapur project will be purely residential. The existing flats are in poor condition and require immediate redevelopment, Singh said.

“In Bahapur, 160 Type V and Type VI flats, with bedrooms, halls and kitchens, will be constructed. The tender for this project will be floated by next week. As there is an immediate requirement here,

trips, pedestrians take up 35% of the share while 7% are cycle rickshaw trips. Public transport trips — such as Delhi Metro and buses — constitute 24% of the total trips on average.

However, the plan has also highlighted that the growth of regional centres and the relative ease of accessibility has led to an increase in the average road and public transport trip length from 6 km in 2007 to 10.9 km in 2018.

At 16.7 km, the plan has highlighted Metro’s role in long-distance commutes, while two-wheelers, cars and buses are best utilised for medium distances of 8-14 km, as per the data.

14 proposals

To encourage people to walk, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has prepared 14 proposals — these at the implementation stage with the road-owning agencies concerned, according to officials. “These will be integrated with

to the PWD.

Once the colonies are redeveloped, the government will advertise flats for sale. The Central government, Central Public Works Department and public sector undertakings (PSUs) will also be able to buy them, Singh said.

“Otherwise, whoever wants to buy it from the market can do so. The market price will be fixed,” Singh said.

“For the portion that we want to give to private players in the open market, we will hold an auction and give it to whoever bids the highest,” Singh added.

Officials said consultants will be appointed for Gulabi Bagh and Mayur Vihar to prepare the Detailed Project Report, budget estimate, and other aspects of the self-financing model. “Here, three categories of flats — Type II, Type III and Type IV — will be developed, which will take about three to four years,” they said.

7 more sites identified

Besides these locations, seven more sites have been identified for redevelopment under the model to optimise land use. These include Probyn Road, Timarpur, Sindhora Khurd, Sindhora Kalan and Vikas Bhawan.

■ Gulabi Bagh, Sindhora Kalan and Sindhora Khurd colonies are located in North Delhi and comprise around 1,200 Type I, II and III government quarters.

■ Probyn Road and Timarpur, near Civil Lines, have 16 Type V residential quarters and 90 Type III quarters.

■ Kalyanwas has 70 Type II government flats.

“As these are big-ticket projects and cannot be constructed solely through public funds, the government has decided to rope in private players. It will give contracts to private companies to construct houses and office complexes and recover the cost by allowing construction of private offices and retail spaces, and possibly even by selling left-over land parcels to private developers,” officials said.

DELHI SIR DRAFT ROLLS

Duplication, relocation: Why 1/3rd of electors may get deleted

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, August 17

DUPLICATE ENTRIES in other states, relocation, and lack of awareness are among the factors that the booth level officers (BLOs) have attributed to the expected deletion of 32.82% of names of electors in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of draft rolls in Delhi.

On Monday, the SIR enumeration phase — in which BLOs conduct door-to-door visits to distribute enumeration forms, electors fill out their details and BLOs upload the details on the EC portal — ended in the city.

When the exercise started in June, the city had 1.45 crore names on its electoral rolls. Enumeration forms of around

67.18% of the electorate, or 97.47 lakh electors, have been collected and uploaded onto the portal, as per the officials.

Forms of around 47.62 lakh electors are set to be marked uncollectible — a category that includes people who are absent, have shifted, have died, have duplicate entries, or fall under ‘Other’ reasons.

“Most of my deletions will be of labourers who had Voter ID here as well as in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh. Some have even completed the SIR of those states because they want at least one address proof of their villages,” said a BLO in East Delhi, who did not want to be named. The BLO was assigned an urban village. He said he had

to mark them absent after a discussion with their neighbours. “Others had found cheaper rental accommodations in nearby villages, or found work at another construction site, so they shifted,” he added.

Out of around 1,500 electors assigned to him, he said he had only been able to collect forms and digitise enumeration forms of around 800. He also estimates that out of the 700 forms he had submitted, around 200 will be sent notices due to a mismatch in names or due to missing documents.

BLO Amit Kumar, 31, who was assigned upscale Kailash Colony, said that he was able to digitise 60% of his enumer-



WORKERS SAY WON’T CALL OFF STRIKE UNTIL DEMANDS ARE MET

‘We want justice’: Protests enter second day after sanitation worker is stabbed to death; 1 arrested

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, August 17

“WE WANT justice,” said a teary-eyed Sunita, 37, as she sat cross-legged on a road in a street near the Emergency Block at the Lal Bahadur Shastri (LBS) Hospital on Monday. Her brother, Anil Kumar, a 27-year-old Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) contractual worker, was stabbed to death in East Delhi’s Kalyanpuri in the early hours of Sunday morning.

Along with her father Ram Asare, Sunita, her family members, and hundreds of sanitation workers, and Kalyanpuri MLA Kuldeep Kumar gathered at the protest site Monday, demanding Rs 1 crore in compensation for the family, a government job for a relative and strict punishment for the accused as their protest entered the second day. Senior district police officers and paramilitary personnel were deployed at the hospital in view of the demonstration.

Recalling the last time she met Anil, Sunita said, “I saw him two days ago. He came to my house... and we had a meal together... he mentioned that his salary was about to get credited. He was happy. But he is gone now. Who will take care



The protest on Monday; (right) victim Anil’s father. TASHI TOBGYAL

of the family? That is why we are demanding a government job for his elder brother.”

The MCD Sanitation Workers Union has also gone on a strike — they said it won’t be called off until all demands are met.

According to the police, Anil, who worked as a helper, was standing near a garbage van on Sunday when the attacker approached and assaulted him with a knife. The incident was captured on a CCTV camera.

Hours after the murder, Anil’s family began a sit-in protest outside the mortuary at Lok Nayak (LBS) Hospital, refusing to accept his body after the post-mortem as they demanded the arrest of the accused.



Police arrested the suspect, identified as Nihal alias “Kulla”, 52, from the Kalyanpuri area on Monday afternoon. During questioning, Nihal allegedly told investigators that he had intended to target Anil and the garbage van driver, Gulshan, as he suspected an illicit relationship between Gulshan and his wife. “Nihal revealed that he tracked the vehicle early on Sunday. In a fit of rage, he attacked Anil, who often accompanied Gulshan. Officers are trying to recover the knife allegedly used in the crime,” a police officer said.

Delhi Master Plan 2047 sharpens focus on ‘Right to Walk’

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 17

ON AVERAGE, a Delhiite walks just 1.6 km a day. As far as cycling goes, the daily average comes down to 3.6 km, according to the Delhi Master Plan 2047. In its 20-year-vision for the Capital, the plan emphasises on promoting “Right to Walk”, which emerged as a critical talking point following a recent Supreme Court ruling in this regard. The plan renews the focus of authorities on a citywide network of safe, shaded and universally accessible pathways, along with pedestrian-only zones and improved links with public transport.

Granular comparison

According to the plan, non-motorised trips — such as walking, cycling and cycle-rickshaws — constitute 42% of the total trips. Expectedly, these trips are taken for a distance of less than 5 km. Of the total non-motorised

trips, pedestrians take up 35% of the share while 7% are cycle rickshaw trips. Public transport trips — such as Delhi Metro and buses — constitute 24% of the total trips on average.

However, the plan has also highlighted that the growth of regional centres and the relative ease of accessibility has led to an increase in the average road and public transport trip length from 6 km in 2007 to 10.9 km in 2018.

At 16.7 km, the plan has highlighted Metro’s role in long-distance commutes, while two-wheelers, cars and buses are best utilised for medium distances of 8-14 km, as per the data.

14 proposals

To encourage people to walk, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has prepared 14 proposals — these at the implementation stage with the road-owning agencies concerned, according to officials. “These will be integrated with

plans for traffic management, Multi-Modal Integration (MMI) and others... Walk Plans for other priority areas are to be prepared in consultation with stakeholders,” said an official, adding that the authority has initially identified 24 priority areas for the preparation of Walk Plans. For road infrastructure overhaul, the plan proposes barrier-free non-motorised transport infrastructure such as footpaths and cycle tracks. Pedestrian zones and cycle crossings are to be provided wherever possible, while pedestrian crossings — pedestrian-operated, light-controlled road crossings — near schools and markets are proposed to improve safety.

“Traffic-calming measures like Multi-Utility Zones (MUZs) to accommodate street furniture, that is seating, garbage bins, signage, public conveniences such as restrooms, childcare rooms and drinking water,

street vendors and kiosks at regular intervals, service lines such as gas pipelines, optical fibre, among others, provision for parking and Public Cycle Sharing (PBS) systems, while ensuring that clear walking space is available for pedestrians,” said the official.

In areas with high pedestrian footfall, including commercial areas, heritage precincts and areas identified for 24x7 economic activity, agencies can identify pedestrian-only zones, the plan has underlined.

The plan also proposes continuous active-travel networks connecting cultural hubs and other active-travel corridors along roads with a right of way of more than 30 metres, subject to feasibility. Officials said that new developments under landpooling, transit-oriented development and regeneration schemes will also be treated as Active Travel Areas.

“Cycling along highways,

greenways along natural drains and the Yamuna are also proposed as part of the network... Transit stations will be designed with cycle parking and pick-up and drop-off facilities for public and private vehicles, taxis and intermediate public transport,” said officials.

It also talks about removal of encroachments, illegal parking and unauthorised structures (including religious structures) from footpaths and Non-Motorised Transport lanes, which shall be taken up on priority.

For developing land-pooling areas, the plan separately proposes an incremental public transport network comprising new bus routes, bus rapid transit system (BRTS) and high-speed bus routes. Metro systems may be introduced along specific corridors, while Urban Extension Roads are proposed to function as mass-transit corridors connecting these areas with the rest of Delhi.

Two including minor killed as fire breaks out at West Delhi building

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 17

TWO PERSONS, including a minor, were killed after a suspected blast in an e-rickshaw battery triggered a fire at a building in West Delhi’s Raghubir Nagar in the early hours of Monday, police said.

Police said that the victims were identified as Md Sufed (17) and Md Sahmad (38), who hailed from Bhagalpur in Bihar.

Sufed lived with his father, Md Naseeb, and maternal uncle Sahmad — all e-rickshaw drivers, police said.

The victims were charging the portable batteries of their vehicles on the premises of the building when the incident happened, officers said.

Sahmad’s brother Md Rehman said he came to know about the incident around 6 on Monday. “It appears that the



Deceased Md Sahmad

batteries were being charged here. We do not have any other details yet. People told us that a large number of batteries were being charged here and that there was a blast, after which they died. This is negligence,” he said.

“Our father also sleeps in this building. However, he had slept at another house in the area yesterday. It is a miracle... he too, like my brother and my nephew, could have been a vic-

Police say the victims were charging the portable batteries of their e-rickshaws on the building premises

tim,” Rehman said.

Police said that officers reached the spot after receiving a PCR call regarding the incident. They found that the victims had sustained injuries. They were rushed to Guru Gobind Singh Hospital, where doctors declared them dead.

A team from the Delhi Fire Services also reached the spot, after which the blaze was brought under control.

Police said that the exact cause of the fire is yet to be ascertained, adding that further inquiry is underway.

● BUNDU HALEEM WAS STARTED BY NAIMUDDIN’S GRANDFATHER. FOR THREE GENERATIONS, THAT’S THE ONLY DISH THE FAMILY HAS SOLD

A stall near Jama Masjid selling haleem and blessings for more than 70 years

Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, August 17

BACK IN 1953, Naimuddin’s grandfather started a small food business in a lane close to Jama Masjid. There was only one dish on the menu — haleem. But the lack of variety was no handicap — customers loved the robust, deeply satisfying flavours of his slow-cooked mutton-and-lentils stew.

More than 70 years on, the little shop in a lane close to Karim’s hotel retains its reputation. Naimuddin continues to sell the only dish that his grandfather ever cooked. On most days, he runs out by 4.30 pm.

“Our work is *dada ilahi* (an-

cestral),” Naimuddin told *The Indian Express*. “Dada ji sold a portion for *chaar aana* (25 paise).” Naimuddin sells his haleem for Rs 50 a plate. But he turns away no one — those who can’t afford a full plate can have a small portion for even Rs 10.

His haleem is not merely something that he sells for profit, Naimuddin said — it is a blessing from his grandfather and father. His shop bears his name, Naim Bhai Haleem Wale, but also that of his father — “Bundu Haleem”.

At the stall, Naimuddin stands behind a large pot of haleem simmering gently on a coal *chulha*. A second pot sits to his left, ready to feed the first

once it runs low. He makes 25-30 kg of haleem six days a week, Naimuddin said. “I don’t open on *Jumma* (Fridays) and during *Ramzan*.” His day begins well before 4 am, the haleem is ready by 11 am, and is over by 4.30 pm. “Some days, the pot runs empty by 3 pm,” he said.

The recipe and ingredients haven’t changed since the time his grandfather made the dish, Naimuddin said — pounded wheat, broken wheat, turmeric, chilli, salt, garam masala, lentils, and meat, typically cuts of mutton from the neck, cheek, and tongue. “It is extremely time-consuming and difficult to make this, that’s the reason not many take up the task,” he



Naimuddin’s sells his haleem for Rs 50 a plate, but if you can’t afford that, he will give you a smaller portion for less. REVA THAKKAR

said. Traditionally, haleem is served with flatbread, but Naimuddin has no time to make anything other than the dish. “People are welcome to get

their own roti, bread or rice to eat with it,” he said.

Haleem traces its origins to harees, a dish that travelled to the Deccan with the Hadhrami

Arab soldiers who served the Nizams of Hyderabad. The dish evolved over time, as generations of Indian chefs added lentils, ghee, and spices to it.

In Delhi, you can get haleem at shops in Old Delhi, Nizamuddin Basti, and the Hyderabad pockets in Zakir Nagar and Jangpura. Bundu Haleem, Naimuddin’s stall on Matia Mahal Road, is among the capital’s oldest continuously-running haleem places.

After finishing Class 12 in 1994, Naimuddin, now 51, got married, and briefly trained

with the Delhi Police, and taught at a Civil Defence centre. “I wanted a government job, but life had different plans. My father’s health began to fail,

and seeing his distress, I joined him,” he said, adding: “I don’t want to pass the stall down to my daughters. They are successful in their lives — one practises law, the other works at a car showroom, and two are in school.”

To hear that Bundu Haleem may not survive its owner would break many hearts. On the rainy Tuesday that *The Indian Express* went to the stall,

Yasmeen had come all the way from Jahangirpuri with her husband and their one-year-old child to enjoy the dish. “We have been coming for the last five years,” she said.

Mohammed Arif, a welder, has been coming every day for the past six years: “*Mera roz ka dimn ka khaana hai ye*.” He has the haleem with some rotis that he picks up from a restaurant.

For Abdul Kayyum, who has been parking his autorickshaw at the Jama Masjid stand for 37 years, “Naim bhai” has become a close friend.

Gulfam (36), Yasmeen’s husband, said he first came to the stall as a little boy with his father: “The taste is still the same.”



Engaging Gen Z

UNDERLINING THE new-found significance of the youth following protests in Delhi, BJP national president Nitin Nabin is scheduled to hold a three-hour interaction with Gen Z representatives during his trip to Vizag on Tuesday. Of the seven separate events which he is scheduled to attend during his stay, Nabin's three-hour-long engagement with the youth is second only to his meeting with the state executive, which is scheduled for four-and-a-half hours. Nabin will also interact with district presidents and other office-bearers for an hour and with elected representatives such as MPs, MLAs and MLCs for two hours.

Film Fan

THE NEWLY appointed Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha president and Vadodara MP Hemang Joshi has a somewhat little-known interest — organising film festivals. He organised a film festival on 'Operation Sindoor' on October 25, 2025, and then a short film festival on 'Har ghar desi ghar ghar swadeshi' in December 2025. He is learnt to have organised many other thematic short-film festivals with youth organisations and foundations.

Date Awaited

FOURTEEN MONTHS after the first annual general meeting of the newly reconstituted Prime Ministers' Museum & Library Society was held in June last year, the administration is yet to fix a day for this year's meeting. The 47th annual general meeting in 2025 was chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and also attended by Union ministers Nirmala Sitharaman, Dharmendra Pradhan, Ashwini Vaishnaw and Gajendra Singh Shekhawat.

Kishor takes oath as Bankipur MLA, calls it 'big responsibility'

Santosh Singh
Patna, August 17

JAN SURAAJ Party (JSP) founder Praashant Kishor on Monday took the oath as Bankipur MLA at Bihar Assembly, calling it "a matter of great honour". Kishor took the oath in the presence of Speaker Prem Kumar.

"It is a matter of great honour to be part of a House that was represented by Srikrishna Singh, Anugrah Narayan Singh, Kedar Pandey, Karpoori Thakur, Lalu Prasad, Nitish Kumar, Ram Vilas Paswan, and Sushil Kumar Modi. Being a member of the Bihar Assembly also brings a big responsibility. I will try to live up to people's expectations," he told reporters in Patna.

Kishor defeated BJP Neeraj Kumar Sinha to win July 30 Bankipur bypoll, ending the ruling party's three-decade-long hold on the constituency. The bypoll was necessitated with BJP national president Nitin Nabin vacating the seat after being nominated to Rajya Sabha.

After taking the oath, Kishor headed off to address public meetings in his constituency. He has been meeting residents across every ward under Bankipur to reiterate his election promises, having already covered 14 of the 24 wards.

The pledge that has garnered the most attention is his promise of 10,000 jobs for the people of his constituency.

2.08 crore Maharashtra voters may be left out of SIR draft rolls

Vallabh Ozkarar
Mumbai, August 17

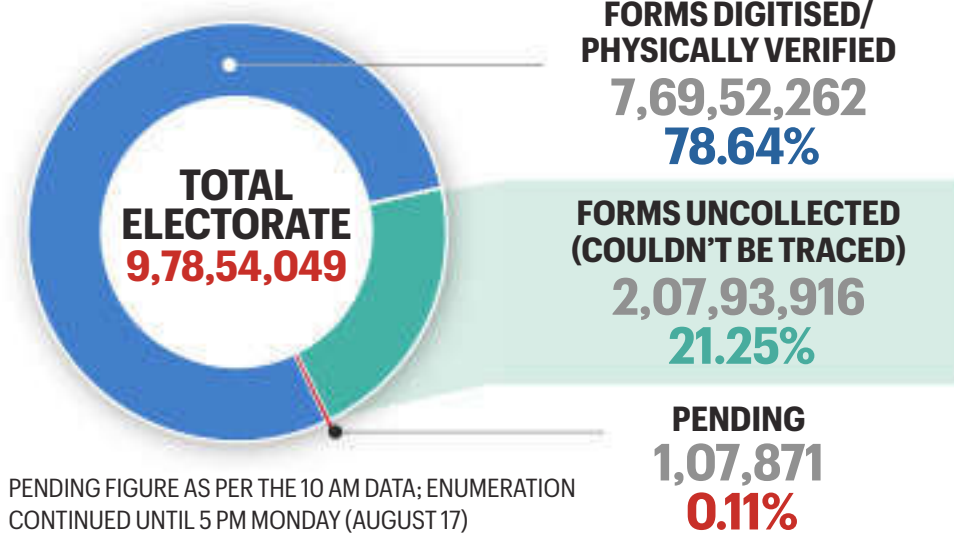
FORMS FOR at least 2.08 crore of Maharashtra's 9.79 crore voters — more than one in five — could not be collected during the house-to-house enumeration exercise under SIR of electoral rolls, which ended at 5 pm Monday. The figure is from the 10 am bulletin on the final day, and is likely to change. Nearly half of these are from Thane, Mumbai and Pune.

Names for which forms remained uncollected will not feature in the draft electoral roll to be published on August 24.

"This is not permanent deletion from the electoral roll. The August 24 list is a draft, and being left out of it does not mean that an eligible voter has permanently lost the right to vote. Voters should check the draft roll on August 24. Those whose names are missing will have time from August 24 to September 1 to get their forms collected," said an official.

During the SIR, BLOs visited households with pre-filled forms and collected them for verification and digitisation. A form recorded as uncollected does not by itself mean the voter is dead, has shifted, is a

MAHARASHTRA ELECTORAL ROLL REVISION



PENDING FIGURE AS PER THE 10 AM DATA. ENUMERATION CONTINUED UNTIL 5 PM MONDAY (AUGUST 17)

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGF9mJmZg1

WhatsApp: <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

duplicate or is ineligible. The voter may have moved, may not have been at the address when the BLO called, or may not have been traced there.

The data shows 2,07,93,916 forms, or 21.25% of the state's electorate, in the uncollected category. Across Maharashtra, 7,69,52,262 forms, or 78.64%, had been digitised as of the

10 am bulletin.

The problem is concentrated in the largest urban districts. Forms for 94.47 lakh voters in Thane, Mumbai City, Mumbai Suburban and Pune account for 45.4% of all uncollected forms, although the four districts hold only about 27.5% of the state's electorate.

Thane has the highest share, with forms for 28.88 lakh of its 74.51 lakh voters, or 38.77%, uncollected. Mumbai City has 9.60 lakh, or 37.57%, Mumbai suburban 26.99 lakh, or 34.48%, and Pune 28.99 lakh, or 31.92%.

The numbers are also high in Nagpur, Palghar and Raigad. Nagpur has 14.06 lakh uncollected forms, or 30.32%, Palghar 6.87 lakh, or 28.88%, and Raigad 5.91 lakh, or 23.33%. Together, these seven districts account for about 1.21 crore, or 58.3%, of all uncollected forms, while holding about 37% of the electorate.

Rural districts show the opposite pattern. In Hingoli, forms

for 8.82% of voters remain uncollected. The figure is 9.10% in Buldhana, 9.93% in Ratnagiri and 10.62% in Latur. In Thane, forms for nearly four in 10 voters could not be collected. In Hingoli, it was fewer than one in 10.

Officials have previously cited migration and changes of address among the reasons for the high urban numbers of uncollected forms. In Mumbai, Thane and Pune, frequent movement between residences can make it difficult for BLOs to find electors at addresses recorded in the roll, officials said. The uncollected figure has risen from 1.80 crore on August 12 to 2.08 crore on Monday, an increase of about 27.3 lakh in five days.

The 10 am bulletin showed around 1.08 lakh electors outside digitised and uncollected categories, with their final status yet to be reflected. On that basis, 2.08 crore is the minimum number of electors likely to be left out of the August 24 draft.

Over 73 lakh names dropped in Telangana SIR draft rolls

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, August 17

AROUND 73.39 lakh voters in Telangana have been deleted under Special Intensive Revision (SIR) as draft rolls were released Monday.

Meanwhile, 92 lakh voters will be sent notices, Chief Electoral Officer C Sudarshan Reddy said on Monday.

Reddy said the Election Commission has collected 78.30% of enumeration forms from a total of 3.38 crore voters.

Apart from 73.39 lakh voters who were deleted from the draft rolls, about 60 lakh had anomalies in the electoral rolls, and another 32 lakh electors remain unmapped — meaning that they couldn't be linked to the 2002 voters' list.

This means that as many as 92 lakh electors will now get notices.

Of the state's 3.38 crore voters, 9,22,229 (2.73%) have died, 57,46,803 (16.99%) were found to have shifted permanently or were absent, and 6,70,203 electors (1.98%) were found to have been enrolled in multiple places in the electoral roll.

According to the Telangana Chief Electoral Office, BLOs did not get back the rest of the enumeration forms because "the electors became electors in other states and UTs, were not found in existence, or did not submit the form till August 10, were not willing to register as elector for some reason or the other".

Electors who were unable to submit their enumeration forms can now file Form 6 for inclusion during the claims and objections period. The period for filing claims and objections is between August 17 and September 16. The notice phase and disposal of claims and objections will be held between August 17 and October 15.

'Must conduct NRC before Census': Manipur students protest, announce two-day strike

Leivon Jimmy
Imphal, August 17

THE 'CAMPAIGN for Just and Fair Delimitation (JFD) Student Wing' has announced a two-day general strike in Manipur from midnight on August 17, demanding implementation of NRC before the commencement of the Census exercise in the state.

The house-listing phase of Census 2027 is scheduled to begin with self-enumeration from August 17. The main house-listing operation is scheduled from September 1 to 30 this year.

The JFD, a conglomerate of civil bodies, is demanding a halt on any form of Census-related exercise until illegal immigrants are identified, using 1951 as the base cut-off year.

The strike comes amid growing protests in Imphal and across valley districts against preparations for Census. Students, market bodies and civil



Students clash with security personnel in Imphal on Monday. PTI

society organisations have opposed it and threatened to boycott the process.

The general strike has received support from several civil society organisations, including the United Meitei Naga Committee Manipur, Federation of Naga Civil Society (FNCC), Chandel Naga People's Organisation,

United Meitei Pangal Committee, and Native People's Committee Manipur.

The JFD has appealed to the public to extend support to the strike, aimed at mounting pressure on the authorities to conduct the NRC before the Census.

On Monday, many civil society bodies staged different

forms of protests at several locations across the Imphal valley. The agitation was particularly visible at Khwairamband Keithel, the state's largest commercial hub, which remained closed after the three women's markets held public meetings and shut down in support of the protest.

Tensions were also reported on the DM University campus, where students clashed with police while attempting to stop Census-related training at the DM College of Teacher Education and Hindi Teacher Training College. According to reports, at least two student protesters sustained injuries in an alleged police lathicharge.

Meanwhile, a large student rally began from Kwakeithel and proceeded towards Keisampat, with the procession continuing at the time of filing. Students chanted slogans opposing the Census exercise and called for its collective boycott.

CIVIL SOCIETY GROUPS TO CM: SEEK 3-MONTH S.I.R. EXTENSION

Karnataka SIR: Over 1 crore voters likely to be removed in draft rolls

Express News Service
Bengaluru, August 17

THE ENUMERATION phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka concluded Monday. A total of 1.08 crore voters are classified under the Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate and Other (ASDDO) list and are not likely to feature in the draft electoral rolls scheduled to be published on August 24.

Apart from voter deletions, 25.14 lakh other voters are likely to get notices under the 'No Mapping' category — those who failed to map themselves

or their lineage in the 2002 voters' rolls — during the next phase of SIR in the state.

According to data shared by Karnataka CEO Monday, enumeration forms for 80.46% of the mapped voters — totaling around 4.46 crore — are digitised. These voters will feature in the draft electoral roll.

Of those in the ASDDO list, around 11.84% (65.61 lakh voters) have permanently shifted, 2.96% (16.38 lakh) are dead, and 2.76% (15.28 lakh) are untraceable or absent.

Meanwhile, Eddelel Karnataka, a coalition of civil society groups, met Chief Minister D K

Shivakumar and submitted a petition noting that about half the names of Bengaluru voters would be removed from the draft rolls. "In nearly 3,000 booths in Karnataka, deletion rates exceed 60%," the organisations' petition stated.

The delegation was led by actor Prakash Raj, who had recently flagged that he was marked as shifted during the enumeration phase and alleged it was a ploy to delete voters. The group urged government to seek a three-month extension of SIR and urged it to approach the Supreme Court if necessary.

Ahead of 2027 Assembly poll battle in Uttarakhand, why BJP has set its sights on 23 seats it lost in 2022

Dhami to oversee preparations in Khatima, a seat he lost in 2022

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, August 17

THE BJP has tasked senior leaders with overseeing organisational work in the 23 Assembly constituencies it lost in the 2022 Uttarakhand elections, as part of a micro-management strategy aimed at strengthening the party ahead of the 2027 polls.

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, who lost his traditional Khatima seat in the 2022 elections, has been assigned the constituency. He will oversee the party's programmes there, assess the political situation and work towards creating a favourable atmosphere for the BJP ahead of the next Assembly elections.

The move comes amid concerns within the BJP over anti-

incumbency, particularly among Gen Z voters. The Congress had won 19 of the 23 seats the BJP lost in 2022, while the BSP and Independents won two seats each.

"These leaders will visit their assigned constituencies, assess the political situation, draw up strategies with local party leaders and create an atmosphere conducive to the BJP's victory in 2027," a senior BJP leader said.

The BJP won 47 of Uttarakhand's 70 seats in 2022 to retain power. Although Dhami lost Khatima, he was later elected from Champawat in a bypoll, allowing him to continue as CM.

"Khatima, Dhami's hometown, is also a constituency he frequently visits. He is familiar

with the people and can comfortably devote time to meeting them and addressing the issues of the public as well as BJP workers," the leader said.

BJP's central leadership will take a final call closer to the 2027 elections on whether Dhami contests from Khatima or Champawat. However, party insiders believe he should contest from Champawat, where he won after losing Khatima.

BJP state chief and Rajya Sabha MP Mahendra Bhatt has been assigned Piran Kaliyar, a Muslim-dominated seat in Haridwar district the party has never won. Congress's Furkan Ahmed has held the seat since 2012.

Another difficult constituency, Manglaur, has been assigned to RS MP and BJP na-



BJP will take a call closer to 2027 polls whether CM Pushkar Singh Dhami will contest from Khatima or Champawat. ANI FILE

tional co-treasurer Naresh Bansal. The seat, also Muslim-dominated, has so far been won by BSP and Congress.

Two constituencies that the BJP has never won — Chakrata and Dharchula — have been assigned to party general secretary Deepthi Rawat and senior leader Ganesh Bhandari, respectively.

Other senior leaders given charge of seats lost by BJP in-

clude Union MoS Ajay Tamta and former CMs Ramesh Pokhriyal Nishank, Trivendra Singh Rawat and Tirath Singh Rawat. Garhwal MP Anil Baluni has been assigned Badrinath, a seat which Bhatt lost in 2022.

BJP state general secretary Kundan Parihar, who has been assigned Haridwar Rural, said the exercise was aimed at strengthening the party at the grassroots level. "This is a micro-management exercise for these 23 seats. The leaders will tour their assigned constituencies, hold meetings with local leaders to strengthen the party at the polling booth level and assess the political equations and other challenges," Parihar said.

Under the plan, former CMs, ministers, MPs and other senior leaders will also be responsible for ensuring public participation in BJP programmes and campaigns in their assigned seats.

BJP's new social media head: Will ensure right info reaches Gen Z

THE BJP on Monday appointed **Deepak Mhaskey** as the party's new national social media convener, replacing Amit Malviya.

In an interview with **Jayprakash S Naidu**, Mhaskey speaks about his role and his plans for the party, among other issues. Excerpts:

What would be your main focus as BJP's national social media convener?

My focus will be to tackle the fake narrative spread by the Opposition, which uses AI in reels to twist facts and mislead people. We have been creating positive content and taking it to people. I will try and add momentum to this.

You replace Amit Malviya, who held the post for over a decade. What would you like to do differently?

I have worked under him and served as the coordinator for Chhattisgarh. I have learnt a lot from him. I spoke to him today and sought his guidance on how to take his work forward. I hope to take this battle forward and give our work new dimensions.

Malviya was very active on social media. How will your approach be?

Every person has their own style. He had his own approach. I will follow things I have learnt from him but you will also see my way of functioning.

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protests seem to have dented the party and similar agitations may happen closer to elections. How do you plan to handle them?

Giving responses to protests is a normal part of political dis-



course. We will deal with issues as and when they arise. As I said earlier, we will make efforts to prevent the spread of fake information and narratives.

Do you have any Gen Z-specific strategy?

We have a meeting on August 22, where we will get instructions. We will plan our strategy accordingly. I will ensure the right information reaches Gen Z.

Every state has its own way to communicate. We need to make use of different social media platforms. We will plan campaigns accordingly.

Will state party units have the power to post content or will information flow be controlled centrally under your leadership?

Both the centre as well as state units have their own roles. We will work in tandem.

Do you think state units should have more power?

In BJP, it is not about power. We work in coordination and our roles are decided by the party leadership.

Do you see any weaknesses in the BJP's social media cell?

There are no weaknesses.

Will try to know the mind of youth and mobilise their energy, says new BJYM chief

Aditi Raja & Jatin Anand
Vadodara, New Delhi, August 17

BJP'S FIRST-TIME MP from Vadodara, Hemang Joshi, who was appointed the national president of Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha (BJYM) on Monday, plans to take the party's youth outreach beyond conventional political messaging, focusing on the concerns of Gen Z, social media narratives, and direct engagement ahead of the 2029 Lok Sabha elections.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* after his appointment, Joshi said: "We have to keep the youth away from negative narratives and take them closer to the path of Viksit Bharat envisioned by Prime Minister Narendra Modi."

He said the need is to understand the "game of narratives in the era of social media" and "how we set up a narrative".

In 2024, when he was 33, Joshi replaced two-time MP Ranjanben Bhatt from Vadodara, a constituency that Prime Minister Narendra Modi won in 2014.

A former vice-chairman of the Vadodara Municipal Corporation's school board, Joshi is a physiotherapist and also has a Master's degree in human resource management. He is believed to be close to BJP's national leaders as well as the RSS.

Joshi said his priority would be to "break barriers that seem to exist between national leaders and ground karyakartas". "I will try to know the mind of the youth. For this, we will need to interact with them by breaking protocols, if needed. I aim to mobilise youth energy ... to change the scenario rather than just focussing on the negativity," he added. He said connecting with the young people when they have concerns and relaying the "feedback from the



Vadodara MP Hemang Joshi

Hemang Joshi said his priority would be to 'break barriers that seem to exist between national leaders and ground karyakartas'

ground to the leadership in a timely manner" is imperative.

Joshi, who is a known Rahul Gandhi baiter on social media as well as in Parliament, said: "If we recall Rahul Gandhi's younger days... he wore kurta-pyjama... now when he is older, he dresses in T-shirts to woo the youngsters... Our outreach, however, will be genuine to address the concerns of the youth."

Joshi, who was appointed Gujarat president of the BJYM in December last year, said he would resign from the state post and "work as a karyakarta in the state" once the decision on his successor is taken.

Joshi also has a distinguished image in terms of international exposure. He represented India at the inaugural BRICS Cultural Forum in 2024 in Russia and 2nd BRICS Traditional Values Forum in Brazil in 2025.

As a member of an all-party parliamentary delegation, he visited various countries for diplomatic outreach in the aftermath of Operation Sindoor in May 2025.



'Black money compromises democracy': SC orders speedy probes, trials

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, August 17

OBSERVING THAT black money in the electoral process compromises democracy, rule of law and the process itself, the Supreme Court on Monday strongly batted for timely probes and conclusion of criminal cases relating to recovery of ill-gotten money during the elections in the country.

Issuing a slew of directions, a bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N K Singh said, "Black money in the electoral process i.e. the issue with which we are herein concerned, is one such aspect that compromises democracy, rule of law and the electoral process itself," the bench said.

The order was passed by the bench on a plea filed by Karnataka government related to the 2014 Lok Sabha polls, where large scale of black money was seized during elections in Belary district.

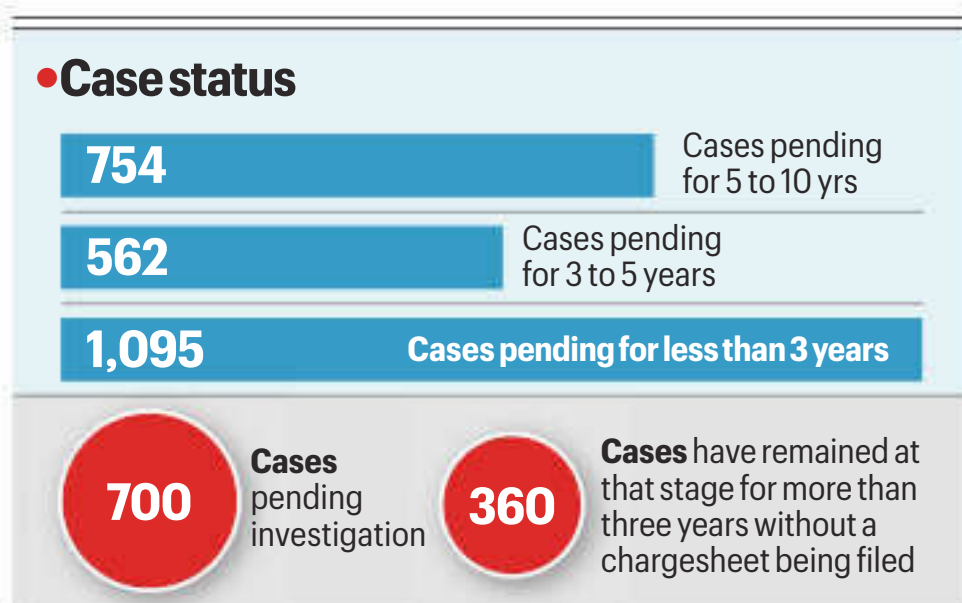
Over 4,000 cases pending against MPs, MLAs: Amicus curiae to SC

Vineet Bhalla
New Delhi, August 17

A TOTAL of 4,192 cases against sitting and former MPs and MLAs are pending trial across the country with 519 cases pending for more than a decade, according to a report submitted before the Supreme Court by Senior Advocate Vijay Hansaria, appointed amicus curiae in a PIL seeking expeditious disposal of criminal cases against MPs and MLAs.

Another 700 cases are pending investigation while 360 have remained at that stage for more than three years without a chargesheet being filed.

The figures form part of Hansaria's 22nd Amicus report. It notes that the 4,192 figure is based on information received from High Courts and their websites; the Allahabad High Court did not submit a report and its figure of 1,171 cases is from its website as of Febru-



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ary 2024. The High Court websites, in total, show 4,442 pending cases.

The report states that Chief Ministers of 14 of 28 states have criminal cases against them pending trials. Telangana CMA Revanth Reddy faces the highest number of cases at 89, followed by West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari (29), Karnataka CM D K Shivakumar, Andhra Pradesh CM N Chandrababu Naidu (both 19) and Kerala CM V D Satheesan (18).

ember 2018 to 5,140 in November 2022 before settling at 4,192 in July 2026.

In 2017, the Supreme Court ordered the setting up of 12 special courts in 10 states, UTs for speedy trials in criminal cases involving legislators. In December 2018, it directed that one designated Sessions Court and one designated Magisterial Court be identified in every district to try cases on priority.

In November 2023, the SC directed the Chief Justices of all HCs to register suo motu cases to monitor the early disposal of such cases and empowered special benches to issue directions for expeditious trials.

The matter was referred to a three-judge Bench in February 2025 after the previous amicus report highlighted the absence of effective monitoring by most HCs. It has been listed for hearing before the three-judge Bench on August 18.

Hansaria said that despite top court's directions, the pendency had remained at roughly

the same level and attributed the delay to designated courts being burdened with regular judicial work, repeated adjournments, non-appearance of accused persons, delays in securing witnesses and inadequate monitoring by High Courts.

The amicus recommended that designated courts exclusively conduct trials involving lawmakers until their backlog is cleared; that cases pending for more than 3 years be heard day-to-day; and that courts issue NBWs where an accused lawmaker fails to appear on two consecutive dates. The report also proposes a nodal prosecution officer for securing witnesses and requiring real-time uploading of case data and order sheets on HC websites.

He has also sought that trials be completed within one year of framing of charges, monthly monitoring by HCs of cases pending for more than 3 years and "micro-monitoring" of individual delayed cases.

BRIEFLY



Firefighters douse the blaze that broke out in the basement of Aayakar Bhavan, the Income Tax office in Mumbai. GANESH SHIRSEKAR

MAHARASHTRA

1,500 evacuated, 29 rescued from fire at Aayakar Bhavan in Mumbai

A FIRE broke out in the basement of Aayakar Bhavan in Churchgate that serves as the headquarter of the Income Tax department in Mumbai on Monday, leading to a major evacuation of around 1,500 people from the seven-storey building. "Nearly 1,500 people were present and all were evacuated quickly... 29 people were left stranded for some time because of the smoke..." a senior Mumbai Fire Brigade official said. According to officials, the fire broke out at 1.57 pm in the basement storage cabins near Churchgate station. ENS

Prayagraj: Three Kanwariyas die in road accident

THREE KANWARIYAS died in Prayagraj, after their speeding motorcycle collided with an auto-rickshaw, police said on Monday. DCP (Ganga Nagar) Kuldeep Gunawat said Shiv Prakash, a Tharwai resident, died on the spot while Ashok Kumar from Phaphamau, and Lallu were rushed to SRN Hospital, where they died during treatment. According to police, the motorcycle's high speed and slippery road conditions following rain caused the accident, causing the two-wheeler to skid and hit the auto-rickshaw. CM Yogi Adityanath took cognisance of the accident and expressed condolences to the bereaved families. PTI

Man, toddler die in roof collapse due to rain in UP

A 25-YEAR-OLD man and his three-year-old nephew died after being buried under the debris of a collapsed house roof in Shahjahanpur district of Uttar Pradesh, amidst relentless rainfall since Sunday night, police said. A woman was also critically injured in the incident, which occurred on Monday morning. Circle Officer (Poyawan) Pravin Malik said in Mudiya Kurmiyat village, a 'kutcha' house was built next to the one whose roof collapsed. The height of the 'kutcha' house exceeded that of the pucca house. Due to the rain, the 'kutcha' house fell on the pucca house's roof as it had no iron beam to support it. PTI

Kharge targets BJP, RSS: 'Which of your leaders fought for Independence?'

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, August 17

AMID THE controversy over the rendition of *Vande Mataram* at an Independence Day event, Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge on Monday hit out at the BJP and the RSS, calling them "anti-India" and questioned their role in India's freedom struggle.

Addressing the Congress convention of booth-level agents and workers in South Goa's Verna, Kharge said it was the Congress which fought for the freedom of the country. "Which BJP or RSS leader fought for Independence? And you teach us patriotism? [They say] we are anti-India. You are anti-India... you are anti-religion," he said. "You are anti-religion because when a person like me goes to Uttarakhand and gives a speech before lakhs of people... you do a 'purification' through a 'havan' two days later. Is it not a shame on this country? Your religion teaches this? Your Gurus... they teach this? Where is your (M S) Golwalkar Guruji? Where are the teachers... who taught you? Have they taught only this? *Paapi log toh aap hain, apka pehle shuddhikaran hona chahiye* [You are the sinners, you must be 'purified' first]," he said.

A political row had erupted on Sunday after Union Home Minister Amit Shah accused Congress leader Sonia Gandhi of attempting to stop the full rendition of *Vande Mataram* at the party headquarters on Independence Day and said the party should apologise to the nation. The Congress denied the charge and defended its leader, stressing that the full rendition of *Vande Mataram* was sung at the function.

Kharge said Congress leaders like Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru had devoted their lives to the freedom struggle. He said the BJP and RSS did not fight for independence and instead wrote



AICC President Mallikarjun Kharge addresses a public meeting in Goa on Monday. ANI

letters to the British, pledging their support. "They were slaves of the British. What does history say? You... from the BJP or whoever from the RSS... wrote letters to the British, saying we are in your support. What did we [Congress] say? 'Do or die'. This was Mahatma Gandhi's voice. Your voice was... *maafi maangna* [to apologise]. *Ye maafi sarkaaren hein* [these are apology governments]," he said.

Referring to Goa Congress leaders, who switched over to the BJP in the recent past, Kharge said, "Our people won with a big majority in Goa the previous time, but some people defected... Today, out of 12 ministers [in the Cabinet], 10 are from the Congress. Do not vote for these gaddars [traitors]."

Slamming the BJP for "stealing MLAs" and "engineering" defections, Kharge said the BJP government in Goa is a "government of thieves." He said, "The Congress should have formed the government here. But they [BJP] formed the government 'tod-fod ke' [through defections]. So, what should I call it? And these people will teach us morality?"

Navy to lease two new MQ-9B Sea Guardian unmanned aircraft from US firm

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, August 17

THE MINISTRY of Defence on Monday inked a Rs 1,943-crore contract with American defence major General Atomics Aeronautical to lease two MQ-9B Sea Guardian High-Altitude Long-Endurance (HALE) Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS) for the Indian Navy for 30 months.

In a statement, the Defence ministry said the contract was signed in the presence of A Anbarasu, Additional Secretary and Director General (Acquisition), Department of Defence. It said the MQ-9B Sea Guardian HALE RPAS, equipped with advanced systems, state-of-the-art sensors and sophisticated payloads, will significantly enhance the Indian Navy's Maritime Domain Awareness capabilities.

"The systems will provide persistent intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance coverage over vast areas of the maritime domain, strengthening India's ability to monitor and respond to developments across the Indian Ocean Region," it added.

In December last year, the Ministry of Defence approved the leasing of HALE RPAS for the Navy. Currently, the Navy operates two MQ9As on lease, which were procured in 2020 in the thick of border tensions between India and China for a period of one year, and their

lease period was subsequently extended.

With the addition of two new high-altitude long-endurance systems, the Navy's inventory will increase to four units. This expansion will provide a greater operational coverage for the Navy in both the eastern and western regions. Until now, the limited number of just two HALE RPAS restricted simultaneous coverage of both fronts.

It is learnt that while the lease of the existing RPAS will expire after a certain period, the leases of the two new RPAS will continue until deliveries of the 31 MQ-9B HALE RPAS begin. It is further learnt that the new RPAS will have almost the same configuration as the 31 MQ-9Bs which are being procured, as against the existing HALE RPAS.

In 2024, India and the United States inked a deal of around \$3.5 billion or over Rs 28,000 crore to procure 31 MQ-9B HALE RPAS for the Indian armed forces. Apart from ISR roles, they can also carry out precision strikes on strategic targets in mountains and the maritime domain during long-endurance missions.

A global MRO facility will be set up in India under contract with General Atomics to assemble some of the MQ-9Bs in India to support India's long-term goals to boost indigenous defence capabilities. A certain percentage of the components for the drones will be sourced indigenously.



Nepal honours Army Chief

Nepal President Ram Chandra Paudel (right) confers the honorary rank of General of the Nepali Army upon Indian Army Chief General Dhiraj Sethi in Kathmandu on Monday. PTI

Over 80 FIRs, 253 arrests made in pan-India crackdown on Shahzad Bhatti Network: MHA

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, August 17

SECURITY AGENCIES have busted an alleged terror syndicate linked to the Pakistan-based Shahzad Bhatti Network (SBN), detaining 253 people across 14 states ahead of Independence Day, officials said on Monday.

Officials claimed the recoveries point to direct cross-border links. The recoveries allegedly include IEDs, grenades bearing Pakistan Ordnance Factory markings, pistols, live cartridges and CCTV cameras said

to have been used for espionage.

"The operation carried out on August 12 with state police forces was aimed at preventing alleged SBN-linked disruptions and subversive attacks around Independence Day. The action was coordinated through a real-time intelligence-sharing system and led to fresh FIRs in Delhi and Karnataka," a MHA spokesperson said.

According to officials, the crackdown led to 62 detentions in Uttar Pradesh, 52 in Haryana, 51 in Delhi, 44 in Punjab, 15 in Rajasthan, eight in Maharashtra,

five in Uttarakhand, three each in Karnataka, Gujarat and Bihar, and two each in Telangana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Kerala.

"More than 80 FIRs and over 200 arrests have been recorded against SBN members and alleged associates under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Arms Act, Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, and the Explosive Substances Act," the spokesperson said.

The Shahzad Bhatti Network is alleged to be a Pakistan-

based, ISI-backed terror syndicate linked to grenade, IED and petrol bomb attacks, targeted killings and surveillance of police, defence and religious sites.

Officials said Bhatti has been accused of using social media to lure youngsters and has been linked to the March 2024 grenade attack at the residence of YouTuber Rozer Sandhu in Jalandhar, Punjab. He has also been accused of threatening Mithun Chakraborty in November 2024 over the actor's purported remarks against Muslims.

After January launch vehicle debacle, GISAT-1A take-off in September to end ISRO's seven-month operational hiatus

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, August 17

AFTER A SEVEN-MONTH hiatus, the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) is set to resume its launch services, with the earth observation satellite GISAT-1A set to be launched in the first week of September.

This is one of two satellites — the other being NVS-03 — that has remained parked at Sriharikota spaceport for months as launches were put on hold following a series of setbacks, said officials in the know.

Indeed, three of the six missions that ISRO undertook in 2025 and 2026 saw the satellites not reaching the intended orbits due to anomalies in the launch vehicle or spacecraft engine.

GISAT-1A or Geo Imaging Satellite — also referred to as EOS-05 under the new nomenclature — is a replacement satellite for the 2021-launched GISAT-1 (or EOS-03), which missed the orbit after the final propulsive segment of the rocket failed to ignite.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029vAn2Rb6RGjOKH6oBd0F>

The new satellite, GISAT-1A, which boasts a 10-year mission life, is designed to image large areas of interest at frequent intervals for the purposes of monitoring natural disasters or keeping a track of agriculture or forestry.

Meanwhile, NVS-03 — fuelled and ready at Sriharikota — is likely to be launched in November, officials said.

The space agency undertook just one launch this year.

On January 12, ISRO's workhorse launch vehicle, Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV), was set to place an Earth observation satellite in orbit as part of the ISRO PSLV-C62 / EOS-N1 mission.

However, the mission failed reportedly due to an "anomaly" in the third stage of the rocket. The findings of the Failure Analysis Committee which probed the incident has not been made public yet.

In 2025, ISRO undertook five launches. This included one mission wherein PSLV-C61 was set to put in orbit the Earth observation satellite EOS-9.



The launch of PSLV-C62/EOS-N1 had failed in January reportedly due to an "anomaly". ANI

Again, the mission failed because of yet another "anomaly" in the third stage.

The space agency has maintained that the two anomalies were unrelated. However, no failure analysis report has been made public for this mission either. Then, there were two launches via the Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV).

The first was the GSLV-F16-enabled launch of a NISAR satellite developed in collaboration with NASA, which was successful. However, the second launch — of NVS-02 using GSLV-F15 — missed delivering the satellite to its destination after the orbit-raising manoeuvres failed.

Though the GSLV-F15 functioned normally, the findings of

the analysis report have not been made public.

There were also two Launch Vehicle Mark-3 (LVM3)-enabled launches — of communication satellites Bluebird-2 and CMS-03.

These launch numbers fare poorly against the 15-mission target set by the space agency in 2025-26 and 27 in FY 2026-27 as per the recent ISRO annual report. The space agency counts the launch vehicle and satellite as separate missions. But even then, the numbers fall short.

ISRO had planned to place in orbit in 2025-26 at least four Earth observation satellites, one communication satellite, one technology demonstrator, and three (launches and spacecraft missions) under Gaganyaan programme. It had also planned for at least two PSLV, GSLV and LVM3 missions each.

For 2026-27, the space agency had set an ambitious target of at least five flights of its newly developed SSLV. This would be in addition to four PSLV, three GSLV, and one LVM3 missions. Under Gaga-

nyaan programme, it had planned at least four missions (both spacecraft and launch vehicle).

After losing NSV-02, the launch of the next satellite in the series is extremely important considering India's navigation constellation can no longer provide navigation data independently.

"...Presently, the NavIC constellation has three satellites for providing PNT (Positioning, Navigation, Timing) services — IRNSS-1B, IRNSS-1I and NVS-01. To provide basic positioning service, a minimum of four operational satellites are required in orbit. Hence, the NavIC constellation cannot provide standalone positioning service, however timing service is functional," Union Minister of State for Space, Dr Jitendra Singh, said in a Parliament reply.

Singh further stated that the armed forces continue to use NavIC signals alongside data from the US's GPS, the EU's Galileo, and Russia's GLONASS as part of a multi-constellation navigation setup.

Vande Mataram ‘disruption’: Advocate files complaint against Sonia and Rahul

Alok Singh
New Delhi, August 17

A SUPREME COURT advocate has filed a complaint against Congress leaders Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi over an alleged incident involving the disruption of the national song during an I-Day function.

The complaint, filed by advocate Subh Sharma, alleged that during the rendition of ‘Vande Mataram’, Sonia Gandhi made gestures that appeared to indicate an objection to the song being continued.

DCP (Central) Rohit Rajbir Monday said they are inquiring into the complaint regarding the alleged incident at the All India Congress Committee (AICC) headquarters on August 15. The complaint was received at the I P Estate Police Station on Sunday evening.

Sharma has sought an investigation into the matter and the registration of an FIR against the two Congress leaders.

The complaint further alleged that in another video, Rahul Gandhi can be seen speaking the words, “We are not singing Vande Mataram.”

The statement, when viewed in the context of the ongoing rendition of the National Song and the conduct attributed to Sonia Gandhi, raises concerns regarding the alleged intention and conduct of both leaders towards ‘Vande Mataram’ and its dignity, the complaint said.

8 killed in West Bengal hotel fire as locked emergency exit traps guests

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, August 17

EIGHT PEOPLE, including five tourists from Meghalaya, were killed after a massive fire broke out at a four-storey hotel in Tarapith in West Bengal’s Birbhum district early Monday morning. Three of the deceased were from Alipurduar in West Bengal.

Police detained one person for alleged lapses in the maintenance of the hotel’s fire-fighting system, officials said.

Although the hotel had a rear exit and an emergency staircase, the grilles to the emergency exit were locked, they said, adding that the locks had to be broken to rescue those trapped inside.

The personnel further said the door leading to the terrace was also locked, hampering rescue operations.

Police said 28 people have been rescued from the hotel and admitted to various hospitals. The cause of the blaze has not been determined yet, although police suspect a short circuit. The owner of the hotel has been detained.

According to local residents, the fire started around 4.30 am in the reception area of Hotel Bideshini, rapidly engulfing the entire ground floor before thick smoke spread to the upper levels. They said the fire spread quickly due to false ceilings and fibre panelling of the interiors.



A forensic team visits the site in Tarapith, Birbhum district, on Monday ANI

The hotel, located a stone’s throw from the Tarapith Temple, was packed with tourists due to the holy month of Shraavan.

Fire officials said the victims were likely sleeping when the blaze started. A detailed post-mortem examination will be conducted to determine the exact cause of the fire and resultant deaths. The injured guests, some suffering from burn injuries, were rushed to the Rampurhat Government Medical College and Hospital.

Minister of State for Fire and Emergency Services, Koushik

Chowdhury, said, “According to the information I have, a hotel caught fire early this morning. I am in touch with the Chief Minister (Suvendu Adhikari), who is receiving regular updates. A detailed investigation will be conducted, and we will take stern action.”

Speaking to the media, Superintendent of Police Vidit Raj Bhundesh said the police and fire brigade rescued 11 people. “We are continuing our investigation... We will take stern action. We observed that some fire safety measures, including handheld fire extin-

guishers, were in place,” he said, adding that a forensic team has been called to investigate the matter.

Samarjit Paul, one of the guests, said, “We were on the ground floor when we suddenly heard a commotion... As we opened the door, the heat of the flames hit us. We quickly closed the door, switched off all the lights and fans, rushed to the balcony, and hopped out.”

Another guest staying on the first floor said, “We woke up to people shouting and screaming and saw a lot of smoke. We could hardly see anything. My

husband and I quickly grabbed our children and headed to the balcony. My husband climbed down the parapet (holding on to a tree), I handed over the children to him, and then I climbed down. It was very scary.”

Fire brigade officers on the scene said that a short circuit is preliminarily suspected as the cause, though a full investigation will be conducted.

The hotel has been sealed. Outside, several guests who escaped were seen searching for missing relatives.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi said in a social media post that he was “anguished to hear about the loss of lives due to a fire tragedy in Birbhum”.

He has announced compensation of Rs 2 lakh to the families of those killed in the fire and Rs 50,000 for those injured.

In the wake of the fire tragedy and ahead of the Kaushiki Amavasya festival, which draws thousands of pilgrims to Tarapith, the West Bengal government has formed a multi-departmental Special Audit Committee to inspect all local commercial accommodations.

The committee will audit fire safety compliance, electrical installations, and the availability of emergency exits across all hotels, lodges, and homestays.

Sub-divisional officer (SDO) of Rampurhat will be the committee’s chairperson.



An ambulance arrives at a hospital following a stampede in Bihar's Lakhisarai on Monday. PTI

Bihar: 7 killed, 25 injured as panic over electric pole triggers stampede at temple

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, August 17

BY THE time the stampede occurred at 6:40 am, Manmala Devi and her daughter had already been standing in the long queue at the Ashok Dham temple for over an hour, awaiting their turn. A regular at the temple, Manmala visited on the first and second Mondays of the ongoing Hindu month of Sawan.

“A large number of devotees got down after the train stopped and began entering the queue, increasing the pressure. It was then that the stampede broke out,” she said.

A 44-year-old resident of Barahiya, some 12 km away, Manmala fainted and was killed in the crush, while Pallavi sustained minor injuries. Manmala was one of seven people killed in a stampede near Ashok Dham Halt in Bihar’s Lakhisarai district on Monday morning, where a large number of devotees had gathered on the third Monday of Sawan. All seven deceased were women, officials said.

especially for the temple’s devotees.

“The temple gates opened at 2.55 am, and while the initial crowds were manageable, it grew. When the rumour spread, it created additional pressure within seconds,” the official said.

According to officials, the spread of the rumour led to barricades being broken. Besides Manmala Devi, the other deceased women have been identified as Rinku Devi, 50, of Safiasarai in Munger; Hemlata Devi, 55, Lalita Devi, 50, and Savita Devi, 35, all of Pratappur in Halsi; Saroj Devi, 65, of Bakawan in Patna; and Savitri Devi, 48, of Chananian in Lakhisarai. Three women are critically injured and have been moved to Patna Medical College and Hospital.

Relatives questioned crowd-management arrangements at the temple. There was a huge crowd because it was the third Monday of Sawan, and the administration should have made arrangements accordingly and increased its deployment,” Manmala’s relative said.

The district administration said Rs 4 lakh in ex-gratia compensation had been paid to the families of each deceased person, and arrangements had been made for the treatment of the injured.

A three-member inquiry committee has been set up to investigate the incident, officials said.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and former CM Nitish Kumar expressed grief over the incident through social media posts. In his post on X, Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary described the incident at Ashok Dham as “extremely sad and heart-rending” and said he was deeply distressed by reports of devotees being killed in the accident.

Meanwhile, Leader of the Opposition in the Bihar Assembly and national working president of the RJD Tejashwi Yadav blamed the incident on inadequate security arrangements and crowd management, saying it reflected the “administrative mismanagement” of the NDA government.

WEST BENGAL ANNAPURNA YOJANA 10L out of 17L rejected applicants for cash transfer scheme have Aadhaar issues: Govt

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, August 17

AFTER VERIFICATION, names of around 17 lakh applicants for the Annapurna Yojana were rejected over Aadhaar-related issues ahead of the disbursement of the third tranche of funds for the direct cash transfer scheme for women, the government said on Monday.

The information was shared at a press meet by Minister of State for Health Sumana Sarkar, Minister of State for Information and Cultural Affairs Purnima Chakraborty and Secretary of the Women and Child Development Department, Moumita Godara at Nabanna.

The government will be disbursing the third installment between August 17 and 20 to the bank accounts of 1.45 crore beneficiaries out of 1.62 crore applicants and Rs 4,350 crore has been allocated for this purpose.

According to sources at Nabanna, the primary reason for the rejection of names was the non-linking of bank accounts with Aadhaar. Out of the 17 lakh rejected cases, around 10 lakh

were due to this Aadhaar-related issues. Additionally, several applications were turned down because the applicant or a family member holds a government job, or because records showed they pay income tax.

The sources added that verification of documents is underway for those who applied between July 11 and July 31, and the process will go on till September 30.

To resolve the Aadhaar and bank account linking issues easily, Nabanna has issued special instructions to Block Development Officers (BDOs) to coordinate with bank authorities and organise special camps.

Rejected applicants can re-apply by accessing the ‘Social Register’ option on the government portal, where the renewal window will open on August 20. Anyone with grievances or objections regarding the rejection can also lodge a complaint directly through the same portal. Those wishing to submit fresh applications will need to wait till September 30, sources said.

SC tells HC to defer Rahul assets case, asks CBI and ED not to submit report

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, August 17

THE SUPREME COURT on Monday asked the Allahabad High Court to defer proceedings in a plea seeking a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and Enforcement Directorate (ED) into allegations of disproportionate assets against Rahul Gandhi.

A three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant also asked the CBI and ED not to submit any report to the HC in the interim.

“Police or any other agency, if they have any prima facie evidence, they can register a case, they can proceed against anyone. They don’t need permission from accused. But if the court wants to issue a direction, they are expected to follow the principles of natural justice,” the CJI said.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing Gandhi’s appeal challenging the HC order.

The proceedings before the Allahabad HC originated on a complaint filed by a Karnataka resident, S Vignesh Shishir.

“It is expected that if the complaint of the petitioner has been received, the allegations of the complaints may be verified as per law. It is needless to say that the CBI or ED may take appropriate steps which are permissible under the law,” the HC had said in May.

Appearing for Gandhi, Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal said what was happening was “unknown to law... and a witch-hunt through a process not recognised by law”.

Questioning Shishir’s locus standi and bona fides, Sibal said

he had not disclosed his credentials. He submitted that Shishir is an RSS worker who files petitions against Gandhi repeatedly.

Appearing for the CBI, Senior Advocate S V Raju said the agency “has done nothing except for verifying the complaint”, adding that “if correct, (these are) serious allegations”.

“I am only on the facts, facts may be right, facts may be wrong, but if the facts are right, it’s a gross case of disproportionate assets,” Raju said.

Have you done it (looking into the allegations) suo motu,” Justice Bagchi asked Raju. As Raju answered in the negative, Justice Bagchi said, “then let us examine the correctness of this order”.

Raju said the agency would not oppose Sibal’s submissions if it was a frivolous complaint.

“If it’s so serious, why has your agency kept quiet? Do you require impetus from the court? Your agencies have statutory powers,” Justice Bagchi observed.

Sibal also questioned how the proceedings before the HC, which happened in-chamber, appeared in the media. “These are sealed cover procedures, how do newspaper reports happen?”

Shishir, who appeared online, responding to a query from the bench said, he had not received a copy of the paper book (case documents) to oppose Gandhi’s plea, and urged the court to supply him the documents and fix a date for hearing the case.

The court issued notices to the respondents and directed that the documents be supplied to Shishir so that he can also be heard on the next date of hearing.

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, August 17

EARLIER THIS year, Goa Police intercepted a consignment of hashish being smuggled into the state.

More than the act of smuggling, though, it was the mode through which the contraband was being transported into the state that left the police worried. The hashish packets were found concealed in the bottom of a steam iron, which was posted in a package being delivered at the hands of an unsuspecting driver.

Concerned at the possibility of many more such cases, the Goa Police have decided to take the assistance of courier and postal service providers besides delivery partners to curb drug trafficking in the coastal state.

The initiative is part of a broader three-year roadmap as part of ‘Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyan’.

Senior police officers recently held an awareness meeting with at least 75 representatives from courier and postal service providers across Goa.

During the meeting, the anti-narcotics cell informed the operators about an emerging technique among traffickers to conceal consignments, especially to smuggle cannabis and hashish, in small courier parcels and through the postal services network.

‘Dead-drop method’

The police noticed that increasingly traffickers have been using a “dead-drops” delivery method to smuggle narcotics. After the buyer transfers money to the seller, they are sent coordinates of a particular location to retrieve the drugs from a rider. The drugs are often ferried by unsuspecting courier delivery partners, who are under the impression that they are handing over a legitimate parcel.

The aim of the awareness meeting was to sensitise the courier and postal service operators about common concealment methods used by traffickers and to look for “suspicious consignments”, especially the ones with pseudonymous bookings, incomplete sender or receiver details, unusual packaging, and high-value parcels with inconsistent declarations.

“Courier and postal service providers are key stakeholders to prevent the misuse of their services by drug traffickers. We flagged the importance of proactive vigilance, strict adherence to KYC norms, verification of consignor and consignee details of parcels, and timely reporting of suspicious consignments to law enforcement agencies,” said a senior police official, requesting anonymity.

Advantage anonymity

“This ‘drop-dead’ method has become quite popular due to the relative anonymity it



allows the traffickers. The courier service operators, in a way, end up unknowingly facilitating the transportation of narcotics,” the police officer added.

According to an analysis by anti-narcotics cell, which was shared at a zonal coordination meeting earlier this month, the most commonly seized drugs in Goa include ganja, charas, LSD, MDMA/ecstasy and cocaine.

Though cocaine is smuggled internationally and makes its way to Goa through other states like Delhi and Karnataka, cannabis (ganja) is trafficked here from Jharkhand and Odisha, according to police analysis. Charas is trafficked to Goa from Himachal Pradesh and Nepal while LSD largely makes its way into Goa from Kerala. Methamphetamine is sourced from Kerala and Bengaluru and ecstasy/MDMA is trafficked to Goa from Kerala, Maharashtra and Delhi.

A similar assessment in 2023 found that cocaine is sourced from South American countries and makes its way to Goa via the sea route, primarily through shipping containers. LSD paper is brought in flights, concealed in books in luggage while hashish (charas) is trafficked to Goa from Himachal and other north Indian states besides Nepal through rail route and via bus.

According to the police presentation, offenders use discreet methods for procurement, storage and distribution of drugs. “Social media platforms, courier services, rented premises, tourist gatherings, and nightlife events are sometimes misused for drug circulation. Coastal belts, tourist areas, nightlife zones, and party locations remain vulnerable to drug-related activities,” the report stated.



Goa Police has now created a WhatsApp group for coordination with courier service operators. FILE

Rise in cases

In 2023, Goa police arrested 166 people, including 21 foreign nationals, and registered 140 cases for smuggling narcotics. The number of arrests increased to 192 in 2024 and 213 in 2025. Cases lodged also went up to 162 and 163 in 2024 and 2025, respectively. Until August 12, 2026, 135 people have been arrested and at least 122 cases registered.

Police said the road map to end drug-trafficking involves four pillars: Enforcement, intelligence and operations; precursors and synthetic drugs control; demand and harm reduction; and capacity building and coordination. “We have created a WhatsApp group for coordination with courier service operators and some delivery partners. If they spot any suspicious parcel, especially near schools and clubs in the coastal belt, we have asked them to report to police. The idea is also to identify new patterns and get to the source. A challenge we face is there is no regulatory framework overseeing private courier services,” the police officer said.

At 85, ex-UP cop who refused to give up on promotion finally gets his due

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, August 17

FOR 25 years, a former police sub-inspector refused to let a promotion denied to him at the end of his career become a forgotten grievance.

Ram Autar Singh Yadav pursued the case through the police, the State Public Services Tribunal and finally the Allahabad High Court, travelling more than 450 km from his hometown in Etawah to appear in person in court.

The 85-year-old has now finally won the case, earning the promotion to the post of inspector.

Stating that the petitioner was treated “unfairly”, the High Court has directed the Uttar Pradesh government and the Director General of Police (DGP) to give Yadav the benefits of the rank of an Inspector with effect from 1980.

A division bench of Justices Arindam Sinha and Satya Veer Singh, in its judgment delivered and uploaded on August 4 and 10, respectively, directed to release the petitioner’s promotional salary and benefits from March 16, 1980, till the date of his retirement. It said corresponding retiral benefits must also be given to him within four weeks.



Ram Autar Singh Yadav

In 1999, Yadav retired from service as a Station Officer (SO). He had filed a representation before top officials, including the DGP, during his service period

after his batchmates got a promotion and he was rejected.

In his April 2010 order, the DGP rejected Yadav’s claim, citing adverse remarks in his confidential reports and a previous censure. This order noted that Yadav had been punished five times and adverse remarks were mentioned seven times.

According to Yadav’s petition, he petitioned the State Public Services Tribunal in Lucknow. His claim was dismissed in November 2012. His review petition, too, was dismissed the next year.

He then challenged the Tribunal’s decision in the HC. But his writ petition was dis-

missed for non-prosecution in February 2015.

Yadav made an application for restoration, which was also dismissed for want of prosecution by a co-ordinate bench in December 2025.

The present application was filed for recall of the December order. The petitioner submitted before the court that the adverse remarks, as cited by the DGP in its 2010 order, were never communicated to him.

After hearing the submissions, the High Court bench stated in its order, “The Tribunal appears to have lost sight that a fact can be proved, while the negative cannot. It was up

to the department to demonstrate communication...”

“The Petitioner saying he [was] not communicated the adverse entries of many years could not be called upon to prove the negative. The Tribunal, obviously, erred in review of its earlier judgment based on the adverse entries, where the department had not resisted the case,” the court said.

Issuing directions to pay the petitioner the salary and other remunerations since 1980 and give him all the benefits of the Inspector rank, the bench stated, “We are convinced that the petitioner was treated unfairly.”

FIR filed after Dalits allege they were forced off chairs at Rajasthan school I-Day function

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, August 17

THE RAJASTHAN Police have lodged an FIR after some Dalits were allegedly asked to vacate their chairs during an Independence Day function at a school in Bhillwara.

The FIR was lodged following a complaint by Rameshwarlal Bairwa, 35, and Gopilal Bairwa, 37, who alleged that the incident occurred at an Independence Day function at the government school in their village, Bhakliya, on August 15.

"We were sitting on the chairs placed there during the programme when some people approached us and discriminated against us because of our caste," the Bairwas alleged. They said they were abused "using caste-based slurs by the people, who, in a highly insulting tone, said: 'You Bairwas, sit down

below [on the floor]. If you sit on the chairs, where will we sit? What right do you have to sit in front of us?"

They allege they were intimidated and forced to vacate the chairs, claiming there were threats to shut down the Anganwadi where two women from their group worked. They allege the incident happened in front of schoolchildren, teachers and villagers, "causing us mental trauma and deeply hurting our self-respect and social standing".

Talking to *The Indian Express*, Rameshwarlal said: "The entire case is that we sat on chairs. Every year, all of us sit on the ground. But this time, there were chairs and the teacher invited us to sit on them which led to some people objecting to us, saying that we can't sit with them." Bagor police station SHO Bachhraj Choudhary said the investigation is ongoing.

17 death sentences in seven cases, 100 days: Why a Muzaffarnagar trial court stands out

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, August 17

BETWEEN APRIL 6 and July 17 – barely 100 days – Judge Ravi Kumar Diwakar, Additional District and Sessions Judge presiding over Fast Track Court No. 3 in Muzaffarnagar, sentenced 17 people to death across seven separate murder trials, out of 22 accused.

For a sense of how unusual that number is, take the entire Uttar Pradesh. In all of 2025, across the state, trial courts handed down 28 death sentences in 20 cases, as per the Death Penalty in India: Annual Statistics Report 2025, by the Square Circle Clinic at NALSAR University of Law, Hyderabad.

The two states that ranked after UP in the award of death sentences by trial courts in 2025, Karnataka (15) and West Bengal (14), in fact, saw fewer capital terms in comparison to Justice Diwakar's court alone.

All death sentences by a Sessions Court have to be confirmed by a High Court. The Square Circle Clinic's decade-long data shows High Courts have confirmed barely 1 in 10 of the death sentences they have

examined since 2016 (106 of 1,085). The Supreme Court has not confirmed a single death sentence since 2023.

One essential requirement for confirming the death sentence is adherence to norms as laid out by the Supreme Court in Manoj & Ors v State of Madhya Pradesh case of 2022, which include examining the mitigating circumstances and reports on the accused's conduct.

Judge Diwakar's orders awarding the death sentence do not have a record of the same.

Apart from deaths to 17, of the five other accused in these seven cases, two did not stand trial, another died during trial, another passed away during investigation, and one was tried not for murder but for making evidence disappear.

The requirement, and the gap

In Manoj & Ors v State of Madhya Pradesh, a three-judge Supreme Court Bench comprising Justices U U Lalit, S Ravindra Bhat and Bela M Trivedi held that before a trial court hands down a death sentence, it must have on record several reports, to be prepared by the state

in a time-bound manner. These include reports on the accused's psychiatric and psychological condition, jail conduct, behaviour and work done in custody.

The purpose, the Bench said, was to test whether reform of the convict was truly foreclosed, since death is to be given only in "the rarest of rare" cases.

In the 17 death sentences given by the Fast Track Court No. 3, there is no record of the state producing such material, or the court calling for it. *The Indian Express* reached out to several prosecutors concerned and, off the record, they said they did not submit any such reports as the court did not seek the same.

In at least two cases, the judge noted the accused's "bhav-bhangima (facial expressions and demeanour in the courtroom)" as a key factor. "The court observed the facial expressions and demeanour of the convicted person, and at no point did the court feel that he felt any remorse for the crime he had committed," the sentencing orders in the May 30 and July 2 orders state.

The 2022 Manoj ruling also placed the burden of assembling material on mitigating

circumstances on the State: the trial court has to "elicit" it, and the State has to produce a structured account of the accused's socio-economic background and early life.

Across all the seven cases, the defence counsel argued that the convicts concerned were poor, labourers, or fathers of young children. But the court found other factors as weighing over this in its sentencing orders.

Advocate Rajeev Sharma, District Government Counsel, Muzaffarnagar, did not respond to attempts by *The Indian Express* to reach him via phone calls and text messages.

Under Sections 407 to 412 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, no death sentence passed by a Sessions Court can be carried out until the High Court confirms it. So, all 17 death sentences awarded by the Muzaffarnagar trial court will go to the Allahabad High Court for confirmation, alongside any appeals the convicts file independently.

In a landmark ruling in 2025, in the Vasanta Sampat Dupare v Union of India case, a Supreme Court Bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sanjay Karol and Sandeep

Mehta held that even a death sentence the Supreme Court has itself affirmed as final could be reopened under Article 32 of the Constitution if the Manoj safeguards were not followed.

The seven cases, the 17 death sentences

■ April 6: Three given the death sentence by the Muzaffarnagar Fast-Track Court No. 3 for kidnapping and murdering a young advocate and a close friend of one of the convicts. The court saw it as an attack on the Bar and the rule of law itself.

■ April 28: A father and three sons convicted for beating a man to death with bricks over a Rs 70,000 debt. The court likened it to mob lynching, and held that "the facial expressions and behaviour" of the four showed no repentance through the trial.

■ May 30: One given capital punishment for the "diabolical" double murder of a woman he was in a relationship with and her six-year-old son. His crime was seen as aggravated, as he was already in jail for his wife's dowry death.

■ June 20: Two held guilty of killing a man and burning the body. The court held it to be a

calculated, "no body, no case" attempt, influenced by films, to destroy evidence. It spoke about "total lack of remorse" shown by the accused in the courtroom.

■ July 2: One sentenced for fatally stabbing a Home Guard and trying to kill another after they stepped in to stop him from assaulting his own mother. The crime was seen by the court as "a challenge not only to the police force but also directly to the authority of the state government". The court also added that the crime demonstrates criminals are capable of "directly challenging the sovereignty of the State".

■ July 6: Two convicted of killing a rival panchayat election candidate, and using their influence to make the murder weapon disappear from police custody. The judge said that "democracy is based on the ballot, not the bullet".

■ July 17: Four were sentenced for organising a "gang-style" robbery-murder on a highway. The court cited their criminal antecedents and Muzaffarnagar's reputation as a 'Crime Capital', and talked about "the message" the sentence sends.

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Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, August 17

THE BIHAR Police has told the Supreme Court that a constable working in the District Intelligence Unit (DIU) "had fired...4 rounds from his AK-47 in the air" after he "got trapped in the crowd" of protesters that had hit the streets in Siwan on July 25, following the bandh call by various parties as the 'Jantar Mantar' protests in the state turned violent, but no one was injured.

In a counter affidavit filed in the top court, ADGP (Law and Order) K Suhita Anupam said that "in Siwan, on 25.07.2026, protestors of AISA and RYA (student and youth wing of



Protesters clashed with police at several places in Bihar on July 25. FILE

CPI(ML)) gathered at Gandhi Maidan and began marching towards JP Chowk. At around 12:30 pm, protestors started pelting stones on the police force. The hooligans from Mairwa Road and Gopalganj

Road joined the stone pelters. In the stone pelting, 20 police personnel including Superintendent of Police Siwan, 2 Sub-Divisional Police Officers, 2 Inspectors, 2 Sub-Inspectors, 13 Constables got injured. In the

violence, two police vehicles and a large number of traffic trollies were damaged. Water cannon and tear gas shells were used to control the law and order situation. For the incidents, 6 FIRs were registered against 82 persons, out of which 17 persons were arrested".

The affidavit filed on August 11 added that "as the deployed force was inadequate, all the officers and personnel working in different sections and lines were called to supplement the police force. Near JP Chowk, Constable...working in the District Intelligence Unit (DIU), got trapped in the crowd and fired 4 rounds from his AK-47 in the air. No one was injured". It further said that in Hathi

Chowk, about 1.5-2 km from JP Chowk, another assistant sub-inspector fired 2 rounds from his 9mm pistol to disperse the mob. Two fired cartridges of .315 bore and 1 fired cartridge of 7.65 mm were recovered from the place of incident.

"Three protestors suffered minor firearms injuries" and they "were given best possible treatment in Sadar Hospital, Siwan, and were immediately shifted to Medanta Hospital in Patna for best treatment. All the injured persons were released after their injuries healed," the affidavit read. The State Police said that "the injuries to protestors were neither caused by AK-47, nor the persons were located at the place where the con-

stable fired from AK-47. Ballistic examination is being carried out to ascertain the type of weapon, distance of fire, angle of fire etc".

It added that the constable who fired the AK-47 "has been put under suspension for undesired conduct and departmental proceedings...has been initiated against him". The State pointed out that "as AK-47 is a platoon-level weapon, it is to be used in special operations, not in law and order situations". A detailed instruction regarding "use of AK 47 has been issued by the Director General of Police" on August 1 and added that "similar orders have been issued at earlier occasions as well".

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EDUCATION



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The institute successfully concluded a three-day PGDM Orientation Programme from July 29–31, 2026. The programme featured Ms. Ghazal Alagh, Founder of Mamaearth, and industry leaders Ayush Gupta, Director HR, GAIL, and Satyajit Mittal, Founder of Aretto. Day two featured an HR Conclave, team-building activities and chief guest Mr. Vivek Srivastava, Managing Director, PwC. The programme concluded with Campus Connect and a Talent Hunt judged by actress and model Akaisha Vats. Dr. Sandeep Marwah graced the event, held under the leadership of Dr. Lalitya Vir Srivastava, Dr. Saurabh Sharma and Dr. Gurdeep Singh Raina.



CHRIST (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY) - EVENT

Dr. Fr Joseph C.C., Vice Chancellor of CHRIST (Deemed to be University), was conferred the honorary rank of Colonel of the National Cadet Corps (NCC) at a pipping ceremony held at the University's Central Campus. Air Commodore Kamal Chadha, Deputy Director General, NCC Directorate Karnataka & Goa, highlighted CHRIST's 57-year NCC legacy and eight consecutive Best Institution Awards. Nearly 200 CHRIST cadets have been commissioned into the Armed Forces, with 47 joining between 2019 and 2026. Dr. Fr Joseph is the third CHRIST Vice Chancellor to receive the honorary rank.



AMITY INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL - EVENT

Amity International School, Noida, won the GT Winner's Trophy at the 16th GT Awards, organised by The Global Times at Amity University, Noida. The GT Making a Newspaper Contest 2025–26 featured young journalists from 12 Amity International and Amity Global Schools, showcasing creativity, storytelling and journalistic skills. Mayur Vihar and Sector-46, Gurugram, were joint first runners-up, while Sector-43, Gurugram, secured second runners-up. Saket received the Jury Special Mention Award. Chief Guest Sikta Deo of NDTV urged students to remain curious, fearless and honest. The event also recognised editorial, design, alumni and mentoring excellence.



AJAY KUMAR GARG ENGINEERING COLLEGE (AKGEC) - EVENT

The Department of Computer Science & Engineering at AKGEC, in collaboration with C-DAC Noida, inaugurated a six-day offline bootcamp on Cloud Computing Technology under the FutureSkills PRIME Project. The programme, held from recently, was inaugurated with a traditional Lamp Lighting Ceremony and Saraswati Vandana. Anita Dev, Advisor, AKGEC, graced the occasion as Chief Guest, while Anu Chaudhary, Head, CSE Department, welcomed participants and emphasized the importance of industry-oriented skills. C-DAC experts Shubham Tripathi, Cyber Security Engineer, and Yasir Ahmar Khan, Cyber Security Trainer and Security Consultant, are conducting interactive sessions and hands-on training. Participants are gaining practical exposure to cloud infrastructure, virtualization, deployment models, cloud security, DevOps, containerization and cybersecurity. The initiative aims to bridge the academia-industry gap and equip students with future-ready technical skills.



AMITY UNIVERSITY - EVENT

The University witnessed enthusiastic participation from students and faculty in the virtual launch of the 'Drug-Free Youth for a Developed India' campaign, organised by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Government of India. PM Narendra Modi addressed youth nationwide, stressing that a developed India by 2047 requires healthy, mentally strong and drug-free citizens. S. K. Srivastava, Chairman, Anti-Narcotics and Disaster Management Committee, reaffirmed Amity's commitment to a drug-free campus and awareness of addiction. Students viewed films about drug abuse's impact on individuals and families. Faculty and students pledged support for the campaign and a healthier India.



GNIOT GROUP OF INSTITUTIONS - EVENT

It hosted the Namaskar Uttar Pradesh State Creators Awards–2026, organized by Namaskar Foundation, celebrating the state's creative talent, innovators, social reformers and change-makers. UP Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak graced the occasion as Chief Guest, while ISRO Scientist Abhishek Singh was the Guest of Honour. Distinguished achievers from education, culture, technology, entrepreneurship, healthcare, agriculture and social service were felicitated for their contributions. Rajesh Gupta, Chairman, GNIOT, highlighted the role of education and innovation in nation-building. The event reinforced the Foundation's commitment to recognizing talent and inspiring youth.



NOIDA INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY (NIET) - EVENT

NIET, strengthened its international academic engagement through participation in the Summer Institute on International Education in Japan (SIIIEJ 2026), held at J.F. Oberlin University, Tokyo. Neema Agarwal, Additional Managing Director, NIET, participated in a panel discussion on student aspirations, employability and the future of international higher education, with a focus on India–Japan collaboration. She highlighted the importance of international exposure, industry connect, student mobility and meaningful academic partnerships in preparing students for global opportunities and real-world outcomes. The panel featured Prof. Vijaya Sekhar Chellaboina, Prof. Keiko Ikeda of Kansai University and Mr. Adrian Mutton, facilitating an engaging exchange on international education and deeper India–Japan academic collaboration. Agarwal said, "International education is about creating meaningful pathways for learning, collaboration, and employability."



JS INSTITUTE OF DESIGN (JSID) - ORIENTATION

The Institute welcomed its new cohort with a three-day immersive orientation programme, setting the tone for an industry-driven and globally informed design education. Bringing together international academic leaders from École Intuit Lab, France, renowned industry practitioners, faculty and alumni, the programme offered students valuable exposure to real-world design perspectives, mentorship and collaborative learning. Through engaging sessions, networking opportunities and introductions to the institute's academic ecosystem, the orientation reinforced JSID's commitment to nurturing future-ready designers equipped with global outlooks, creative confidence and strong industry relevance.



JAMIA HAMDARD - EVENT

Jamia Hamdard celebrated India's 80th Independence Day with patriotic fervour at the Hamdard Convention Centre. Prof. (Dr.) Asgar Ali, Vice-Chancellor, unfurled the National Flag, followed by the National Anthem and a Guard of Honour by NCC cadets and security personnel. The programme featured patriotic songs, a skit, and an Inter-University Eloction Competition on "Atmanirbhar Bharat: How to Achieve the Goal," with participation from Jamia Hamdard, University of Delhi and Jamia Millia Islamia. Prof. Ali paid tribute to freedom fighters and stressed education, innovation and compassion as drivers of progress. The event concluded with felicitation of security personnel and distribution of sweets.

MOMENTOUS EVENT SEES DIPLOMATS FROM INDIA, IRAN, RUSSIA, CHINA; PAKISTAN STAYS AWAY

At Afghan embassy, Taliban diplomats mark 5th anniversary of ‘victory day’

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 17

IT WAS a humid evening and the lush green lawns of the Afghan embassy in Delhi’s diplomatic enclave Chanakya-puri were lit up with paper lanterns and fairy lights. A white and parrot green themed shamiana housed at least 20 round tables, with giant coolers and fans to keep the guests cool.

This was no ordinary evening at Chanakyaपुरi, which witnesses diplomatic receptions round the year. This one was different, and a first in India’s diplomatic history.

Five years after the Taliban took control of Afghanistan, its embassy in Delhi marked the 5th anniversary of “victory day” for the first time on Monday – which was attended by Indian government officials and about two dozen foreign diplomats.

Taliban took over the Afghan embassy in November last year, after their Foreign Minister Amir Khan Muttaqi visited India and met External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar. Both sides decided to upgrade the ties, with the Taliban sending its diplomats to Delhi under a chargé d’affaires – in the absence of official recognition of the Taliban regime by the Indian government.

Chargé d’affaires Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor hosted the two-hour event which was attended by a delegation from the Ministry of External Affairs led



Chargé d’affaires Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor with Joint Secretary (Pakistan, Afghanistan and Iran) Anand Prakash at the embassy on Monday. SHUBHAJIT ROY

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 by Joint Secretary (Pakistan, Afghanistan and Iran) Anand Prakash.

As the evening unfolded, diplomats trooped in. Palestinian Ambassador Abdullah M. Abu Shawesh was among the first to arrive, followed by Iranian Ambassador Mohammad Fathali.

While Russia and China sent their diplomats, Pakistan – which has had strained relations with the Taliban in the last couple of years – did not send a representative.

Envoys from Eritrea, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Niger, Qatar, Oman were seen, and Serbia was the only European country to attend the event.

With no diplomatic recognition from most of the world, the Taliban chargé d’affaires clicked pictures with the

shared interests of the region and the world. A peaceful, stable and responsible Afghanistan creates new opportunities for regional connectivity, trade, investment and economic co-operation, while also playing a constructive role in preventing shared security threats,” he said.

“The Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan believes that Afghanistan’s geography should not be a field for negative competition, but rather a bridge for connectivity, cooperation and shared prosperity,” the envoy added.

Invoking the historical ties, he said, “For centuries, Afghanistan and India have remained connected through trade, transit, sports, and a shared cultural heritage. Throughout our history, the routes linking our two countries served as channels for the exchange of knowledge and art, as well as for the transmission of the values of literature and spirituality. The ancient cities of Afghanistan, such as Kabul, Herat and Kandahar, welcomed Indian traders and caravans, while... Delhi and Lahore benefited from the influence of Afghan scholars, poets and Sufis. In the political sphere as well, the two countries influenced one another in their struggles for freedom and independence from British colonial rule.”

Coming to the present, CDA Noor said, “In recent years, relations between Afghanistan and India have witnessed significant progress – guided by mutual respect, political engagement and shared interests. Official diplomatic contacts between the two countries have expanded, embassies and consulates have become more active, and high-level delegations have continued to exchange visits... More recently, Afghanistan’s Minister of Foreign Affairs, as well as ministers from other sectoral ministries, have visited India, and the two countries have reached understandings in various areas. These developments represent an important step forward in further strengthening and expanding cooperation between Afghanistan and India.”

Only a handful of women were present at the event, including Indian diplomat Sneha Dubey, a few Indian women journalists as well as wives, family members of foreign diplomats in the crowd of about 200 people.

As the evening rolled by over watermelon mocktails, virgin mojito, Qabuli pulao and gosht, the Afghans from the former regime were seen standing near the tent.

While the Taliban-appointed diplomats had dinner with Indian and foreign guests inside the tent, those appointed by the Ashraf Ghani regime looked on from the lawns. A Taliban-appointed diplomat told The Indian Express, “We are all working together, there is no problem between us at all.”

CBI FILES CHARGESHEET

Twisha death: AIIMS Delhi finds ‘no injury suggestive of assault’

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, August 17

A SECOND post-mortem conducted by an AIIMS Delhi medical board has found no injury on model-turned-actor Twisha Sharma’s body “suggestive of assault prior to death”, *The Indian Express* has learnt. The report allegedly confirms that she died of ante-mortem hanging using the gymnastic belt recovered from her matrimonial home.

The CBI, which is investigating the case, has filed its chargesheet. The alleged findings assume significance because Twisha’s family had alleged that the first post-mortem conducted at AIIMS Bhopal had been manipulated under the influence of accused retired judge Giribala Singh and her son, advocate Samarth Singh. The second post-mortem was conducted in Bhopal on May 24 by an AIIMS Delhi medical board following an order of the Madhya Pradesh High Court on May 22.

In its findings, the medical board is learnt to have concluded that the cause of death in this case “is Asphyxia as a result of ante-mortem hanging, which is suicidal in manner produced by the examined Ligature material, the gymnastic belt with a ring”. No other injury of medico-legal importance found on the body of the deceased suggestive of Assault/Scuffle prior to death, the report is learnt to have said.

In the first post-mortem report, prepared at AIIMS Bhopal, doctors allegedly observed “two parallel ligature marks” on Twisha’s neck during the autopsy. The report allegedly recorded the investigating officer did not produce the alleged nylon belt recovered from the scene before the medical board at the time of the post-mortem.

“The alleged ligature material was not presented during



Twisha Sharma

examination,” the report noted, adding that because of this omission, “scientific correlation between the ligature mark and the alleged material could not be established.” The report by AIIMS Bhopal stated that the death was “due to antemortem hanging by ligature”.

“Multiple antemortem injuries (simple in nature, possible by blunt force) over other parts of the body have been noted,” the first PM report stated. Apart from the ligature injuries, the first post-mortem documented multiple external injuries on the body. These include “two reddish abrasions” on the front of the neck, bruises on the left arm, including a “bluish contusion”, another “bluish contusion” below it, and a further “bluish contusion” lower down on the same arm. It further documented a “reddish contusion” on the front of the left forearm. Another injury described was a “reddish contusion” over the “right ring finger”.

Twisha, a former Miss Pune and model-turned-actor from Noida, was found dead at her matrimonial home in Bhopal’s Katara Hills on May 12, 2026 -- less than six months after her wedding to advocate Samarth Singh. The case was initially registered as a dowry death by the Katara Hills police and later transferred to the CBI amid allegations of investigative lapses and evidence tampering.

Are courts precluded from granting fair compensation for nuclear mishaps: SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 17

THE SUPREME Court on Monday asked the Centre to respond whether the Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India (SHANTI) Act, 2025, which replaced the Civil Liability for Nuclear Liability Act of 2010, would preclude constitutional courts from determining a “fair and just” monetary compensation in case of a nuclear mishap.

A three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant also sought to know whether there is any conflict of interest in the power under Section 17(4) of the Act to appoint Chairperson and Members of the Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB). The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, issued notice to the Centre and AERB on these two issues.

The court was hearing a plea which said that the government’s move to cap the liability of private nuclear operators under the Act in case of a nuclear disaster will encourage the operators to cut corners.

Appearing for the petitioners, Advocate Prashant Bhushan and Neha Rathi said the Act caps the highest liability of the operator at Rs 3,000 crore and the government’s residual liability at Rs 4,500 crore. Referring to nuclear disasters at Chernobyl and Fukushima, Bhushan contended that the real cost would be several times higher.

The CJI, said that “only because Parliament imposed a cap, it does not bar the courts”.

To the court’s remark that the limit may be only to make the project more attractive to foreign investors, Bhushan said it might lead to the operators cutting corners. “If there is a nuclear accident in the country, questions will be raised. And if those accidents are on account of corners cut by the plant operators, in the belief that their liability is capped at Rs 100 crore to Rs 3,000 crore... it’s a very very serious issue,” he said.

Bhushan said the SC decisions had in the past laid down this principle that if somebody operates a hazardous industry, then if there is an accident from that industry, the person who runs it will have absolute and unlimited liability. “That principle has been clearly violated”. Also, AERB itself runs some nuclear plants, and it also plays a significant role in regulating them. “This is a violation of the principles laid down of the independence of the regulatory body by all international conventions”.

Responding to a query from the court about nuclear energy, Bhushan said the government had assessed India’s potential of solar power and said it is 3,343 gigawatts (GW) using 6% of wasteland, which his 14 times the peak power demand of 256 GW. He submitted that solar power can be built in three months and its per-capita unit cost is one-fifth that of nuclear energy. “It has no hazard whatsoever,” he said.

States can’t block elephant corridors fearing crop damage: SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 17

STATING THAT states cannot block the elephant corridors fearing crop damage, the Supreme Court Monday asked the Centre to conduct a fresh survey of these corridors across the country.

A three-judge bench, presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, said, “We are very clear that there cannot be obstacles in the way of wildlife. Elephant herds have a practice of travelling long distances. No State can say that just because crops are getting destroyed, there have to be obstacles in their path”.

The bench, also comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, was hearing an application which highlighted blockade of the corridors in some states.

“We have been informed that there are mandatory guidelines issued by the Ministry of Environment, Forest, Climate Change and Wildlife to ensure seamless and unobstructed elephant corridors passing through different States. However, owing to certain local factors, the elephant corridors have been impeded, choked, blocked, or obstructed...”, the bench said in its order directing a fresh survey.

The top court also asked the Centre to submit a comprehensive survey report detailing the necessary steps and initiatives taken by them to prevent such obstructions.

The court said the matter will be heard after six weeks.

SC weighs rules for Ram temple donations amid row over ‘theft’

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 17

THE SUPREME Court on Monday said it might pass orders listing ways to transparently maintain donations at the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya in the wake of alleged embezzlement of funds at the temple.

“There are certain other directions which are required for the purpose of reforms. That we will issue. We are also considering this fact – that how the donation amount should be maintained, what kind of transparency (is needed),” Chief Justice of India Surya Kant remarked orally while hearing petitions seeking probe into the alleged embezzlement.

The CJI made the remark as a counsel urged the three-judge bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, to direct the Trust managing the shrine to publish details of the donations received so far.

The court also asked the Special Investigation Team (SIT) constituted by it to investigate the matter and take the probe to a logical conclusion.

The CJI asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta how much more time the SIT would require.

After Mehta informed the SIT would require another three weeks, the CJI said, “Let them conclude it also. Let them take it to a logical conclusion.”

Mehta said that, as directed by the court, the UP Inspector General of Police who was heading the initial SIT in the matter is also leading the SIT formed by the court.

He added that the SIT had also included a forensic auditor in the team as desired by the court. Mehta informed the bench that the investigation is going on and a status report has been drawn up.

The court directed the status report be filed in its Registry.

One of the petitioners contended the investigation will not be proper with the current Trust in place and urged the court to dissolve it.

The CJI, pointed out that the “SIT is not under (the) Trust. It is constituted by us. It is accountable and answerable to us.



Council of Scientific and Industrial Research
Anusandhan Bhawan, 2, Rafi Marg, New Delhi-110001
Advertisement No. R&A/01/2026
Start Date for online applications: 18th August, 2026 (10.00 AM)
Last Date for submission of online applications: 17th September, 2026 (05.00 PM)
CSIR invites online applications from eligible “Indian Citizens” for filling up 43 posts of **Technician (I) / Group-II (I)**, in the “Pay Matrix Level-2” (Rs. 19,900-63,200), on direct recruitment basis. The complete details about the vacancies, qualification, experience, age limit and online application form etc. are available on CSIR website i.e. <http://www.csir.res.in>
CBC- 36202/11/0008/2627
Deputy Secretary (R&A)



THE TATA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
Regd. Office: Bombay House, 24, Horni Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: 91 22 6665 8282, CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567
Email: investorcomplaints@tatapower.com Website: www.tatapower.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
NOTICE is hereby given that the certificate(s) for the undermentioned securities of the Company has / have been lost / misplaced and the holder(s) of the said securities / applicant(s) has / have applied to the Company to issue duplicate certificate(s).
Any person who has a claim in respect of the said securities should lodge such claim with the Company at its Registered Office within 15 days from this date, else the Company will proceed to issue duplicate certificate(s) without further intimation.

Sr. no.	Folio No.	Name of Shareholder(s)	Kind of securities and face value	No. of securities	Distinctive Number(s)
1.	H5N0010499	Nand Ram Mishra	Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	5,000	15356301-15361300

For The Tata Power Company Limited

Sd/-
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary
FCS 7021

Place: Mumbai
Dated: August 17, 2026

GURU TEG BAHADUR HOSPITAL
(GOVT. OF NCT OF DELHI)
Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095

F.No.F.50/A&E/GTBH/2026/ date: 14/08/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE
SHIFTING OF GTBH EMERGENCY SERVICIE TO RAJIV GANDHI SS HOSPITAL

It is hereby informed for the benefit of the general public that the Accident & Emergency (A&E) Services (except Gynecology & Obstetrics and Pediatrics emergency services) of Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital (GTB Hospital) are being shifted to Block No. 4, Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital (RGSSH), Tahirpur, Delhi-110093 w.e.f. 18 August 2026, 9.00 A.M.
However, the Gynecology & Obstetrics and Pediatrics emergency services shall continue to operate from MCH Block, GTBH.
The public is advised to visit **Block No. 4, Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital, Tahirpur, Delhi** (Entry from Gate No. 4) for availing the above-mentioned emergency services with effect from 18th June 2026.
All concerned agencies, healthcare providers, ambulance services, and members of the public are requested to take note of the change and extend necessary cooperation.

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0185/26-27 **Medical Director**



GUJARAT ENERGY TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
REGISTERED & CORPORATE OFFICE, SARDAR PATEL VIDYUT BHAVAN, RACECOURSE, VADODARA – 390 007
www.getcogujarat.com

TENDER NOTICE NO. ACE (P&C): TN – 11: 2026-2027

[A] PROCUREMENT: Tender No. (1) E-3110: Purchase of G.I. Earth-wire & Stay-wire.
[B] CIVIL: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ CIVIL-657, 658, 659, 661, 662, 664, 665, 667, 669, 670, 671:- (1) Construction of C.R. Building, Foundations, Cable Trench etc. at 66 kV Dhunsol S/s under Palanpur Circle., **(2)** Const. of C.R. Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, etc. at 66 kV Rajpuritalat S/s, and opp. end line-bay foundation at 66 kV Jamanpada S/s under Navsari Circle., **(3)** Providing Pile foundation for various tower locations proposed for replacement of existing 66 kV lines under Navsari Circle., **(4)** Const. of C.R. Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, etc. at 66 kV Dediyaasan (GIDC) S/s under Mehsana circle., **(5)** Const. of C.R. Building, Staff Quarter etc. at 66 kV Hamla S/s under Anjar Circle., **(6)** Const. of First Floor C.R. Building, Foundations, Precast Cable Trench, etc. at 66 kV Sanand-III (GIDC) S/s under S'nagar Circle., **(7)** Const. of New C.R. building at F.F., Feeder Cable trench etc. at Existing 66 kV Vapi GIDC under Navsari Circle., **(8)** Const. of C.R. Building (GF) for shifting of existing C.R. with electrification, Yard Cable Trench, R.C.C. Road etc. at 66 kV Panoli 1 S/s under Bharuch Circle., **(9)** Const. of C'wall, RCC road, Maintenance of Existing C.R. Building, Metal Spreading etc. at 66 kV Thasara S/s under Nadiad Circle., **(10)** Const. of New C.R. Building (9+2 Span), RCC Road etc. at 66 kV Limbasi S/s under Nadiad Circle., **(11)** Const. of C.R. Building etc. at 66 kV Gada S/s under Anjar Circle.
[C] LINE: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ E-503/TL/ 66KV/S&E:- Supply, Erection, testing & commissioning of 66 kV D/C Becharaji-Vithalapur line on M/C Tower with ACSR Panther Cond. (AP-14 to AP-34) 11.86Rkm Under KSY Scheme.
Above tenders are available on website www.getcogujarat.com (for view and download only) & tender.nprocure.com (For view, download and online tender submissions).
Note: Bidders are requested to be in touch with our websites till opening of these tenders.
Date: 18/08/2026 Additional Chief Engineer (Procurement & Contracts)

The Indian EXPRESS

~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

60 days on, a disturbing US-Iran stalemate

THE 60-DAY window for the US and Iran to agree on a long-term peace framework expired on Monday. On the ground, however, both sides had shut the window in late June and through July, as they traded strikes. The MoU had begun to unravel, largely over disagreements about how its terms should be interpreted. The framework also failed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, which Iran has effectively blockaded since the Israel-US attack in late February, prompting an American counterblockade. Far from limiting hostilities, the 60-day period saw the war widen, with the Houthis and Saudi Arabia attacking each other as the Yemen-based militant group enforced a partial blockade of the Bab el-Mandeb. Both the US and Iran are now doubling down on economic warfare and both have their reasons to do so. The past few months have shown the US that bombing alone will not dislodge the hardline regime in Tehran and the US is running low on munitions. Iran, too, knows that the US has come to stay in the region, and that ballistic missiles fired at US bases or Israel will not change that. The deadlock means that the rest of the world remains hostage to a conflict that neither side appears capable of ending.

Trump's position has oscillated between escalatory rhetoric — he has now threatened to bomb Oman if it “gets in the way” of a deal with Iran — and an insistence that a negotiated settlement is possible. With a midterm election approaching, he needs to demonstrate that the pressure campaign is producing results without keeping the country trapped in another foreign war. Iran, meanwhile, must calculate how long it can absorb the economic costs without making concessions. Washington has rescinded sanction waivers on Iranian oil in the international market, while threatening to maintain its naval blockade of Iranian ports “indefinitely”. Tehran calculates that it can squeeze Trump until the midterms, and sees the stalemate as the new balance of power.

It remains to be seen who will blink first, whether either side can gain decisive leverage to negotiate a settlement, or the deadlock becomes the new normal. Should the stalemate persist, India, which has managed the consequences so far, will have to reconsider the threat to its economic, energy and strategic interests. Diplomacy alone will not do the trick. India must reduce its overwhelming dependence on imported oil, build larger strategic petroleum reserves, and aggressively invest in alternative energy sources.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mjMzg1

When DU chooses to shrink Delhi’s past

THE REMOVAL of an elective paper on the Delhi Sultanate from Delhi University's newly notified postgraduate History syllabus, along with several long-taught papers on gender, religion and political structures in ancient India, does students a disservice. It does so not just by narrowing the choice made available to them but also by undermining their ability to engage critically. In recent years, syllabus changes have travelled steadily from schools to colleges and universities, with chapters and subjects rationalised or removed without sufficiently persuasive explanation. Reform is, of course, both desirable and necessary. But the University's explanation for the omissions — that they are intended to achieve greater balance and regional representation under the National Education Policy (NEP), 2020 — sits uneasily with the NEP's stated aim of fostering considered judgement. Higher education should complicate what students have learnt at school, place events in wider contexts and expose them to competing interpretations and historiographical perspectives. The Delhi Sultanate paper opened a window to the political formations of the 13th and 14th centuries. Its omission renders connections to a rich past more tenuous.

It is difficult to approach History as a study of discrete episodes. It is a continuum, informed, enriched and complicated by what comes before and after. The Delhi Sultanate occupies a vital place in medieval history because alongside the story of powerful dynasts, it offers insights into the transformation of Delhi into a political centre — the evolution of state institutions, patronage networks, the movement of people and ideas, and the events, freedoms and unfreedoms that eventually shaped Mughal and colonial histories. This intricate tapestry cannot be reduced to neat siloes. If neglected regions, communities and perspectives need greater space, the answer should be to widen the field.

That is also the broader argument of the NEP: To make education more multidisciplinary, flexible and capable of encouraging students to think independently. DU should keep that ambition in sight. At a time when debates over curricula risk turning history into a proxy battlefield for contemporary anxieties, the best defence is not a narrower syllabus but greater intellectual choice. A storied university such as DU should trust its students to navigate the past in all its complexity.

In margins of old books, what AI cannot replace

THE LLMs are hungry and only vast quantities of books can satisfy their appetite. This, according to second-hand booksellers in the UK, is why the sales of pre-owned books are seeing a sudden surge. The news follows the recent revelations about AI firm Anthropic's mysterious “Project Panama”, which involves the large-scale buying and scanning of books, mostly second-hand — ironically, because the AI slop flooding the internet has rendered it a low-quality source of information and knowledge.

The fact that books of any kind are being bought in such numbers while the publishing industry is in a slump may seem, on the face of it, like good news. Look closely and it stands revealed as a false consolation. For, AI can only consume books through “destructive” scanning, a process that requires the spines of books to be ripped off so that the pages can be rapidly scanned and the remains recycled. This digitisation by digestion is an unfortunate fate for books among which, in the words of Virginia Woolf, one might encounter a “complete stranger” who could become “the best friend we have in the world”.

Because that has, for long, been the main appeal of second-hand books. Collectors are right about the charms of old, yellowing pages and their distinctive smell, as well as the revelatory beauty of marginalia. It is also true that the second-hand book industry was democratising knowledge long before AI. But to browse through books once prized by others and to find among them a new love of one's own has a special allure. At a time when algorithms are determining what is seen and what is ignored, second-hand books hold out the increasingly rare promise of serendipity.

August 15 after Jantar Mantar: The many spaces of freedom — and unfreedom

THIS INDEPENDENCE Day came close on the heels of a students' movement that forced a powerful government to bend and became a liberating moment in its own right. The day after brings an occasion to stand on tip toe, look at what has moved, and what did not change.

Let's begin with freedom's heady freezeframe. Till the Jantar Mantar moment, a narrative was becoming a stranglehold. It went like this — Congress and the regional parties are in unchecked decline and the BJP, armed with a will-to-power not diminished by power, enormous resources and control over central agencies, is seizing and filling spaces vacated by opposition parties. After the resignation of a Union minister in response to the protesters' demand at Jantar Mantar, that story is becoming unfrozen. A third force has flashed on the public mind, putting both the main players on notice. Suddenly, the government, too, looks vulnerable, not just the Opposition. Democracy's wet dog shake at Jantar Mantar is loosening democratic spaces.

Even though he did not mention the students' movement by name, Prime Minister Narendra Modi's I-Day speech acknowledged it and sought to domesticate it. He profusely invoked “*yuva shakti*”, but asked that it be yoked to the national project. He described the young, the protagonists of Jantar Mantar, as the “*labharthi*” or passive beneficiaries. This is in line with the earlier recasting by his government of the rights-bearing citizen as the recipient of state largesse and as the performer of duties.

The PM identified the challenge before the nation — the threat posed by the “*dimagi*” Naxal (one with a Naxal mindset) well after the “*hathiyari*” Naxal (armed in-

surgent) had been defeated. In the PM's repertoire of slurs and labels for opponents, dissenters and critics — “ecosystem”, “*aandolan jeevi*”, “urban Naxal”, among others — “*dimagi*” Naxal is perhaps the most unvarnished. It takes no detours, looks for no pretexts, allows no nuances. It reaches inside the mind to criminalise the thought and idea directly.

A few days before the PM's Red Fort speech, a sessions court in Mumbai delivered an uncannily similar-sounding lesson in unfreedom as it refused anticipatory bail to two TISS students accused of raising slogans during a memorial event held in October 2025 (the Bombay High Court has subsequently given one of the two students interim protection from arrest).

The students had gathered to pay tribute to the late Delhi University professor G N Saibaba, who died shortly after his acquittal ended a prolonged incarceration in a UAPA case. “...the act of accused persons appeared to be not limited to paying him (Saibaba) homage. They even allegedly raised slogans...”, the court said. The slogans in question sought the release of Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, former student activists facing trial under UAPA, jailed now for about six years, the trial still not in sight. The court also took note of reading material recovered from the students' electronic devices, which, the prosecution said, reflected Maoist ideology. “...though the accused have not committed a criminal offence, their act coupled with the material found... raises doubt about their conduct” — the court seemed to defer, in anticipation, to the PM's coinage of “*dimagi*” Naxal.

In JNU, authorities withdrew permission for an event in which



VANDITA MISHRA

The students' success story is up against the congealed realities of a layered polity. Gen Z's success, therefore, lies more in what it can help illuminate, not just in what it has achieved

Tata's leadership change is an opportunity, not a crisis



HETAL DALAL



AMIT TANDON

For the group to truly outlive individuals, it must place its trust in seasoned professionals while safeguarding its core philosophy of responsible citizenship

NCHANDRASEKARAN'S announcement that he will not be seeking a third term should not cause investors to panic. The transition at the helm of the Tata group has a longer runway this time, but the change has a different dynamic. If used well, it could become an opportunity for the group.

While N Chandrasekaran's (Chandra) decision to not seek reappointment was not unexpected, it has caused some disquiet. Shareholders in listed Tata Group companies need not panic. The operating companies are strong businesses, have strong leadership and well-established boards. The immediate impact of this decision is limited at best. For the listed companies that Chandra chairs, a transition will be made once a successor has been appointed.

For the listed companies, Chandra has had a successful run; they have grown in size and profitability, and capital has been infused and unlocked by reducing the level of cross-holdings. The group has also started investing in tomorrow's businesses. The concerns are more at the level of Tata Sons — large losses from the aviation and digital businesses, the challenges of the semiconductor foray, its contentious relationship with the RBI with respect to its listing, among others.

A leadership change at the helm of Tata Sons is not entirely a surprise. The media has reported skirmishes among the trustees of the Tata Group and between Chandra and some members of the Tata Sons board. If for nothing else, a successor would have had to be identified soon enough — Chandra is about two years away from reaching the Tata Group's mandatory retirement age for executive directors.

The Tata Group has six months to find a successor. Under Indian law, succession planning is the mandate of the nomination and remuneration committee and of the board. In Tata Sons' case, however, a selection committee must be formed — the process has already been initiated by the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust — for the appointment of the chairperson. The selection committee must comprise three members nominated jointly by the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust

and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, one from among Tata Sons' board, and one independent outsider; the committee's own chairman is chosen by the trusts from among their nominees; and quorum requires a majority of the trust nominees.

The appointment of a successor now requires a fresh perspective. The ideal candidate must possess deep relationships across the bureaucracy, ministries, and regulatory bodies, demonstrate proven experience in leading large conglomerates, and exhibit a strong appetite for risk. At the same time, this individual must be capable of navigating an increasingly complex global environment shaped by geopolitical uncertainties and rapid technological advancements.

This must be seen as an opportunity by the group to build further longevity. The Tata Group has a unique holding structure, with philanthropies as the ultimate parent. For the group to truly outlive individuals, it must place its trust in seasoned professionals — both at the executive and board levels of Tata Sons — while safeguarding its core philosophy of responsible citizenship. Defining the mandate, responsibilities, and deliverables of the chairperson of Tata Sons will be central to this effort.

Equally, Tata Sons must also evolve its operating style. Its silence is no longer acceptable in the age of social media. The group's continued lack of response to controversies has allowed the narrative to be controlled by others, slowly denting its image and brand as a reputable, well-governed group known for its contribution to society and the larger societal cause.

Leadership transitions at the Tata Group have historically been fraught with contention, each shaped by its own circumstances. N Chandrasekaran's decision not to seek a third term may be less divisive, yet his successor will inherit a new set of challenges. The most pressing among them will be to reconcile differences, reimagine the group's structure, and chart a path that secures both stability and renewal.

Dalal is president and COO, and Tandon is managing director of Institutional Investor Advisory Services India Limited



SABINE AMEER

A country in which half the population is systematically excluded from public life cannot meaningfully be described as at peace

killed when a Sudan Airways Fokker Friendship was shot down by rebels near the south Sudanese town of Malakal, the official Sudanese News Agency (SUNA) reported. It said the plane carried 57 passengers and an unknown number of crew, when it was hit during a flight from Malakal airport to Khartoum. East African aviation sources in Nairobi said the crew radioed a final plea for help at 0829 GMT, just after the plane took off.

Soviet MI-26 for Air Force

THE INDIAN Air Force (IAF) is going in for a military heavy-lift helicopter called MI-26 from the Soviet Union to augment its helicopter fleet, it is learnt. The MI-26, which has been code-named “Halo-7” by NATO coun-

tries, is believed to be the heaviest and most powerful helicopter in use in the world.

Housing projects on hold

THE MINISTRY of Urban Development has received a severe jolt with most of its projects in the field of housing finance and urban improvement still pending clearance in the Finance Ministry — more than six months after their submission. The projects were submitted to the Finance Ministry after prolonged deliberations among various housing agencies amid much fanfare in the Ministry of Urban Development, which proclaimed that the implementation of the projects would bring about a revolution in the field of housing construction in the country.

The writer is a contributing researcher with ORF

40 YEARS AGO

August 18, 1986



Police firing in Pakistan

SEVERAL HUNDRED demonstrators burned tyres and barricaded streets in the southern part of Karachi with oil drums and vehicles, hurling rocks at the police, who responded with tear gas. One person was killed as the police opened fire on anti-government demonstrators who stormed the streets for the fifth consecutive day. The demonstrators engaged the police in battles marked by gunfire and rock-throwing to protest against five deaths in police firing in Lahore and the arrests of hundreds of opposition leaders.

Sudanese rebels down plane

ABOUT 60 passengers and crew were feared



What will we sing of now, when we sing of patriotism



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

GULZAR HAS called on the new generation of Indians to come up with an anthem for our times. Not a replacement for 'Jana Gana Mana', the national anthem, or 'Vande Mataram', the national song, subject to a lot of unnecessary excitement of late. But a song, a *qaumi tarana* as he calls it, that supplements our official tracks, that can be hummed by crores of young Indians, that can invoke deep feelings of belonging to a community called India.

In his opening remarks to the video rendering of his latest song, he points out an obvious void: All the patriotic songs we use today are dated, some by a century. We need something new. His own new song, 'Ekakela Hidustani, do banate to Hindustan', is a subtle message against divisive politics and an invocation of diversity, so necessary in our times. Like 'Mile sur mera tumhara', there is a feel-good quality to it, even if the music video is a tad extravagant. Yet, even a card-carrying Gulzar fan like me would not say this is the song we have been looking for. The poet himself does not claim to have filled the void. He challenges us. He invites us.

Thankfully, the national anthem and the national song have not lost their motivational quality. T M Krishna's latest book, *We The People of India: Decoding A Nation's Symbols*, devotes a chapter to tracing the journey of both these songs. For me, like most Indians of my generation, springing up to attention whenever we heard 'Jana Gana Mana', often to the annoyance of radical friends, was not just a school drill. The ritual invoked something deeper, something that grew with time as its meaning unfolded. The anti-CAA protest re-enchanted the national anthem, infusing it with fresh meanings and energies. I find 'Vande Mataram' no less stirring — unlike most musi-

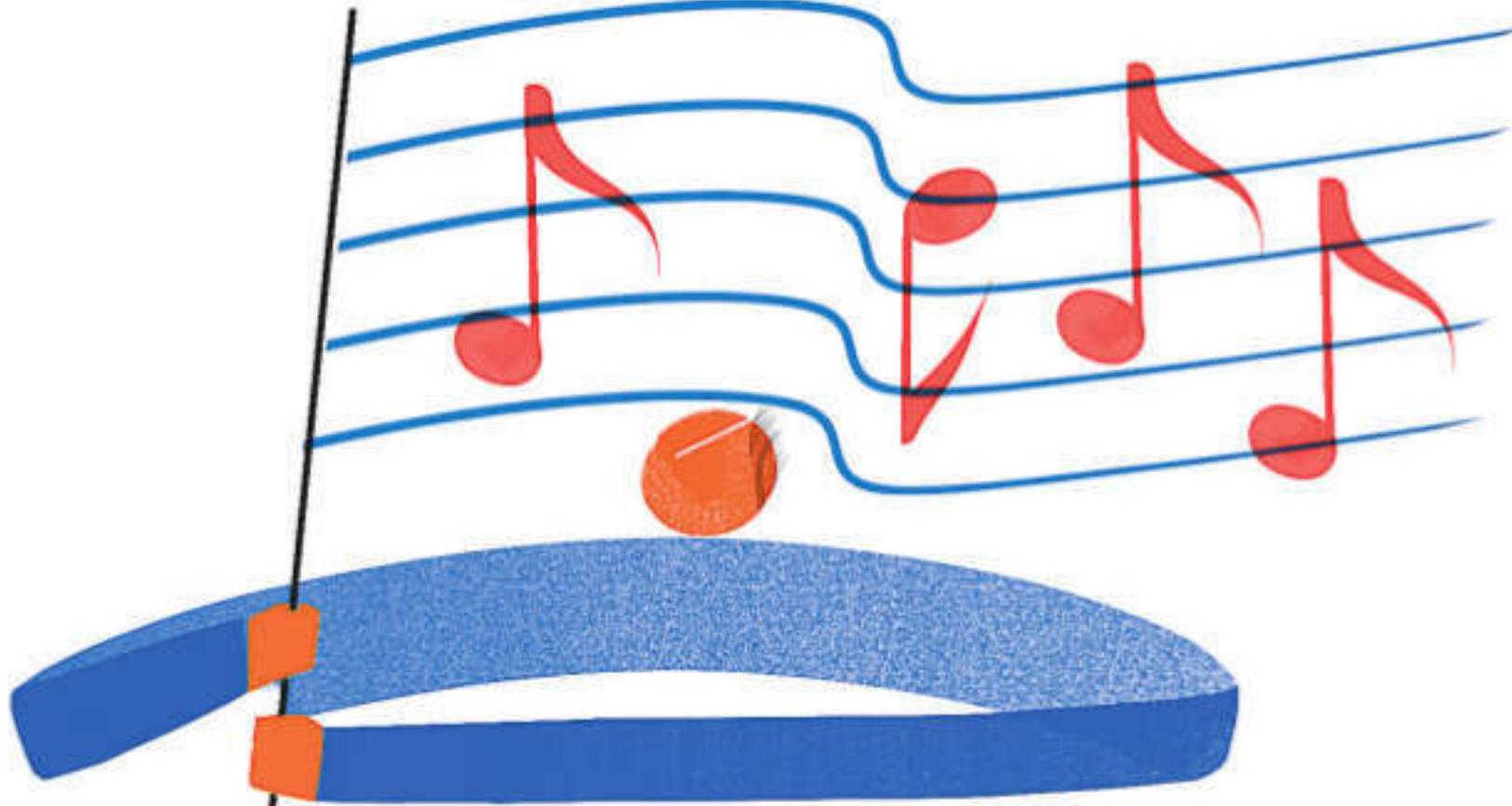


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

cally tuned friends, I prefer the filmi version of *Anand Math* over the official Akashvani composition — though it is a song of longing for a nation, not quite for a nation that has come into being. Yet, these officially sanctified, and often mechanically regulated, songs remain too lofty, too sacred, to be hummed in any other context.

I grew up in an India where *deshbhakti* songs did not invite disbelief or ridicule. 'Saare jahan se achchha' — here I prefer the melodious over the military band composition — was still the one song inherited from the freedom struggle that moved us. 'Mazhab nahin sikhata apas mein bair rakhna' was echoed by 'Tu Hindu banega na Musلمان banega'. These songs did not just remind you of the value of freedom ("apni azadi ko hum hargij mita sakte nahin"), they invited every Indian into the project of nation-building ('Saathi haath badhana' or 'Chhodo kal ki baten'). Indian nationalism was not about being one-up on our neighbour or our enemy. India was defined by openness to the universe: "*Jo jisase mila seekha hamne/gairon ko bhi apnaya hamne*".

We, the children of the 1960s and 1970s, were often the target of these songs ('Aao bachcho tumhe

Today, a song for India needs more than just a creative genius. It needs nothing short of reimagining India. We live in times where voices from the margins cannot be wished away in weaving a new tapestry of the nation

dikhayen' or 'Hum layen hain toofan se') that invited us to a republic of virtues. These lines from 'Insaaf ki dagar pe' still move me to tears: "*Insaniyat ke sar pe izzat ka taj rakhna/tan man ki bhent dekar Bharat ki laaj rakhna*". This was my nationalism. Serving humanity was the way to honour my motherland. The three wars of 1962, 1965 and 1971 foregrounded grief ('Ae mere watan ke logon') and sacrifice ('Kar chale ham fida') but did not unleash jingoism. Even the Manoj Kumar variety of flat nationalism spoke of love as the marker of Bharat ('Hai preet jahan ki reet sada'). Watching cinema was taboo in my childhood. So I connected to the national imagination through these songs on the radio rather than on screen.

Something changed after that. Maybe I grew up and was unwilling to suspend

disbelief. Maybe the country was taking a different turn, unable to sustain the earlier credulity. In any case, my political self could not connect with the popular songs of the day.

Poetry made more sense to me. Apoorvanand's book *Kavita me Janatantra* captures something of the journey of Hindi poetry through the political lens. For me, Raghuvveer Sahay's sting-

In J&K, a facade of normalcy cannot substitute for peace



MEHBOOBA MUFTI

THE ADMINISTRATIVE order circulating in Anantnag directing government employees to participate in a "Tiranga Rally" is not an isolated instance. It is symptomatic of a style of governance that has increasingly come to define Jammu and Kashmir since the Government of India took direct control of the region following the illegal abrogation of Article 370 in August 2019.

What is most striking about the order is not the national flag itself, but its coercive tone. When participation in a government-sponsored event becomes an administrative obligation, are we witnessing genuine public enthusiasm or merely another carefully choreographed display of "normalcy"?

Since 2019, Kashmiris have lived under an extraordinary degree of security and administrative suppression. Raids and investigations by multiple agencies have become a recurring feature of life in the Valley. Government employees have been dismissed over alleged links with militancy or militant sympathisers, leaving families devastated. Thousands have been detained in the aftermath of militant incidents, at times under broad allegations of being "overground workers". Educational and charitable institutions have faced closure or restrictions over alleged links with banned organisations, while properties worth hundreds of crores have been attached under various laws.

On the one hand, the government repeatedly tells the rest of India that Kashmir has entered a new era of peace and normalcy. On the other, extraordinary security measures, raids, detentions, dismissals and restrictions continue to shape the everyday lives of ordinary people.

And then comes another painful reminder that the problem is far from over. On August 12, reports emerged of a purported threat letter attributed to the United Liberation Council, described by authorities and sections of the media as an affiliate of Lashkar-e-Taiba. The letter reportedly named several Kashmiri Pandit government employees and carried their phone numbers. For Kashmiri Pandits, such threats inevitably revive painful memories. Since 2019, 25 members of the community have once again been targeted and killed, including Ajay Pandita Bharti, Rakesh Pandita, Makhan Lal Bindroo, Rahul Bhat, Rajni Bala, Puran Krishan Bhat and Sanjay Sharma.

A tourist arriving in Srinagar may see busy markets, hotels filled with visitors, traffic on the roads and an impressive display of security. Everything may appear normal. But normalcy cannot be measured by what a visitor sees during a few days in the Valley. It must be measured by whether ordinary people feel secure enough to speak freely, whether families believe that the law will protect rather than intimidate them, whether young people see a future for themselves, and whether communities that have suffered displacement and violence genuinely feel safe enough to return and rebuild their lives.

The crackdowns that have followed militant attacks, including large-scale detentions and other punitive measures, have only deepened anxieties about collective punishment. Recently, after the killing of a police constable in south Kashmir, thousands were reportedly detained. When another militant attack resulted in the killing of migrant workers, the familiar cycle of raids, detentions and suspicion followed once again.

Gen Z and Gen Alpha in Kashmir were not responsible for the violence of the 1990s. They were born decades after the worst years of the conflict. They should have been able to grow up without inheriting the baggage of an earlier conflict. Instead, many are growing up watching fathers, brothers, relatives and neighbours being summoned, detained or questioned. They see homes demolished when a member of a family is accused of militancy. They see fear and humiliation become part of everyday life. They see a system in which one section of society is repeatedly assured that everything is normal, while another is continually asked to prove that it is not a threat. What does that do to a young mind? It does not create reconciliation. It creates bruised memories. And bruised memories do not disappear because officials are instructed to display flags.

A government that genuinely wants Kashmiri Pandits to return must create an environment in which they return because they feel safe, not because they are asked to participate in official ceremonies designed to demonstrate that everything is normal. The same principle applies to Kashmiri Muslims. The state must distinguish between a militant and an ordinary citizen; between an accused person and a convicted person; and between a family member and the person accused of committing a crime.

Kashmir needs healing, not another performance of normalcy. That healing will come only through dignity, justice, security, dialogue and a genuinely human approach. Brute force may silence a street for a while. It cannot silence a generation's memory. A facade of normalcy may impress visitors. It cannot substitute for real peace.

The writer is former chief minister of Jammu and Kashmir

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

PM's speech

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi's newest coinage, "Dimagi Naxals" or "Intellectual Naxals", which he used in his Independence Day address to the nation without explicitly stating whom he had in mind or whom he meant by it, has caused a political storm ('In youth-driven Viksit Bharat, celebrate "dimag", *IE*, August 17). He merely said that "Dimagi Naxals" need to be identified and isolated without elaborating. He gave room to suspect that he may have used the label against all those people, be they opposition leaders, activists, journalists, public intellectuals or the youth called "cockroaches", who do not see eye to eye with him.

C David Milton, Maruthancode

History from below

I REMEMBER reading Sumit Sarkar's books during my BA, and it was fascinating to revisit his intellectual journey through this editorial ('The historian who didn't lose hope', *IE*, August 17). As we know, history is often described as being written by the victors. Sarkar's scholarship, however, consistently sought to foreground the experiences of the subaltern. His deep engagement with the lives of the marginalised is evident in his writings. What makes his work particularly significant is his ability to question established narratives and bring to the fore voices often left unheard.

Nawal Thorat, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar

THE REFLECTIONS on Sumit Sarkar underline the value of scholarship that remains rigorous yet open to changing evidence ('The historian who didn't lose hope', *IE*, August 17). Historians help society examine its past without political convenience determining conclusions. Universities should protect academic freedom, support archives and encourage debate across differing interpretations. Young researchers need reliable sources and fellowships. A healthy democracy benefits when history is studied critically and honestly, rather than reduced to slogans or selective memory.

S Durga Arunkumar



SAUMITRA BHADURI AND SHUBHAM ANAND

A COUNTRY can defend its currency in two ways. It can earn more dollars or it can borrow them. The two look alike when the money arrives, but they are not the same. India's latest external-sector stabilisation largely falls into the second kind.

Between June 8 and August 13, banks mobilised \$52.3 billion in foreign-currency inflows under the RBI's special swap facility, with FCNR(B) deposits accounting for the bulk of the funds raised. The RBI has closed the FCNR(B) swap window a month earlier than originally scheduled. At a time when the rupee was under pressure, this has been read as a vote of confidence. However, the question is why the money needed such inducement or recorded such a sharp fall as soon as it was withdrawn.

Because confidence had left. The rupee was Asia's worst-performing currency in 2025-26. Foreign portfolio investors had pulled out billions. They turned net buyers in July, bringing in about \$2.1 billion. However, that is still a modest reversal relative to the scale of the preceding exodus. It is too early to read this as investors rediscovering India.

The question is why this works when reassurance does not. Because currency markets move not only on fundamentals but on expectations. Once investors believe depreciation is one-way, good data stops persuading them. The way to break that loop is to make the bet

When the RBI absorbs hedging costs, the exposure moves onto the public balance sheet. When banks raise three-to-five-year money and lend against it, the risk resurfaces as an asset-liability mismatch

The rupee's borrowed breathing space

against the rupee expensive. That is what the FCNR(B) window does.

FCNR(B) deposits let non-resident Indians hold foreign currency with Indian banks, free of rupee risk, with tax-free interest and full repatriation. Banks raise fresh three-to-five-year deposits, swap the dollars with the RBI, and the central bank absorbs the hedging cost. Once that cost is lifted, banks can offer dollar rates near 6-7.5 per cent, and some add leverage of 9-19 times. For a wealthy depositor borrowing abroad and placing the proceeds here at a protected high yield, this is a carry trade with the currency risk removed by someone else.

Who is that "someone else"? That is the question the enthusiasm skips. The pace of mobilisation measures the incentive more than belief in Indian assets. Flows surged only after the subsidy appeared. Confidence that materialises only after the price is raised is not confidence. It is a purchase.

So, what has India bought? Time, and a quiet transfer of risk.

To be fair, the fundamentals are not in crisis. Reserves are large, services exports and remittances cushion the account, and part of the rupee's weakness reflects the strong dollar. But being out of crisis is not the same as being secure. India slipped into a current-account deficit in May. Against that backdrop, the surge in FCNR(B) deposits is best viewed as a balance-of-payments stabiliser rather than a durable

source of dollars. They are ultimately a form of external borrowing and create future repayment and rollover obligations.

Here is the part that deserves more attention. The scheme does not make the rupee's risk disappear. It relocates it. When the RBI absorbs hedging costs, the exposure moves onto the public balance sheet. When banks raise three-to-five-year money and lend against it, the risk resurfaces as an asset-liability mismatch. A visible currency problem today can become a less visible banking problem tomorrow.

There is a further reason not to relax: These deposits will mature. Every dollar arriving now must be repaid in three to five years.

What should India do with a window it has paid to open? Treat it as a purchased pause, and spend it well.

The RBI deserves credit for acting decisively. But, if India earns too few dollars, no better way of borrowing will solve it. The answer lies in building export-surplus sectors, attracting FDI, cutting energy import dependence, and treating tourism as a foreign-exchange industry.

The FCNR(B) surge proves India can summon diaspora dollars quickly when needed. However, it also shows that rupee stability increasingly rests on liabilities the country has paid to attract and must one day repay.

Bhaduri is professor, Madras School of Economics, and Anand is PhD scholar, MSE

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Legal aid defence needs reform, not retreat

pendence of the legal profession and affecting the livelihoods of practising advocates.

These concerns should be viewed in light of a number of factors. For 2025-26, the NALSA dashboard on LADCs reports that 4,86,354 cases were assigned to LADCs, including 1,88,878 bail cases. Compared with the overall criminal caseload reflected in the National Judicial Data Grid (NJDG), these constitute a small proportion. The NJDG indicates that 24,68,339 criminal cases were instituted in a single month, which roughly translates to 2.96 crore criminal cases in a year. Against this, the 4.86 lakh cases assigned to LADCs represent approximately 1.6 per cent of criminal cases instituted. The numbers raise a basic question: Where is the threat to private criminal practice?

To see quality legal services as a threat to private lawyers is quite simply a lost oppor-

tunity to raise the bar. If private lawyers feel a more structured legal aid system threatens their work, perhaps it is an opportunity for introspection. One reason for the popularity of LADCs is the diligence with which many undertake their work — prompt appearances at production and remand hearings; filing appropriate and timely petitions challenging violations of procedural law and protecting their client's rights. The traditional

The 4.86 lakh cases assigned to LADCs represent approximately 1.6 per cent of criminal cases instituted. The numbers raise a basic question: Where is the threat to private criminal practice?

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vn2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F> assigned-counsel system, where private lawyers are empanelled to provide free legal aid, has often been criticised for missing hearings, delayed applications and complaints regarding fees paid by the state.

The interests of lawyers must be balanced against the fair trial rights of the accused. But a functioning system of legal representation should not be reconsidered without first asking what it has achieved and where it needs improvement.

This brings us to another concern — the interim arrangement for assigning legal-aid matters to young lawyers. Are young and relatively inexperienced lawyers equipped to undertake a full range of criminal defence work, including trials? Criminal defence requires experience in case preparation, cross-examination, bail and remand proceedings, trial strategy and navigating the

criminal justice system. Those unable to afford private lawyers should not become a testing ground.

Concerns around the LADC system must therefore be examined against evidence. There has, as yet, been no national assessment of the LADC system. Discontinuing or stalling a scheme, duly adopted and implemented by a statutory body, without an assessment and consideration of its impact on ongoing cases, is an injustice to the legal-aid system itself. If the LADC system has demonstrated that dedicated lawyers, institutional oversight and accountability can improve the quality of criminal defence, the response should be to learn from it — not dismantle it.

The writer is a lawyer and expert on criminal justice reforms, legal aid and pre-trial detention

CENTRE TO FORM HIGH-POWERED PANEL ON BANKING REFORMS FOR VIKSIT BHARAT SOON

FM-bankers meet: Mobilisation of deposits, banking for GenZ in focus

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, August 17

ADDRESSING THE banking needs of Gen Z and ways to boost deposit mobilisation took centre stage at a key two-day meeting of the public sector banks and the Ministry of Finance starting Monday, where heads of key financial institutions are expected to produce “workable ideas” for banking sector reforms.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said banks are in a better position to take up reforms as non-performing assets (NPAs) are at the lowest level ever, adding that the future of banking must reflect the aspirations of India’s youth, with 29% of India’s population between 15 and 29 years of age. The ‘high-level committee for banking’ with a focus on “banking for Viksit Bharat”, which was announced in this year’s Budget, will be announced soon, she said.

“Intensive discussions today and tomorrow come at a time when we expect the announcement of the high-powered committee to look into banking for Viksit Bharat. The recommendations [after this discussion] would help us to clearly understand where the committee wants India to go towards Viksit

Bharat and in that the role of banks,” Sitharaman said. The minister further said, “it is your output that I am keenly looking forward to because once the committee gives its input, it’s for us to rapidly move in that direction, understanding that the Viksit Bharat 2047 is actually not too far away. We are in 2026, so less than or short of 20 years is what we have before us”.

The meeting was structured around seven themes covering key areas of opportunity for PSBs and PFIs, including ‘deposit mobilisation’, ‘banking for youth’, ‘supporting the investment cycle’, ‘global capability centres’, agriculture & horticulture value chain infrastructure, priority sector lending and ‘re-imagining credit card business’.

A banking sector executive who participated in the meeting told The Indian Express that several ideas were discussed, particularly on how to mobilise deposits and “finance the aspirations of the youth”. “There have been discussions on new structured products which give more flexibility and better returns. For instance, when we talk about mobilisation of deposits, we are looking at what type of credit flows are required to achieve the kind of GDP needed



FM Nirmala Sitharaman said banks are in a better position to take up reforms as NPAs are at the lowest level ever. PRAVEEN KHANNA
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mlJMzgl
group of 15-29 years.

The discussion comes as India’s household debt has surged in recent years, and financial sector regulators are particularly concerned about the composition of that debt. Non-housing retail loans — largely used for consumption — now account for more than half of household borrowings, and have grown faster than housing, agriculture and business loans, a trend flagged in internal discussions among policymakers, as this newspaper had reported earlier.

Another banker said the meeting was very focused on addressing the needs of the youth at every level, starting from education to various levels, particularly in the age

FM asks states to address land, connectivity bottlenecks

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday said industrial corridors are an important pillar to expand manufacturing and urged states to resolve bottlenecks relating to land, connectivity, utilities, and statutory clearances.

Chairing the third meeting of the apex monitoring authority of the National Industrial Corridor Development and Implementation Trust (NICDIT) here, she stressed that the focus must now move beyond project approvals towards timely completion of infrastructure, land allotment, investment and commencement of production.

“She urged States to resolve bottlenecks relating to land, connectivity, utilities, statutory clearances and the powers of project Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs),” the commerce and industry ministry said in a statement. PTI

Govt nod to 31 more applications for electronic components mfg sops

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, August 17

THE MINISTRY of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has approved 31 more applications under the Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), entailing a proposed investment of Rs 7,877 crore, as the government looks to deepen domestic manufacturing beyond finished electronic products and into components and sub-assemblies.

The projects, spread across 10 states, are expected to lead to production worth Rs 82,243 crore and create close to 10,000 direct jobs, IT Secretary S Krishnan said Monday.

The latest approvals cover a wide range of products, including capital goods, camera and display modules, anode materials, enclosures, connectors, rare-earth permanent magnets, optical transceivers, speakers and microphones, antennas, capacitors, coils and

The government looks to deepen domestic manufacturing beyond finished electronic products and into components and sub-assemblies

filters, among others. An enhanced investment in copper-clad laminates by Wipro Global, which had received an earlier approval, is also part of the latest tranche.

With this, the government has approved 106 applications covering around 30 product categories across 15 states under the scheme. Cumulative proposed investment from the approved projects has reached Rs 69,548 crore, crossing the scheme’s original investment target of Rs 59,350 crore. Expected production from these

projects stands at Rs 5.34 lakh crore, compared with an original target of Rs 4.56 lakh crore. The selected companies, so far, have committed to create close to 75,000 jobs, as opposed to the scheme’s total target of 91,600.

Some of the projects approved earlier under the scheme have already started production. ATL’s lithium-ion cell facilities at Rewari and Sohna, and Tata Electronics’ enclosure plant in Hosur, are currently operational, IT Secretary S Krishnan said. Several others are nearing commissioning: Kaynes Circuits’ PCB plant near Chennai is expected to start operations within about a month, Motherson’s enclosure facility in Kanchipuram and Wipro Global’s copper-clad laminate plant in the next two-three months, while Dixon’s display and camera module facility in Noida is expected to go live within four months.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Tata Sons AGM faces quorum uncertainty

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 17

WHILE EFFORTS are underway to ensure the smooth conduct of Tata Sons’ annual general meeting (AGM) scheduled for August 18, the meeting is likely to be adjourned if there is a lack of quorum. The regulatory freeze imposed on the Sir Ratan Tata Trust has left the Tata holding company unable to secure the shareholder representation required to convene the meeting.

The issue stems from Tata Sons’ Articles of Association, which stipulates that at least five members must be personally present to constitute a quorum. Crucially, the quorum must include an authorised representative jointly nominated by the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust. “Efforts are on to conduct the AGM smoothly,” said a source.

All the parties concerned — including Tata Trusts, the Shapoorji Pallonji Group, Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran and other shareholders — are keen to ensure that the upcoming AGM proceeds smoothly without any disruption. The meeting is particularly significant for shareholders, as the dividend payout will be formally approved at the AGM, paving the way for them to receive the declared dividend in their hands.

Additionally, the AGM will have to consider and approve the resolution for the reappointment of Chandrasekaran as a director. Given the importance of both resolutions, all stakeholders have a clear interest in ensuring that it takes place without any hitch.

“When the AGM clears the

dividend, shareholders get the money in their hands. Further, the resolution for the reappointment of Chandrasekaran as director will also have to be cleared by the AGM,” said a Tata source.

The issue arises from the inability of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which holds a 23.56% stake in Tata Sons, to convene a board meeting following an order issued by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner in May. The order has effectively prevented the trust from conducting its board proceedings while an inquiry into the composition of its board is pending.

This has created a procedural hurdle for Tata Sons. In the absence of a duly convened SRTT board meeting, the trust cannot jointly nominate a representative with the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT). Such a joint nomination is required under the Articles of Association of Tata Sons to meet the quorum requirements for its AGM.

As a result, the Charity Commissioner’s order has implications beyond SRTT’s internal governance, potentially affecting Tata Sons’ ability to proceed with its AGM in accordance with the requirements set out in its corporate charter.

A possible way forward would be for the existing “lifetime trustees” of SRTT to voluntarily relinquish their status as lifetime trustees and, thereafter, renominate themselves as trustees for a fixed and clearly defined tenure. Such a restructuring could bring the trust’s governance framework into conformity with the amended Maharashtra Public Trusts Act.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

CERC lets RE developers retain grid connectivity despite project delays

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, August 17

IN A major relief for renewable energy developers, the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC) has introduced a compensation-based mechanism allowing projects that miss key implementation deadlines to retain their grid connectivity and seek additional time to complete them, instead of facing automatic revocation of transmission access.

Renewable developers can lose their connectivity if they fail to meet three major project deadlines: submitting land ownership documents, achieving financial closure, or missing their commercial operationalisation deadline.

As per the data from Central Transmission Utility of India Ltd (CTUIL), at least 5.3 gigawatts (GW) of renewable energy capacity is expected to face connectivity revocation up to October for failure to achieve commercial operationalisation date.

The latest order comes as some renewable energy developers have approached the CERC seeking additional time to achieve the milestones after receiving notices from CTUIL.

“The entities seeking such time are at various stages of implementation of the project, including some at an advanced stage of implementation. Several such cases have been disposed of by this commission, giving additional time on payment of compensation,” the CERC order read.

It stressed the need for an immediate requirement to handle such cases uniformly, in which entities have made prog-



At least 5.3 GW of renewable energy capacity is expected to face connectivity revocation up to October. REUTERS

ress towards project implementation and are seeking additional time to meet the milestones under the General Network Access Regulations.

“It is noted that such entities have been holding on to the connectivity, a scarce resource; therefore, additional time should be allowed, with payment of compensation, irrespective of the reasons for such delay, in a graded manner to ensure the earliest compliance with the milestones,” it added.

Eligibility to qualify for extension

In its order, CERC specifies that developers must meet strict eligibility criteria, such as securing a minimum percentage of required land, to qualify for these extensions. Compensation would be levied based on the specific milestone for which an extension is sought, with rates generally increasing over time to encourage early compliance. Clean energy developers will have to pay Rs 1,000 per megawatt (MW) per day to obtain extra time for land and financial closure, while Rs 3,000 per MW per day for delays in starting commercial operations.

To qualify for an extension, an entity must demonstrate project progress by meeting minimum thresholds at least 15 working days prior to the original milestone deadline.

For land and financial closure, the developer must furnish land documents for at least 20% of the required land. For extensions in commercial operation date, entities would be required to furnish land documents of 50% to 75% of the required land depending on the project type.

Developers can get up to three additional months to complete land requirements, six months to achieve financial closure and as much as 12 months to commission projects, it read.

If these projects still fail to meet the deadlines, they risk losing their grid connectivity and associated bank guarantees. The order also clarified that 100% of the compensation collected for delays in commercial operations, and 50% of the compensation collected for allowing additional time to submit land documents and achieve financial closure, would be used to reduce the Monthly Transmission Charges for other users under the Sharing Regulations, 2020.

• BRIEFLY

Rupee falls as RBI shuts FCNR(B) window early

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India’s (RBI’s) decision to prematurely close its concessional swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits, coupled with a rise in crude oil prices to nearly \$90 a barrel, sent the rupee lower on Monday, though intervention by the central bank prevented a sharper slide. Despite a softer dollar, the rupee was the worst-performing currency in Asia, depreciating 0.2% to close at a 17-day low of 95.61 against the dollar as importers rushed to take forward cover. Exporters are holding back dollar sales even as importers are stepping up purchases. FE

BSE, PHDCCI ink pact for MSME capital access

New Delhi: Stock exchange BSE Ltd and PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry (PHDCCI) on Monday announced a partnership to promote equity financing and expand capital-market access for MSMEs. The two organisations signed a Memorandum of Understanding to create greater awareness among MSMEs about equity financing, particularly through the BSE SME platform, and help eligible businesses navigate the listing process. BSE MD and CEO Sundararaman Ramamurthy said the partnership would help take awareness about SME listing closer to businesses. PTI

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold	US Dollar
77,728.16	24,287.65	₹1,54,167	₹95.61
-281.09	-78.35		
-0.36%	-0.32%	Silver	Oil
		₹2,35,642	\$91.16

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG, CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 14, 2026

• BARRING SOME PROGRESS IN ARGENTINA, GOVT’S FLAGSHIP OVERSEAS ACQUISITION VEHICLE KABIL HAS STRUGGLED TO MAKE A MARK

Why India is finding it difficult to buy critical mineral assets abroad, expand footprint

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, August 17

INDIA’S EFFORTS to secure critical mineral assets overseas are facing a series of hurdles, ranging from high asset valuations, volatile mineral prices, financial constraints, to socio-political risks in resource-rich countries.

Incorporated in 2019, the government’s flagship overseas acquisition vehicle, Khanij Bidesh India Ltd (KABIL) — a joint venture of National Aluminium Company Ltd, Hindustan Copper Ltd, and Mineral Exploration & Consultancy Ltd — is mandated to identify, explore and acquire overseas

critical mineral assets to help meet India’s growing demand for these strategic resources.

However, barring some progress in Argentina, KABIL has struggled to expand its overseas footprint in other mineral-rich countries, including Australia, Vietnam, Mali, and Chile, as proposed investments in critical mineral extraction projects have either stalled or fallen through.

In Argentina, KABIL has so far acquired five lithium brine blocks in Catamarca province. It is also evaluating seven additional greenfield lithium blocks in Catamarca and is in discussions for two more lithium projects in Jujuy province.

Lithium projects lost to POSCO

In December 2024, a consortium comprising KABIL, Coal India Ltd (CIL), Oil India Ltd (OIL), and ONGC Videsh Ltd (OVL) submitted a non-binding offer (NBO) of \$184 million to acquire 10% equity stake each in the Mt Marion and Wodgina lithium mines in Australia. The proposed transaction involved acquiring a 20% stake in the holding company, Mineral Resources Ltd, which owned 50% stakes in both mines. After the process was reopened, the consortium submitted a revised NBO of \$233 million in September 2025, seeking to acquire a 20% stake in each of the two



Proposed investments in critical mineral extraction projects have either stalled or fallen through. REUTERS

mines. This would have entailed acquiring a 40% stake in Mineral Resources Ltd.

But the assets were ultimately acquired by South Korean steel and chemical

major POSCO, which paid \$765 million for 15% stake each in the Wodgina and Mt Marion mines, equivalent to a 30% stake in Mineral Resources Ltd.

When a parliamentary

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>
panel, whose report was tabled in the Parliament on August 12, sought details from KABIL on the unsuccessful bid, the company outlined several key lessons from the failed attempt. These included the absence of a

domestic value chain for spodumene concentrate, the end product of the Mt Marion and Wodgina projects, high volatility in lithium prices, significant variations in long-term spodumene concentrate price forecasts published by different market intelligence agencies, and the high valuation of assets amid intense competition for lithium projects.

KABIL also failed to submit

stage access to the project’s “data room”. In its response to the parliamentary panel, KABIL said that given the scale of investment involved,

it decided to pursue a joint bid with other public sector undertakings, including CIL, OIL, and OVL. “Due diligence by the partnering companies was initiated. Due to limited time period, bid could not be submitted,” it said. In another case

involving Chile’s state-owned mining company ENAMI, KABIL had signed an NDA to evaluate potential business opportunities across the lithium value chain, including exploration, extraction, processing, and commercialisation. However, KABIL decided to hand over the opportunity to CIL, citing its “limited financial capacity” and the investment requirements associated with developing the five lithium brine blocks it acquired in Argentina in January 2024.

Queries sent to KABIL and the Ministry of Mines remained unanswered till press time.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

No breakthrough in Kushner’s talks with Israel & Hamas on Trump’s Gaza plan

Alexander Cornwell
Jerusalem, August 17

DONALD TRUMP’S envoy and son-in-law Jared Kushner on Monday wrapped up two days of meetings with Israeli and Hamas leaders to break a stalemate over the US president’s Gaza plan, but there were no signs of an imminent breakthrough as both sides dug in. Kushner met Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in Israel a day after meeting Hamas’s political leader in Egypt in a bid to revive the plan, which has stalled as Israel has carried out air strikes and seized more territory in Gaza despite an October ceasefire, while Hamas has refused to give up its weapons.

Trump last month announced that Hamas had agreed to lay down its arms in phases, under a 15-point roadmap put forward by his so-called Board of Peace to advance the president’s plan, as Israel’s military withdraws from Gaza. Hamas said it agreed to the roadmap but implementation depended on Israel first meeting its own commitments, including halting attacks and withdrawing. Netanyahu, whose ruling coalition is trailing in Israeli



Khaled Qaddoumi, the Hamas representative in Iran, speaks during a press conference in Tehran on Monday. AP

opinion polls ahead of an October national election, earlier this month rejected the roadmap, insisting Israel would not withdraw until Hamas is completely disarmed. An Israeli official indicated that there was no breakthrough in the meeting, saying Netanyahu had made it clear the military would not withdraw from a demarcation line set out in an October ceasefire and would continue to carry out operations in Gaza as it sees necessary. The Israeli official said Netanyahu and Kushner agreed in the meeting that the reconstruction of Gaza would not begin until Hamas was fully disarmed, including of light weapons. REUTERS

TRUMP SAYS HE WILL BOMB OMAN IF IT ‘GETS IN THE WAY’

Iran vows to go on offensive in Strait if talks with US fail

Tehran has been negotiating a deal on Hormuz with Oman separately

Parisa Hafezi & Katharine Jackson
Dubai, Washington, August 17

IRAN HAS decided to shift its policy from defensive to “fully offensive” due to the deadlock in efforts to agree a permanent end to its war with the United States, a senior Iranian official told Reuters on Monday.

Progress towards peace talks and a resumption of oil tanker traffic through the strategic Strait of Hormuz has ground to a halt, with no sign that the warring parties are moving towards ending the conflict that the US and Israel launched on February 28.

“Iranian entities must be prepared to escalate tensions in the Strait of Hormuz and wider region, as Iran will be ready to make decisions and take action on difficult decisions,” the Iranian official said, adding that Tehran would conduct a “timely and precise” military attack to break the US naval



Vessels near the Strait of Hormuz, seen from Oman on Monday. REUTERS

blockade if diplomacy failed.

There was no immediate response to those comments from Washington, but US President Donald Trump said in a phone interview with Fox News on Monday that Iran “should put up the white flag of surrender”.

Monday marked the day by which Iran and the US were expected to reach a final deal under a memorandum of understanding agreed in June and aimed at ending the war. Signed on June 17, the MoU set out a 60-day timeframe, extendable by mutual consent, by which Washington and Tehran should reach a broader agreement on issues including limiting Tehran’s nuclear programme and lifting US sanctions.

That interim deal, which declared the “immediate and permanent termination of military operations on all fronts”, quickly unravelled, however, due to a dispute over control of the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow waterway through which a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas flowed before the war.

Tehran said point 5 of the MoU gave it the right to manage the strait, which it shares with Oman, while Washington rejected that interpretation. Hostilities resumed as Tehran began

Houthi say they attacked Saudi military vessels

YEMEN’S Houthi attacked what they described as a Saudi military ship and four escort vessels in the Red Sea with missiles, according to the group’s military spokesperson Yahya Saree on Telegram on Monday. There was no immediate confirmation from Saudi authorities. Mocha is a Red Sea port near the Babel-Mandeb Strait, a strategic chokepoint connecting the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden and an important international shipping route.

US tourist dies after being struck by lightning

AN AMERICAN tourist was killed by a lightning strike on Sicily’s Mount Etna while hiking in an area that was closed to visitors due to recent volcanic activity, Italian firefighters said Monday. The 29-year-old man from Kansas was rescued by helicopter after being struck Sunday evening in an exposed area above the tree line. He was later declared dead by medical personnel. His name was not released. AP

• BRIEFLY

UNITED KINGDOM

PM exchanged messages with impostor posing as Susie Wiles



British Prime Minister Andy Burnham. FILE

BRITISH PM Andy Burnham exchanged messages with an impostor posing as US President Donald Trump’s chief of staff, according to reports published Monday. A spokesperson for Burnham declined to comment, saying it was policy not to discuss “national security matters.” Politico cited four unnamed officials in first reporting that Burnham thought he was messaging with Susie Wiles before he became suspicious and cut off communications. Last year, the US government investigated a series of messages that elected officials, business executives and other prominent figures in the country received messages from someone posing as Wiles. Soon after those incidents, the State Department warned US diplomats of attempts to impersonate Secretary of State Marco Rubio and possibly other officials using AI. AP

ITALY

US tourist dies after being struck by lightning

AN AMERICAN tourist was killed by a lightning strike on Sicily’s Mount Etna while hiking in an area that was closed to visitors due to recent volcanic activity, Italian firefighters said Monday. The 29-year-old man from Kansas was rescued by helicopter after being struck Sunday evening in an exposed area above the tree line. He was later declared dead by medical personnel. His name was not released. AP

IRAQ

Drones strike the office of Kurdistan PM

TWO DRONES targeted the office of the Kurdistan Regional Government’s prime minister in northern Iraq on Monday but there were no reports of any casualties, the KRG security agency said. The attack was launched from Iranian territory, it said in a statement, without clarifying whether the drones had hit their target. There was no claim of responsibility from any group for the attack. REUTERS

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

SRI LANKA

Managers of 4 banks held in \$1-bn fraud case

MANAGERS OF four private banks were arrested in Sri Lanka in connection with a case involving the transfer of USD 1 billion overseas under the pretext of imports, police said on Monday. The arrests are linked to the recent arrest of a foreign exchange dealer for transferring money overseas without any import documentation, according to the Financial Crimes Investigation Division of the police. PTI

PAKISTAN

Nine hurt in three separate landmine blasts

NINE PEOPLE were injured in three separate landmine explosions in Pakistan’s KPK, police said on Monday. According to the police, the three explosions occurred in the remote Dandar Sahara area of Kurram on Sunday. In the first incident, a labourer, Hamid Hussain, lost both his legs in the blast. Two more were injured in separate blasts in the area later in the evening. In the third incident, six people were injured. PTI

Ukraine energy plant suffers 13 Russian strikes in a week

Moscow is set to ‘weaponize winter’, say Kyiv officials

Associated Press
Kyiv, August 17

RUSSIA ATTACKED facilities of Ukraine’s Naftogaz Group 13 times over the past week and has targeted its premises almost 300 times since the start of the year, the state energy company said on Monday.

Russia has repeatedly battered the Ukrainian power grid since its all-out invasion more than four years ago. Moscow hopes to sap Ukraine’s will to fight by denying civilians light, heating and running water during the bitter winter



Bookseller Alexander Bahlai reacts as firefighters try to put out a fire at a market following a Russian missile attack in Kyiv on Sunday. AP

months. Ukrainian officials, who say Russia is “weaponizing winter,” fear Moscow will pursue its campaign through the coming winter, too.

Russian drones and missiles struck facilities, with one asset hit multiple times during the

week, Naftogaz said, reporting serious damage to equipment and production capacity.

No employees were hurt in the attacks, the company said. DTEK Group also said a Russian attack started a fire at one of its mines, killing a 52-year-old man.

Las Vegas gang leader planned Tupac Shakur’s murder: Lawyer

Reuters
New York, August 17

A FORMER street gang leader orchestrated the 1996 drive-by shooting of hip-hop star Tupac Shakur in Las Vegas in retribution for the beating of his nephew, a prosecutor told jurors during opening statements in a murder trial tied to a long-unsolved crime that became a seminal moment in rap history. Duane “Keffe D” Davis, 63, is charged in Clark County, Nevada, with a single count of murder using a deadly weapon. He has pleaded not guilty. Davis is accused of leading a group of men to kill Shakur, 25, one of rap’s most commercially successful and influential artists, in a 1996 drive-by shooting near the Las Vegas Strip.

“You will learn that when the opportunity presented itself for retribution, Duane Davis made sure that the shooters were armed and ready to execute their plan. And remarkably, you will learn that from Duane Davis himself,” said prosecutor Binu Palal of the Clark County District Attorney’s Office. Shakur’s killing heightened the image of violence permeating hip-hop culture and its lyrics during “gangsta” rap’s golden age, stoking the East Coast-West Coast rap feud of that era. Police said after Davis’ 2023 arrest that he was a longtime suspect in the killing but that investigators lacked sufficient admissible evidence to charge him.



US Army vehicles gather at a training field in Yeoncheon, South Korea, near the border with North Korea on Monday. AP

South Korea baffled as Trump scales back military drills

Hyung-Jin Kim
Seoul, August 17

SOUTH KOREA on Monday expressed hopes for resumption of diplomacy between the US and North Korea to ease animosities on the Korean Peninsula, hours after US President Donald Trump said he ordered annual US military exercises with South Korea to be scaled back.

Trump cited his good relationship with North Korean leader Kim Jong Un for the decision. The announcement baffled many in South Korea, a key US ally in Asia where national security is a top priority due to threats from nuclear-armed North Korea.

The 11-day, summertime Ulchi Freedom Shield exercises began Monday morning as scheduled and it wasn’t known which parts of the training were being downsized. North Korea did not immediately respond to the announcement. North

Korea previously threatened strong responses to the US-South Korean exercises.

Experts say Trump’s signals his willingness to reengage with Kim, but the North Korean leader, now emboldened by his advancing nuclear arsenal and expanding military cooperation with Russia, won’t likely return to talks unless he is assured of serious US concessions.

Trump said in a social media post that the exercises are not only costly but “send a signal that is totally inappropriate and hostile” to North Korea, which he said “has been unthreatening and respectful” during his time in the White House.

Trump instructed Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth to “substantially reduce” the exercises, he said, adding that he recently asked South Korean President Lee Jae Myung if they would join the US in the “denuclearization” of Iran, “and they said, No thanks!” AP

Thousands in Indonesia await aid after quake toll rises to 68

Associated Press
Reo, August 17

THOUSANDS OF people were still waiting for aid on the Indonesian island of Flores as the country marked its 81st Independence Day on Monday, days after a powerful earthquake killed at least 68 people, injured more than 200 others and damaged hundreds of homes and other buildings.

Many residents on Flores is-

land in East Nusa Tenggara province spent the day mourning victims and waiting for aid to arrive to communities still cut off by the deadly quake.

During Indonesia’s Independence Day ceremony in Jakarta, President Prabowo Subianto asked participants to pray for people affected by disasters in East Nusa Tenggara and other parts of the country, while leading a nationwide moment of silence honouring the na-

tion’s independence heroes.

More than 1,300 homes were damaged when the quake struck East Nusa Tenggara province on Saturday, with nearly 250 destroyed on Flores alone. Some 5,000 people were forced into temporary shelters and 213 people were injured, according to the National Disaster Management Agency or BNPB.

Authorities have recorded 1,576 aftershocks into Monday.

• BEIJING WANTS TO BECOME A LEADING SUPPLIER OF DATA — THE TROVES OF TEXT, IMAGES AND VIDEOS — THAT TRAIN AI SYSTEMS AROUND THE WORLD

China’s grand plan: To shape what AI learns and remembers

David Pierson & Berry Wang
August 17

WHEN CHATGPT was still a new technology, researchers in Beijing tested how well it handled Chinese-language questions. Their response to its results was telling.

The chatbot described former NBA star Yao Ming as the first Chinese woman to play professional basketball in the United States. It confused two classic works of Chinese literature, “Journey to the West” and “Dream of the Red Chamber,” which were written two centuries apart.

The researchers at the Beijing Institute of Technology, who published their findings in 2023, also wrote that ChatGPT generated a large amount of “biased commentary about

China” and “would not evade or refuse to answer political questions about China.”

ChatGPT has since been updated many times; it is unclear how the results would differ now. But the examples pointed to a central concern in China’s quest to become an artificial intelligence power: The systems shaping the future are being trained on datasets that are overwhelmingly in English, and reflect what China sees as a Western way of thinking.

That imbalance is also a strategic vulnerability for the Chinese Communist Party because it means Western views are likely to prevail when it comes to issues such as human rights and the status of Taiwan, the self-governed island claimed by Beijing, analysts say.

To fix this gap, and to build more powerful AI tools, Beijing



Beijing has prioritized AI as a critical strategic technology needed to keep pace with the United States

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 2028. The plan proposed creating “high quality” datasets in more than two dozen strategic fields, including scientific research, industrial manufacturing and autonomous vehicles.

The plan calls on China to share its datasets worldwide. That was reinforced last month

when China pledged to share data to help the dozens of developing countries that attended the World Artificial Intelligence Conference in Shanghai build their own AI systems. China has also already released huge troves of data curated by government labs and state-owned media, making them available for download around the world.

The goal, analysts say, is two-fold: to draw more users into China’s AI orbit and to narrow the gap with the US in access to high-quality training data, which Beijing believes is helping America maintain its lead.

Under China’s top leader, Xi Jinping, Beijing has prioritized AI as a critical strategic technology needed to keep pace with the United States, and to reinvigorate the Chinese economy. To do that, Chinese labs will need

increasingly sophisticated data. On the surface, that should not be a problem. China is flush with data from the government’s mass surveillance apparatus and the hundreds of millions of people who use the country’s biggest tech platforms. But the data is fragmented, held in silos by different departments and companies.

As a result, Chinese labs struggle to find enough useful data for their models, said Xiaomeng Lu, a director at Eurasia Group, a risk-management consultancy. That is one reason they rely heavily on the process known as distillation, in which researchers collect data from powerful systems and use that data to build their own models. (US companies such as Anthropic complain that their Chinese competitors are unfairly copying their technology.) NYT

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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSONS ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely (1) Ik S/o Obanebo (2) James S/o Lagbodika R/o H.No. 25, Kh No. 42/2, 45/12, Upper First Floor Center Side, Shikshak Vihar, Nilothi Extn., Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 1129/2024 U/s 14 Foreigners Act at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) Ik (2) James cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) Ik (2) James have absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused (1) Ik (2) James of FIR No. 1129/2024 U/s 14 Foreigners Act at P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 18.09.2026.

By Order
Komal Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 03
West District, Room No.292, 2nd Floor,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11505/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Ashish S/o Rajaram R/o Mahavir Ka Makan, Machhi Bazar Near Murga Chowk, Tikri Kalan, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case FIR No. 773/2023 U/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS: Mundka, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ashish cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ashish has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ashish accused of FIR No. 773/2023 U/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS: Mundka, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 01.10.2026.

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Singal
JMFC-06, Room No. 355
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11313/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Vikash Pandey S/O Uma Shankar Pandey R/O H.No. RZH-96/C, Nihal Vihar, Nangloi, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case e-FIR No. 80028312/2025 U/s 306/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S. Safdarjung Enclave, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Vikash Pandey cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Vikash Pandey have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Vikash Pandey of e-FIR No. 80028312/2025 U/s U/s 306/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S.: Safdarjung Enclave, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 30.09.2026

By order
Ms. Devanshi Janmeja
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-03
Court No.212, (South) Saket Court
New Delhi

DP/10522/SW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) Rishab Jain Proprietor of M/s Hanumant Textile, At 1/10916, 1st Floor, Gali No 6, Subhash Park, Near Kirti Mandir, Navin Shahdara, Delhi Also At 1/10918, 1st Floor, Gali No. 6, Subhash Park, Near Kirti Mandir, Navin Shahdara, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CC NI Act 972/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Prashant Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Rishab Jain can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Rishab Jain has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) Rishab Jain of case CC NI Act 972/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Prashant Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 28.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Aakash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North Dist., Room No. 213
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11079/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Deepak Raj @ Badshah, S/o: Sumer Singh, R/o: H.No. 268, Gali No. 4, Phase-I, Mangla Puri, Palam, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 356/2017 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S.: Khyala, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Deepak Raj @ Badshah cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Deepak Raj @ Badshah has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Deepak Raj @ Badshah accused of offence in case FIR No. 356/2017 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S.: Khyala, Delhi and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 04.11.2026.

By Order
Ms. Sheetal Rani
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12, (West)
Room No. 152, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10752/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Annu Sharma W/o Sanjeev Sharma R/o H. No. F-201, D Block, Mangal Bazar, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi, also at Gali No.11, New Lahore, Shastri Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No.273/2023 U/S 323/354/354B/509 IPC, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused Annu Sharma can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Annu Sharma has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Annu Sharma of FIR No.273/2023 U/S 323/354/354B/509 IPC, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 17.09.2026.

By Order,
Ms. Shipra Dhankar
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court)-01
Room No.55, 2nd Floor, Shahdara Distrcit
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11471/SHD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Sh. Deepak Arora S/o Sh. Prabhu Dayal Arora R/o A-65, Ground Floor, Lajpat Nagar-1, Delhi-110024 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide CC No.15750/2018 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Kotwali, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused Sh. Deepak Arora can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Sh. Deepak Arora has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Sh. Deepak Arora of CC No.15750/2018 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Kotwali, Delhi is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 17.09.2026 at 10:00 am.

By Order,
Sh. Pranjal Gangwar
Judicial Magistrate First Class(NI Act)-03(Central District),
Room No.202, 2nd Floor, Building Annexe-II,
DP/11470/N/2026(Court Matter)

DP/11470/N/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Kailash S/o Deshraj Singh R/o Jhuggi No. G-367, Jahangir Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 74/21, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS Act at PS: Jahangir Puri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Kailash can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Kailash has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Kailash of FIR No. 74/21, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS Act of PS: Jahangir Puri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 19.09.2026.

By order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North Court No.6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11423/NW/2026

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता,
सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, सभाग कोठा

क्रमांक- 1253 दिनांक : 10.8.2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 15/पीएमजीएसवाई/2026-27
NIB No. PWD2627A2140

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से प्रमाणमंत्री ग्राम सड़क योजना (पीएमजनम) एवं पीएमजीएसवाई चतुर्थ चरण (PMGSY-IV) Batch-I, FY 2025-26 योजनाअन्तर्गत निविदा के तहत खींचत सड़कों का निर्माण कार्य के निम्नलिखित कार्यों मय पांच साल की सम्यत के लिए 5 फैकज हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग / रेलवे इन्फ्रास्ट्रि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित पत्र में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया से ऑन लाईन निविदाएँ आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साईट <http://dipr.rajabasthan.gov.in> व <http://pwd.rajabasthan.gov.in> व <http://pmgsytendersraj.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। फैकजिंगाईज यु.बी.एन संख्या निम्नानुसार है।
UBN No.PWD2627WSOB09605
UBN No.PWD2627WSOB09607
UBN No.PWD2627WSOB09609
UBN No.PWD2627WSOB09611
UBN No.PWD2627WSOB09613
इच्छुक संवेदकों की अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेब साईट <http://pmgsytendersraj.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड होना आवश्यक है।

(अञ्चल चौकीरी)
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता,
सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, सभाग कोठा

DIPR/C/14650/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2)(ii)Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely Manish@Badal S/o Suresh, R/o: Jhuggi No.473, Loha Mandi, Naraina Vihar, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in FIR No. 736/2017, U/s 392 IPC, registered at P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused Manish@Badal cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Manish@Badal has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Manish@Badal accused FIR No. 736/2017, U/s 392 IPC, registered at P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 16.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Judicial Magistrate First Class-2 (West)
Room No. 356, 3rd Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11520/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.PC/84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) SALEEM S/o Jamil Khan R/o C-454, Gali No. 9, C-Block, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 524/2023 PS Swaroop Nagar, Distt. Outer North, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) SALEEM can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) SALEEM has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) SALEEM of FIR No. 524/2023 PS Swaroop Nagar, Distt. Outer North, Delhi are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 16.10.2026 at 10:00 AM.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Ld. JMFC-07 (North)
Courts No. 6, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11420/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. PC./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Anil S/o Sh. Mahabir Singh R/o Plot No. 3, Nangli Dairy, Near Ravinder Dairy, Najafgarh, New Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under FIR No. 379/2018 U/s 323/354/509 IPC., has been registered at PS: Najafgarh, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, Anil cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Anil has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Anil under FIR No. 379/2018 U/s 323/354/509 IPC., registered at PS: Najafgarh, New Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 26.09.2026.

By Order
Ms. Ebbani Aggrawal
Ld. JMFC (Mahila Court), Room No. 312
(Court Notice)

DP/11304/SW/2026
(Court Notice)

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED

E- NOTICE INVITING SHORT TERM BID NO.12 & 13 (2026-27)

On line bids for Short term E-NIB NO.12 (2026-27) are here from interested bidders for S.No. 01 to 02 in office of the Executive Engineer-I (Civil) R.R.V.P.N. Bikaner, S.No. 03 to 06 in office of the Executive Engineer-II (Civil) R.R.V.P.N. Bikaner, S.No. 07 to 09 in office of the Executive Engineer (Civil) R.R.V.P.N. Hanumangarh and S.No. 10 to 11 in office of the Executive Engineer (Civil) R.R.V.P.N. Ratnagarh and bids for NIB NO.13 (2026-27) for S.No. 01 in office of the Executive Engineer-I (Civil) R.R.V.P.N. Bikaner & S.No. 02 in office of the Executive Engineer-II (Civil) R.R.V.P.N. Bikaner. The details of NIB i.e. estimated cost, tender fee, earnest money date of tender download and submitting etc. given in procurement portal <http://eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajabasthan.nic.in> & www.rvpn.co.in.

UBN : VPN2627WSOB01224,1225,1211,1213,1215,1216,1217,1218,1221,1214,1212 (NIT No.12)

UBN: VPN2627WSOB01222, 1219 (NIT No.13)

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10011 RRVPN/TR-7751/2026

Superintending Engineer (Civil), Ajmer

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of Work and its location: 105-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27; Electrical work in connection with (i) Provision of 2 Family suits and 6 individual suits at ORH GZB in lieu of Old ORH. (ii) Construction of underground tank & pump house, electric sub-station, improvement of water supply system under ADENGZB (iii) Augmentation of homing capacity of ELS/GZB from 200 to 225. (iv) Reorganization of facilities available in Shed and shop at ELS/GZB. (v) Provision of effluent treatment plant at ELS/GZB.

Approx. cost of the works in: Rs. 1,19,09,661.90/-

Address of the office: Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055

Earnest Money: Rs. 2,38,200.00/-

Last Date & Time of submission of tender: 08.09.2026, 13:00 Hrs.

Opening of tender: 08.09.2026, 13:00 Hrs.

Website & notice board: www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2835/2026

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.

(A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India)

NSIC, MDPR Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Industrial Estate, Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station, New Delhi-110020

IN VITATION FOR E-BIDS (IFB)

CONCOR invite E-Tender in Two Packet System for procurement of 20 Feet End open High cube (20'x8'x9') Stainless Steel Containers For Bulk Sall Gross Weight 36000 Kgs. The brief of tender is as under.

SN	Description	Description Details
i	Bid Reference	CON/IA/CON/720F/SS100/2026
ii	Type of Containers	Quantity (Numbers) 100 nos
iii	Description	Design Manufacturing testing & supply of 100 Numbers 20 Feet End open High cube (20'x8'x9') Stainless Steel Containers For Bulk Sall Gross Weight 36000 Kgs as per RDSO Guidelines.
iv	Total Estimated Cost	Rs. 9,73,50,000/- (inclusive all)
v	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 5 Lakh.
vi	Date and time of Submission of Bids	From 18/08/2026 (12.30 hrs) to 07/09/2026 (17.00 hrs) IST
vii	Date and time of opening of Technical Bid	08/09/2026 at 12.00 hrs
viii	Tender Cost & Mode of Payment	₹1120.00/- or through online payment gateway to CONCOR
ix	Tender Processing Fee (Non-Refundable)	₹3540.00 (inclusive of GST) through online payment gateway.
x	Period of Tender Sale (Online)	From 18/08/2026 (12:15 Hrs) to 07/09/2026 (16:00 Hrs) IST

The complete Tender Document can be viewed & downloaded only from the website (www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL) during the tender sale period. The tender notice is also available on the website www.concorindia.co.in and website of Public Procurement Portal (<http://eprocure.gov.in>)

Email: ac2concor@concorindia.com Group General Manager/P&S/Area-II, Phone No:011-4122290, Ext.925 & 686

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Arjun @ Rahul @ Kanchi, S/o Som Bahadur @ Sonu Bahadur R/o Jhuggi No.717, Shiv Basti, Rama Road, Shadhipur New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in case FIR No.801242946/2024 u/s 305 Bharatiya Nyaya Sannhita, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Arjun @ Rahul @ Kanchi cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Arjun @ Rahul @ Kanchi has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Arjun @ Rahul @ Kanchi of FIR No.801242946/2024 u/s 305 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 28.11.2026.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Central District, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11384/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: Ajay, S/o.: Sh. Subhash, R/o.: H. No.: F-3/382, Sultanpuri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide FIR No.07/2020 U/S 394/392/411/34 IPC registered at P.S Raj Park, Outer District, Delhi and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said Ajay could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Ajay is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ajay, accused of FIR No.07/2020 U/S 394/392/411/34 IPC, P.S Raj Park, Outer District, Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.10.2026.

By Order Aakansha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
North-West, Room No. 107, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11349/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Rahul Sharma S/o Rajender Sharma R/o C-203, Rama Vihar, Mohamadpur, Jahangirpuri, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 82/22, PS Karol Bagh, Central Distt., New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Rahul Sharma cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Rahul Sharma has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that the Rahul Sharma the said accused of FIR No. 82/22, PS Karol Bagh, Central Distt., New Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 18.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Nishat Bangarh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
(Central), Room No.-180,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11499/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely Imran Safee@Papi S/o Mohd. Yakub, R/o: Vegabond Faiz Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi also at H. No. 237, Arya Nagar, Ward No. 22, Muradnagar, District. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in FIR No. 91/2018, U/s 380/411/34 IPC, registered at P.S.: Rajinder Nagar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused Imran Safee@Papi cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Imran Safee@Papi has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Imran Safee@Papi accused FIR No. 91/2018, U/s 380/411/34 IPC, registered at P.S.: Rajinder Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 02.12.2026.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
MM/Judicial Magistrate First Class(C)
Room No. 150, 2nd Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11390/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

MANAPPURAM HOME FINANCE LTD.

Shivpuri - Branch (Madhya Pradesh) NOTICE

With effect from 18/11/2026 all business activities of our Manappuram Home Finance Ltd. First Floor, G-Block, Phase-1, Ward No. 37, in front of Sonchiraya Hotel, Gwalior bypass, Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh Pin code-473551 will be shifted to Manappuram Home Finance Ltd., Ground Floor, Kanki Bhawan, Behind Nanghar Mandir, Ward No. 37, Village Jhingira, Shivpuri (Shivpuri - Kankia Gwalior branch) Pin code: 473551

Customers may kindly note the change and are requested to approach us at the above mentioned address only for all further transactions and requirements after the said date Call: (8889933449/ 9770032100).

MANAPPURAM HOME FINANCE LTD.
CN-UG4520K20120P03179
8/586, Padmaaprabha Building, Near Sreerama Swamy Temple, Churpu - Thrivapravar Road, Thrivapravar, Thrissur, Kerala - 680567.

WESTERN RAILWAY

VARIOUS WORK

Divisional Railway Manager(WA), Western Railway, 6th floor, Engg., Deptt., Mumbai Central, Mumbai - 400008.

Invites E-Tender Notice No.: BCT/26-27/110, dt.13.08/2026. Work and location: (i) Udhna - Provision of 01 nos. Pit Line of 25 mtr., 01 nos. Tower wagon shed (30M x 9M x 15M) & 01 nos. Depot (30M x 50M). (ii) Bardoli (Goods Shed) - Provision of height cover shed 350 x 15M with allied lighting. (Composite tender including electrical portion). Approx. cost of work: ₹ 8,50,65,209.41. EMD: ₹ 17,01,300/-.

Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 08.09.2026; 15:00 hrs.

Date & Time of Opening: On 08.09.2026 at 15:30 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.ireps.gov.in 0485

Like us on: [facebook.com/WesternRly](https://www.facebook.com/WesternRly)

WESTERN RAILWAY

CONSTRUCTION WORK

Deputy Chief Engineer (Construction), Western Railway, churchgate Mumbai-40020, invites e-Tender Notice No.: Dy.CE/CCTG/362, Date: 12.08.2026 (Two packet system). Name of work: Construction of additional platform, Pit Line, construction/extension of stabling lines, Sky-Walk, Approach Road and Development of Circulating area at Jogeshwari station & Construction of 2 nos 3 Layer Inspection platforms at Bandra Terminus station of Mumbai Division, Western Railway. Nit Value: ₹ 93,44,91,639.12. EMD: ₹ 1,86,88,800/-.

e-Bid closing date: Till 07.09.2026, 15:00 hrs. e-Bid opening date: On 07.09.2026 at 15:30 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.ireps.gov.in 0489

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कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, युनिट-17 कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय) (उपग्रह सरकार का उपक्रम)

कार्यालय: कुष्मा नगर मयुरा-281004 प्रमाण कार्यालय: टी.सी. 38-वी, बिर्मुति खण्ड, गोमतीनगर, सखनज-226010

Visit us at : www.cdsupjn.org

Email : pm17cds@gmail.com

फोन : 7080088364

L.No. 856/M/14/209
Dated: 11.08.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अधीनस्थानी द्वारा जनपद न्यायालय पतिर, मयुरा में एक पारलीकल (ड्रिनेजिडर) एवं एक वाइटर सेफ (बन्को के लिये सुरक्षित) अलग-अलग शीटालयों का निर्माण कार्य अनुमानित लागत ₹ 6.37 लाख (जी.एस. टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी. एण्ड डी.एस. में पंजीकृत उम्मेदवारों से दिनांक 07.09.2026 के अपराह्न 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 12.08.2026 से दिनांक 07.09.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 08.09.2026 को 14:00 बजे परियोजना प्रबंधक, युनिट-17, सी. एण्ड डी. एस., ज. प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), मयुरा में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य ₹ 1,000.00 + GST (18%) कुल ₹ 1,180.00 देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्यूरमेंट पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Vicky Kumar Chauhan @Vicky Chauhan S/o Shri Ravi Kumar Chauhan R/o H. No. 280, Block No. 14, MCD Flats, Nand Nagri, Delhi-93 also at Through Security Officer-Housing Keeping Department, Ground Floor, Link House, Press Area BLDGI, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-02 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case No. 2967/19 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS IP Estate, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Vicky Kumar Chauhan @Vicky Chauhan cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Vicky Kumar Chauhan @Vicky Chauhan has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that Vicky Kumar Chauhan @Vicky Chauhan in Case No. 2967/19 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS IP Estate, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.10.2026.

By order
Ms. Urvi Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI ACT-01)
Central
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11410/CD/2026

SHRI SAIBABA SANSTHAN TRUST, SHIRDI

Post. Shirdi, Tal- Rahata, Dist. Ahilyanagar,
Phone No. (02423) 258500/259180/259302,
Website - www.sai.org.in E-mail-dwarawati@sai.org.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited on out source basis for Dwarawati Bhaktniwas for the work of Housekeeping, cleaning and pest control works etc. as well as mechanised housekeeping for Dwarawati Bhaktniwas for the duration of 2026-27 to 2027-28 as 18 month on Date : 01/10/2026 to 31/03/2028.

1. For E-tender criteria terms/conditions and e-tender information visit Shree Saibaba Sansthan official website www.sai.or.in/tender.

2. The e-tender for online downloading and uploading Dt. 18/08/2026 from 11.00 am to Dt. 31/08/2026 till 05:00 PM will be available at www.mahatenders.gov.in.

(Goraksha Gadilkar, I.A.S.)
Chief Executive Officer

dgipr 2026-27/2342

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

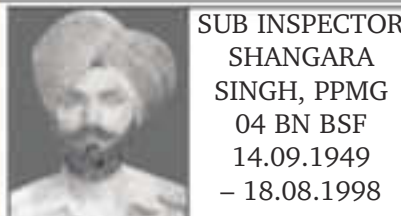
NK JOTIRAM SIDHU CHOUGULE

On 18 Aug 1985, you made the supreme sacrifice while serving for the mother land in J&K while fighting bravely with the terrorists. We remember your selfless service, courage and determination and you continue to be an inspiration to all of us.

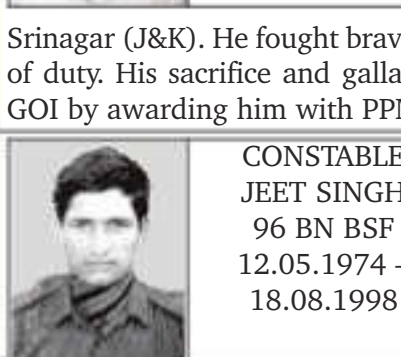
Commanding Officer and all Ranks BraveAath BORDER SECURITY FORCE



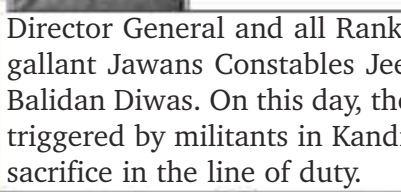
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Ramesh Chand on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in Counter-part firing in area of FDL Kranti-I, Poonch (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector Shingara Singh, on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Dangarpura area, Srinagar (J&K). He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PPMG (Posthumously).



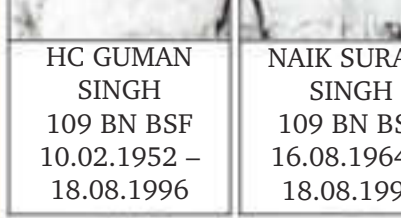
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Constables Jeet Singh and Sudist Kumar Jha on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Kandi area, Rajouri (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Constables Jeet Singh and Sudist Kumar Jha on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Kandi area, Rajouri (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



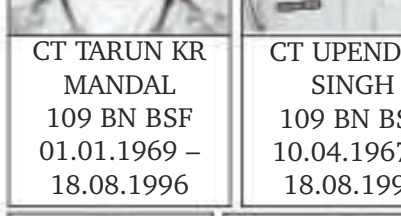
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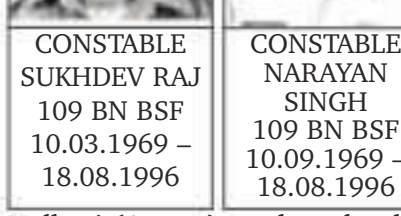
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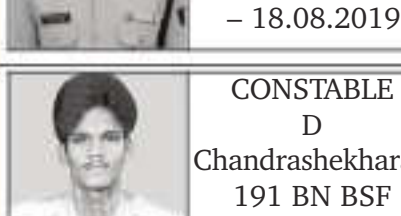
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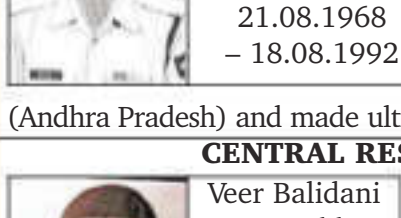
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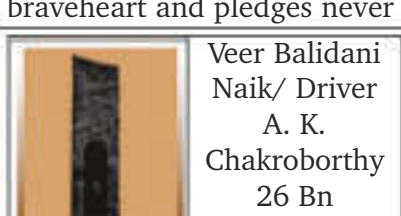
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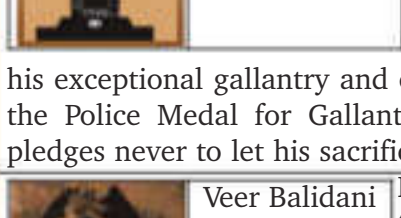
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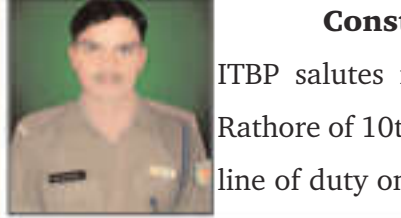
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Jabar Singh of 45 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely discharging his duties during a firing incident in Andhra Pradesh on 18 August 1972 in AndhraPradesh. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



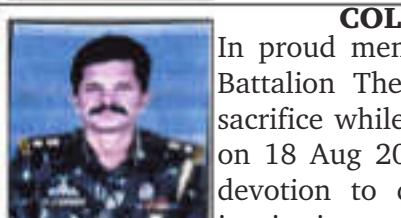
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Naik/ Driver A. K. Chakraborty of 26 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being injured in a targeted fire by militants in Punjab on 18 August 1987. Despite his injuries, he manoeuvred his bus to a safe spot. For his exceptional gallantry and courage, he was posthumously awarded the Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Sunil Ram of 168 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a blast as he stepped on an IED while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Bijapur district, Chhattisgarh, on 18 August 2007. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Sunil Ram of 168 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a blast as he stepped on an IED while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Bijapur district, Chhattisgarh, on 18 August 2007. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Manoj Kumar Rathore of 10th Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Arunachal Pradesh in 2011.



In proud memory of Col KJ Singh, SC*, SM of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regt who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at Nowshera (J&K) on 18 Aug 2002. Your act of valour, rare courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.



"BRAVES DIE, BUT ONLY ONCE" Remembered by Commanding Officer and All Ranks 6 DOGRA

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Thulluru Mandal, Guntur District - 522237, Andhra Pradesh
NIT No. 21/MAU61-ADMNOSTG/OTH/12/2026/2nd call Dt: 14/08/2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Name of Work: APCRDA - Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Consultant to Provide Comprehensive Multi-layered Third-Party Quality Assurance & Quality Control Services for infrastructure and construction works in Amaravati Capital City, Andhra Pradesh, India. The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 19.08.2026 to 03.09.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Due date for submission of Bid is 03.09.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs. Technical bid opening 03.09.2026 @ 16.00 Hrs. For further details Please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and www.crda.ap.gov.in.

Sd/- Commissioner, APCRDA, Amaravati

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA GOVERNMENT GENERAL HOSPITAL, KHAMMAM

TENDER NOTICE
Tenders are invited under Two-Bid System from eligible Manufacturers/Authorized Dealers/Distributors for Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of Medical Equipment, Surgical Instruments, Laboratory Equipment and Hospital Support Equipment under Six (06) Packages for Government General Hospital, Khammam.

Estimated Tender Value: Rs.4,54,33,918/-, Sale of Tender Documents: 21-08-2026 to 10-09-2026
Last Date for Submission: 18-09-2026, 4:00 PM
For complete tender details, visit website: www.gghkhammam.com and <http://khammam.telangana.gov.in>. The medical superintendent, GGH, Khammam reserves the right to cancel the tender at any time without assigning any reasons.

Sd/- District Collector Khammam District
R.O. No. : 8021-PP/CL/ADVT/2026-27 Date: 17-08-2026

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LTD.

Suratgarh Super Critical Thermal Power Station, Suratgarh-335805

E-Tender Notice

Online tenders are invited for TN-313(RVU2627WSOB01051) Annual contract for routine, breakdown maintenance work and providing assistance in operation of Ash Handling System, TN-314(RVU2627WSOB01040) Annual Contract for Routine, Breakdown and maintenance work of complete CA System, TN-321(RVU2627WSOB01075) Annual contract for Routine, Breakdown & Capital maintenance of LT Switchgear, LT Motors, Motorized Valve / Damper Actuators, Soot Blowers and Hoist/Crane, Lift/Elevators & Station Lighting (Excluding CHP) & TN-417(RVU2627GLOB01036) Supply, erection, testing and commissioning of 1100 Ah and 425 Ah Battery banks with dismantling and buyback of existing battery banks of C&I at SSCPP, Suratgarh. Tender details are available on websites <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> for e-tender), www.energy.rajjasthan.gov.in or www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10019 RVUN/PR-4451 Project Head (STPS-SC)

Mahatma Phule Renewable Energy and Infrastructure Technology Limited

(Subsidiary of MPBDC, a Government of Maharashtra undertaking)

EOI Notice

MAHAPREIT invites Expression of Interest (EOI) for the SELECTION OF A CONSORTIUM / ASSOCIATION PARTNER (CONSULTING FIRM / AGENCY) to Jointly Bid with MAHAPREIT for The GIZ International Tender: "Green Hydrogen in Hard-to-Abate Sectors: Policy and Regulatory Instrument." The EOI documents can be viewed and downloaded from the official websites <https://mahapreit.in> The last date for submission of bids is 24/08/2026.

Executive Director (Operation) MAHAPREIT, Mumbai

Government of Karnataka (Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Department) KARNATAKA RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AGENCY

III Floor, Grameenabhivruddhi Bhavana, Ananda Rao Circle, Bengaluru - 560009.

Phone No.: 080-29710021/ 22 / 23 / 24 Fax: 080-29710025 E-mail: coo.krrda.karbg@gmail.com Website: <http://www.krrda.in>

No: KRRDA/TECH/208/TND/NOT-7/2026-27/1871 Date: 14-08-2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDERS (NIT) (2nd CALL)

Karnataka Rural Road Development Agency (KRRDA), on behalf of Government of KARNATAKA, invites item rate Tenders in Electronic Tendering System for Indent Number: KRRDA/2025-26/RD/WORK_INDENT 449 Call-2, 532 Call-2, 486 Call-2, 412 Call-2, 450 Call-2, 451 Call-2, 452 Call-2, 453 Call-2, 454 Call-2, 469 Call-2, 405 Call-2, 410 Call-2, 414 Call-2, 419 Call-2, 418 Call-2, 347 Call-2, 519 Call-2, 505 Call-2, 511 Call-2, 341 Call-2, 342 Call-2 under Karnataka Rural Road Improvement Project (KRRIP) - Pragathi Patha - ADB Financed in the Karnataka State for 21 (4 Prior + 17 Post) number of packages including routine maintenance for five years, from the eligible contractors registered with Public Works Department, Govt. of Karnataka, or non-registered contractors.

Availability of Bid Documents and mode of Submission: The bid documents are available online on KPP Portal (<https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>) and should be submitted online. The bidder shall be required to register on this portal. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have a valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities.

Last Date and Time for Receipt of Bids through KPP Portal: **5:00 PM, 02-09-2026.** For further details please log on to KPP Portal (<https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>)

Any further corrigendum and addendum relating to the said tender notification will be published only in the KPP Portal.

Sd/- Tendering Officer and Executive Engineer KRRDA, Bengaluru.

DIPR/CP/2181/Advt/2026-27

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, P.H. CIRCLE, SAMBALPUR.

E-mail id: - sephsbp@gmail.com

1st Corrigendum to the e-Procurement Bid Identification No. ACEPHSBP-02/2026-27 Dt. 06.08.2026

The tender in response to the above mentioned Tender Call Notice is re-scheduled as follows and all other term and conditions remained same.

Critical Dates:

Sr. No.	Description	Scheduled Dates	Re-scheduled Dates
(i)	Period of availability of : tender on-line	From 11.00 Hrs. of 14.08.2026 to 17.00 Hrs. of 28.08.2026	From 11.00 Hrs. of 21.08.2026 to 17.00 Hrs. of 05.09.2026
(ii)	Last date & time of : seeking clarification	17.00 Hrs. of 19.08.2026	17.00 Hrs. of 28.08.2026
(iii)	Last date & time of : bidding on-line	17.00 Hrs. of 28.08.2026	17.00 Hrs. of 05.09.2026
(iv)	Date & time of opening : of Bid	11.00 Hrs. of 29.08.2026	11.00 Hrs. of 07.09.2026

Sd/- ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, P. H. Circle, Sambalpur

OIPR- 13001/13018/1/26-27/0003

DEVELOPMENT SUPPORT AGENCY OF GUJARAT

An autonomous Society promoted by Tribal Development Department, Govt. of Gujarat (Phone no.079-232-52257)

CORRIGENDUM-3

Development Support Agency of Gujarat (D-SAG) is developing the National Tribal Freedom Fighters Museum at Garudeshwar, Rajpipla in the Narmada District. D-SAG has issued a Tender Notice on Dated. 18/07/2026 for Construction and Management Agency (CMA) for the Phase-3 (Package-A & B) of the National Tribal Freedom Fighters Museum at Garudeshwar, Rajpipla. A corrigendum is issued for **Package A Tender ID-325472. & Package B Tender ID-325589.**

Important Dates:	
Revised Last date of online bid submission	24.08.2026 at 05.00 PM
Revised Last date of Physical bid submission	24.08.2026 at 05.00 PM
Revised Date for Opening of Technical bid	24.08.2026 at 06.00 PM

All bidders are requested to take note of the above and consider the additional documents while preparing and submitting their bids. For detailed scope of work, eligibility criteria, terms & conditions, interested agencies may visit the website <https://tender.nprocure.com/>

Chief Executive Officer Development Support Agency of Gujarat Gandhinagar INF-1167-2026-27

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)

2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru - 560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383. Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-08/577/2026-27 Date: 17.08.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item rate Tenders are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors registered in KPWD who have got adequate financial resources & sufficient past experience for the following works as per the schedule given below:

Name of Work : (1) Improvement of damaged roads and construction of new drains on 5th, 6th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 10th roads and 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 7th, 9th side roads in Kanabargi Industrial Area, Belagavi District. **(2)** Shifting of Existing 1st Stage Water Supply Pipeline by providing, laying and joining of 406mm dia MS pipeline at Mulawad Industrial Area, Vijayapura District

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **04.09.2026 upto 04:00 pm**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the E-Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/- Chief Engineer - 2

DIPR/CP/JA/2197/2026-27

कार्यालय नगर परिषद्, झुन्झुनू (राज.)

क्रमांक :-एफ(5) / विकास / 2026 - 27 / 8663 दिनांक :- 11.08.2026

ई-निविदा संख्या 09/2026-27 (NIB Code- DLB2627A7029) कुल राशि - 461.98 लाख

निविदा की कुल लागत (लाखों में)	46198000 / -
कुल घरोहर राशि 2 प्रतिशत (रुपये में)	923960 / -
कुल घरोहर राशि 1/2 प्रतिशत (रुपये में)	230990 / -
निविदा डाउनलोड करने की तिथि	11.08.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे से 21.08.2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे तक
निविदा अपलोड करने की तिथि	11.08.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे से 21.08.2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे तक
निविदा खोलने की तिथि	21.08.2026 दोपहर 12.00 बजे

निविदा सूचना इंटरनेट साईट <http://www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> वेबसाईट पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

राज.संवाद/सी/26/10091 आयुक्त नगर परिषद् झुन्झुनू

Chairman, Kulehar Tourism Development Society (KTDS)-cum-Deputy Commissioner, Una, Tehsil & District Una, Himachal Pradesh

No.- 01 e-Tendering Dated : 11.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

On behalf of the Chairman of Kulehar Tourism Development Society (KTDS) cum DC Una e-Tenders are invited from leading Operators for Hospitality and Conducting Water & Allied Sports, Tourism, Leisure activities at Gobind Sagar Lake, Androuli, Tehsil Bangana, District Una, Himachal Pradesh in following Activities as under :-

Sr. No.	Name of Adventure Activity	Min. Quantity
1.	Jet Ski	02
2.	Speed Boats	04
3.	Bumper/ Banana Ride/Similar Rides with Speed Boat	02
4.	ATB Ride	02
5.	Floating Jetty	02
6.	Food Van Double Decker	02
7.	Para Motoring	01
8.	Para sailing with speed boats	02
9.	Zip Line	01
10.	Shikara	02
11.	Water jetovator	02
12.	Hanging Restaurant	01
13.	cruise	02
14.	House Boat	02
15.	Leisure Domes	As per requirement

The complete tender document can be viewed and downloaded from <https://www.htenders.gov.in> upon payment of a tender fee of Rs. 10000/- (Ten thousand) via demand draft. The last date and time for submission and uploading of tender documents is 03-09-2026 at 5.00 PM after which no tenders will be accepted. Interested bidder(s) are required to submit their bids in two parts: The Technical bid and the Financial bid. The Technical bid shall include details of the non-refundable Tender fee of Rs. 10000/- in the form of a demand draft issued in favor of the tender inviting authority, Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs. 2,00,000/- in the form of an FDR/unconditional and irrevocable Bank Guarantee pledged in the name of the tender inviting authority, and all requisite documents and information as specified in the tender document. In addition to uploading the Technical bid on the website, <https://www.htenders.gov.in> bidder(s) must send the original copies of the Demand Draft for the Tender fee and the Bank Guarantee/FDR for the EMD to the undersigned office in a single envelope, clearly labeled "E-Tender for the Hospitality and Conducting Water & Allied Sports, Tourism, Leisure activities at Gobind Sagar Lake, Androuli, Tehsil Bangana, District Una, Himachal Pradesh." The Financial bid, which shall include the Bill of Quantities, must be uploaded in .xls format as specified in the tender document. All subsequent corrigendum, modifications and clarifications related to tender will be published solely on aforesaid website, and the bidder(s) are advised to regularly check the site for updates. The tender inviting authority reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reasons.

Chairman Kulehar Tourism Development Society Distt. Una (H.P.)

No. 0742/2026-2027/HP Email.ID: ktdsuna72@gmail.com

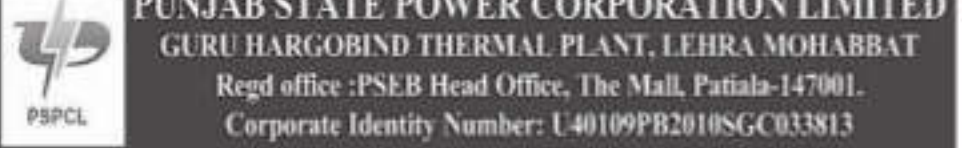
राजस्थान आवासन मण्डल

क्रमांक :- 122 दिनांक :- 17/08/2026

संशोधित निविदा सूचना संख्या: 02/2026-27

इस कार्यालय द्वारा जारी निविदा सूचना संख्या 02/2026-27 में संशोधन उपरान्त बिड़ प्रपन डाउनलोड व अपलोड करने की तिथि 18.08.2026 से 07.09.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक, मूल प्रपन कार्यालय में जमा करने की तिथि 08.09.2026 सायं 4.00 बजे तक, तकनीकी बिड़ खोलने की तिथि 09.09.2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे एवं वित्तीय बिड़ खोलने की तिथि 16.09.2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे रहेगी। अन्य शर्तें मूल बिड़ अनुसार यथावत रहेगी।

राज.संवाद/सी/26/10109 अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता-द्वितीय, जोधपुर



GURU HARGOBIND THERMAL PLANT, LEHRA MOHABBAT
Regd office :PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001.
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2018SGC03813
Website: www.pspcl.in, GSTIN 03AAFCPS126QJZC

Tender Enquiry No. 690/GHTP/EMC/GMMC-128 Vol-III Dated: 14-08-2026

Dy. Chief Engineer, Electrical Mtc. Circle, GHTP, Lehra Mohabbat, Distt. Bathinda (Punjab) invites e-tenders from experienced and reputed firms for the work Design, Manufacture, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of Passenger lift of 550 Kgs or 8 persons capacity for 3 floors having microprocessor control system. Last date for request for registration of firms with GHTP is 14-09-2026 up to 17.00 hrs and bid submission is 17-09-2026 up to 11

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Satakshi D/o Vishwavardhan R/o 133/13, NBCC Plaza, Sector-1, Saket, Pushp Vihar, PO: Malviya Nagar, Dist: South Delhi, Delhi-110017, have changed my name to Satakshi Thapliyal 0071054930-1

I, Dev Ram Joshi, S/o Bachi Ram Joshi, R/O-RZG-56, Raj Nagar Part-2, Palam-Colony, delhi, have changed my name to Devi Ram Joshi 0040872717-1

I, Jessica-Rachel Roberts, R/O of C-304, Gayatri, Apartments, Plot No.27, Sector-10, Dwarka, Delhi-110075, clarify that my father's name on my passport is, being corrected from Clarence-George Roberts to Clarence George Roberts. 0040872821-12

I, J. L NIRMALA CHAITANYA M D/o ANAKRISHNANARMA MUDRADI Plot No: 42, 2nd floor, Decent Kunj, Backside of Royal Green Garden Marriage Hall, Block - A, Mansaram park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi, 110059, have changed my name to NIRMALA CHAITANYA RANGANADHAM 0071054935-1

I, Neha Gupta, D/O-Sushil Gupta Ex., W/O-Kushagra Kant Jain, R/O-K12A, 1st Floor, Kailash-colony, near-Kailash Colony, Metro station, PO: Greater Kailash South Delhi, Delhi-110048, declare that I got divorce from my husband vide court Decree No. HMA-805/2026 dated 21.05.2026 and further I have changed the name of my minor daughter Siara Jain aged 03 years and she shall hereafter be known as Siara Gupta 0040872848-5

Mamta Kumari, W/o, Parveen Arora R/O-C-6A/81C, Janak Puri, New Delhi-110058 is confirm and declare that Mamta Arora, Meera Arora and Mamta Kumari is same and one person. 0040872819-8

I, MOHD SHAFIQ S/o MOHD RAHEES R/o 903-904 1ST FLOOR GALI KUPPE WALI BALLIMARAN CHANDNI CHOWK DELHI 110006, have changed the name of my minor Daughter aged 11 Yrs from Inayat Parveen Ansari to Inayat Ansari permanently. 0071054881-1

I, Rohan Nair, S/o Rajiv Nair, R/o S-187, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi-110017, have changed my minor son name of ZORAVAR K NAIR to zoravar nair. 0040872821-4

I, VIRENDER PAL SINGH S/O SHIS PAL SINGH R/O G12/6 THIRD FLOOR, MALVIYA NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110017, declare that My Name has been misspelt in my Passport VARENDER PAL SINGH correct spelling is VIRENDER PAL SINGH. We request to amend and correct the same in records. 0040872729-2

I, RIPAN KUMAR, S/O TANA CHAND, R/O D-24 TEACHER COLONY PRATAP VIHAR VIJAY NAGAR, GHAZIABAD, U.P. 201009, have CHANGED MY NAME TO RIPAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040872823-8

I, PRAKASH MISHRA S/o Jay Dutt Mishra, Flat No-D1-63, Cluster-3, Block-D, Vasant Kunj, Delhi-70, have changed my name to PRAKASH CHANDRA MISHRA. 0071054967-1

I, Surender Kaur W/o Balvinder Singh R/o Ward No. -13, Pehowa, Kurukshetra (Haryana), have changed my name to Surinder Kaur. 0040872819-1

I, Sumit Jain S/O Vijay Kumar Jain R/O I-5/5, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110085, hereby inform that Vijay Jain and Vijay kumar Jain both are names belongs to my father for one and same person. 0040872820-1

I, SUNIL S/O DEEN DAYAL R/O HOUSE NO.169, GALI NO-4, SHIV COLONY, BALLABGARH, FARIDABAD-121004 (H.R.) HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM SUNIL TO SUNIL KUMAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0071054885-1

Monika Aggarwal, W/o Shyam Sunder Aggarwal R/O New R-17A, Anand Vihar, Uttam Nagar New Delhi-110059 have changed name Monika 0040872819-10

I, MANOJ KUMAR, S/o Raghu Nath Singh, R/o 473, Ground Floor Block C&D, Shalimar Bagh, Pkt-I SFS, Flat, Shalimar, Bagh Delhi-110088, have changed my minor son name KETAN to KETAN ANTIL 0040872823-1

I, hitherto known as Prabhavathi V/o Chidananda DB residing at No 251/1, Ground Floor, 2nd Main Road, 8th Cross, Soundarya Layout, Sidedahalli, Nagasandra, Post- Bangalore, Karnataka-560073, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Pankaja H.M. 0071054945-1

I, MOHAMMAD SAFEEOQ ANSARI S/O MOHD RAHEES R/O 903-904 1ST FLOOR GALI KUPPE WALI BALLIMARAN CHANDNI CHOWK DELHI 110006, have changed my name to MOHD SHAFIQ Permanently 0071054883-1

I, SHEHLA KHATOON, W/O RIZWAN AHAMAD, R/O G-45 third floor thokar No-4 Abul Fazal enclave, South East Delhi-110025, Have changed my name to RIZVANA KHATOON 0040872821-6

I, PARDEEP KUMAR SHARMA S/O JAGAN NATH SHARMA R/O HOUSE NO. 58A, GALI NUMBER-5, ADARSH NAGAR, BALLABGARH, FARIDABAD-121004 (H.R.) HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM PARDEEP KUMAR SHARMA TO PARDEEP KUMAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071054886-1

I, RAJESHWARI AGGARWAL, W/O, AJAY AGGARWAL, R/O, FLAT NO-G-2, HIG GROUND FLOOR, PLOT NO-730, SHAKTI KHAND-3, INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201014, I have changed my name to RAJESHWARI DEVI. 0040872819-7

I, SANJEEV KUMAR S/o Parshuram Singh R/O-B9/310, Phase-4, Block-B, Aya Nagar Delhi-110047, have changed my name to SANJEEV 0040872821-3

I, PREETI SINGH W/O VIRENDER PAL SINGH R/O 90/5 AB G.F, MALVIYA NAGAR SOUTH DELHI-110017, declare that My Name has been misspelt in my Passport PREETI SABHARWAL correct spelling is PREETI SINGH. We request to amend and correct the same in records. 0040872729-1

I, it is for general information that I Kailash-Satti, S/O, Late Purshotam Satti, R/o Qtr. 518, Type-2, Sector-02, Sadiq-Nagar, PO-Andrewsganj, Dist: South-Delhi, Delhi-110049, declare that my name has been wrongly mentioned as Kailash Sati, My Actual and correct name is Kailash Satti, which may be amended accordingly for all future purposes. 0040872823-7

I, Samarth Kumar S/o Neetu R/o G2/92, 1st Floor, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-88 have changed my name to Samarth for all purposes. 0071054962-1

I, Shipra Goyal W/o Rohit Goel R/o H No. 675/5 Ward 5, Mehrauli New Delhi-110030 do hereby declare that my correct name is Shipra Goyal but my son SHIVANSH GOEL's 11th class school record written as SHIPRA GOEL. I further declare that SHIPRA GOEL and SHIPRA GOYAL is the one and same person. 0040872725-1

That my name written as SHAHNAB MERAZ in my school documents but my correct name is SHEHNAB MERAZ W/O KAMRANUDDIN R/O T-10 3RD FLOOR SHEESH MAHAL DARYA GANJ DELHI-02 and now presently I would be known as SHEHNAB MERAZ for all future purposes 0040872739-1

I, Leela Dhar S/o Murlidhar R/o A-150, Block-A, New Ashok Nagar, Delhi-110096, Have Changed My Name to Leela Dhar Purohit for all future Purposes. 0040872818-1

I, Mohd Tauheed, S/o Late Abdul Waheed R/o House No. 60 A, Gali No.12, Zakir Nagar, Okhla, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to Mohd Tohid for all purposes. 0040872715-1

I, Vikas Singh-Chauhan, S/o Shyam Singh Chauhan, R/o-4/29, New Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, East, Delhi-110032, declare that, Vikas Singh, at Vikas Chauhan and Vikas Singh Chauhan, these names are same and one person and I will be known as Vikas Chauhan in future. 0040872821-13

I, hitherto known as Ambalal S/o Girdhari Gurjar residing at Airport Road, 50/1 Ganga Nagar, Kalani Nagar, Indore, Bijasan Road, Madhya Pradesh-452005, presently residing at Ward no 2, charana, rajsamand, rajasthan 313211, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Amra 0071054939-1

I, Taj Ali Mohammad, S/o Abdul Malik R/o H.No-1375, Sector-52A, Wazirabad, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122003, Have changed my name to Md Taj Ali 0040872819-5

I, Nazish Ansari alias Nazish, W/o Mehtab Ahmed R/o H.No.-764, Gali No.-19A, Vijay Park Majupur, Delhi-110053 have changed my name to Nazish Mehtab, for all, future purposes. 0040872821-1

I, Qamreen Qureshi S/o Safdar Islam R/o 7151, Gali Tellyan, Qureshi Nagar, Sadar Bazar, Delhi Changed my name to Qamreen. 0040872823-5

I, MD ASHFAQ AHMAD S/o MOHD Nasruddin R/o 10/12, 3rd Floor, Jogabai Extn., Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025 I have changed my name Mohammad Asfak Ahmad to, MD ASHFAQ AHMAD for all future purposes & legal documents. 0040872714-1

I, SIKHA PAUL Mother of SUMAN PAUL Presently residing in Vill+ PO-JOLAIBARI, (WEST ASHRAMPARA), Tehsil-Jolaibari, Dist-South Tripura, State-Tripura-799141, have changed my name from, SIKHA-PAUL, to, SHIKHA PAL, vide Affidavit, date-17/08/2026. 0040872821-11

I, Surabhi Chadha R/O A-32, Suncity Near Suncity Heights 54, Gurgaon Sector 54 Gurgaon 122011 Haryana I have changed my name to Surabhi Kaushik. 0071054932-1

It is for general information that I, Pradeep Yadav, S/o Rajender Yadav, Residing at 1/5163, Street No.6, Balbir Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, declare the name of mine has been wrongly written as Pradeep in my minor daughter namely Charvi Aged-14 years in her School-Record. The actual name of mine is Pradeep Yadav. Which may be amended accordingly. 0040872848-4

I, kamini kumari, W/O. Ranjeet Kumar Roy, Aged about 47-yrs, R/O-D2/252, Block, Vinod Puri, Vijay Enclave, South West Delhi-110045, state that my name inadvertently spelt in the educational and other documents of my sons (Lokesh Roy and Brijesh Kumar Roy) as Kaminee Kumari in place of Kamini Kumari, therefore, I declare that "Kaminee Kumari" and Kamini Kumari, both are one and same person. 0071054946-1

I, hitherto known as Jayarani W/o Ravichandran residing at E-109, Thangavellu Building, Byarappa House Road, Opp Indirapuram, Nethaji Nagar, Jalahalli Cross, P. Dasarahalli Bangalore North, PO-Dasarahalli Post- Bangalore, Karnataka-560057, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Rani. 0071054946-1

I, JITENDRA SINGH S/o Shri Brahmpal Singh R/o House No.4-L, Pocket-2 (EHS) Mix Housing, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Delhi-110096, have changed my minor daughter's name from INAYA DEDHA to IRAEA DEDHA aged 11 years for all purposes. 0040872820-2

I, DAYANAND S/O LAKHIRAM BHATT R/O HOUSE NO. 3159A, HOUSING BOARD COLONY, SECTOR-3, BALLABGARH, FARIDABAD-121004 (H.R.) HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM DAYANAND TO DAYANAND BHATT FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071054884-1

I, SANJAY NAGPAL, S/o J C Nagpal, R/o K-8/15, 4th-Floor DLF Phase-2, Near Central Arcade Gurugram Haryana-122008, have changed my name to SANJAY KUMAR NAGPAL 0040872823-2

I, Mohd Arfin S/o Qutub uddin, 1013, Gali Rajan, Farash Khana North Delhi, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to Mohd Arfeen. 0040872821-7

I, Shivam Vashisht S/o Vinod Kumar R/o 1218 C-135 Royal Height Society Raj Compound Colony, Gali Number 18, Lal Kuan, Ghaziabad, Dundaheera, Uttar Pradesh 201009, have changed my name to Shivaam Vashishit 0071054936-1

I, HIMANSHU MALHOTRA F/O DHWANI MALHOTRA R/O WZ-91.3RD.FLOOR NIMRI VILLAGE SHASTRI NAGAR DELHI-110052 HAVE CHANGED MY DAUGHTER NAME TO DHAANYA 0040872848-1

I, HIMANSHU VARISHA W/o Shafiuallah Khan, A-11, SF, Khajoori Road, Jogabai Extn., Jamia Nagar, Delhi-25, have changed my name to MOHSIN WRISHA 0071054971-1

I, RAVINDER JAIN, S/O SURENDER JAIN R/O H.NO. 606 CHHBILL DASS COLONY UKLANA-MANDI UKLANA (113) HISAR HARYANA-125113. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAVINDER GOYAL. 0040872819-4

I, Mona Das D/o Late Bharat Lal Das, resident of G-429, First Avenue, Gaur City-1, Greater Noida West, Greater Noida, have changed my name from Mona Das to Mona Ghosh. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Mona Ghosh for all future purposes. 0071054896-1

I, VEENA KHANNA, wife of, Lt. Mr. PRADUMAN KUMAR KHANNA, aged 74 years, residing at, PL-26, F-MAURYA ENCLAVE, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034, have changed, my name from VEENA-KUMARI KHANNA to VEENA KHANNA, I shall henceforth be known as VEENA KHANNA, for all purposes 0040872823-4

I, Sagar Kataria S/o Sudesh Kataria R/o House No.-8/Village-Sihi, Post-Sikanderpur, Gurugram (Haryana), have changed my name to Sagar 0040872819-2

I, SUPREET SINGH, S/O HARJEET SINGH PANDEY, R/O FLAT NO-1/2, BANYAN ROAD, SHIPRA SUNCITY PHASE-2, INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH 201014 have changed my name to SUPREET SINGH PANDEY for all purposes. 0040872819-13

I, Ex. No-908992HL-Hav Shakeel Ahmed Shah, S/O-Mohd Anwar Shah, R/O- Kachhama, Tehsil-Kralpora, District-Kupwara. In my service records names and D o B of my daughter's has been wrongly mentioned as Safiea Shakeel, 15-09-2007, Rafia shakeel, 22-07-2009 instead of Safiya Shakeel, 16-08-2010, Rafiya Jaan, 19-10-2011 as mentioned in education certificates. It needs corrections. Objections be filed to Unit 3rd JAKLI within seven days. 0020518435-1

I, LALA BISHNU SUDARSHAN DEY, son of Late Prashanta Kumar Dey and Late Bijoya Dey, of 8/9 Gulmohar Road, Shipra Suncity, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, hereby declare that the names LALA BISHNU SUDARSHAN DEY, BISHNU SUDARSHAN DEY, Dr. L B S DEY, appearing in various documents/records, refer to one and the same person. Lala Bishnu Sudarshan Dey shall be my correct and official name for all purposes hereafter. This declaration is being published for the information of the general public and all concerned authorities. 0040872726-1

I, TAJINDER PALL S/o Amar Nath Taneja, R/o 132-A, Eastern Side Portion, Third Floor, Arjun Nagar, Safdarjung Enclave, Delhi-110029, have changed my name to TAJINDER PAL permanently 0040872821-9

I, Gaurav Kumar S/o Kanti Prasad R/o C45, Pocket-1, Kendria Vihar-2, Sec-82, Noida have changed my name to Gaurav Singh. 0071054929-1

I, DEEPAK JAIN S/O GAUTAM KUMAR JAIN R/O D-12/G BACK SIDE MODEL TOWN-II DELHI-110009, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO DEEPAK KUMAR JAIN 0040872848-3

I, SURENDRA SINGH S/o Shri Chand Yadav, 53, SF, Priya Darshani Vihar-2, New Gupta Nagar, Delhi-09 have changed my name to SURENDRA SINGH YADAV. 0071054973-1

I, Vikram Mehla age-46-yrs, S/o Raghubir Singh, F/O-Vanshika Mehla, R/o House, No.149/4, sector-1, Pushp Vihar, near M.B.School, New Delhi-110017, have changed name of his daughter from Lisa to Vanshika Mehla 0040872819-6

I, Raj Kumar, S/o Lt. Ram Saroop R/o 7348/179, Lane No.1, Prem Nagar, Shakti Nagar, Delhi-110007, Changed my name to Raj Kumar Gupta. 0040872821-2

I, Mohd Gulzar Qureshi S/o Anwar Ahmed R/o 7426, Gali Chhoti Masjid, Qureshi Nagar, Sadar Bazar, Delhi-110007, have changed my name to Gulzar Ahmed. 0040872823-6

I, Sirajul Siddiqui S/o Mohammad Suleman R/o-812, Gali-6, Rahul Garden, Bahaita Hajeepur, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Mohd Sirajul Siddiqui. 0071054961-1

It is for general information That I, Gangawati D/O Suresh R/O B-18/501, Jhuggi Indra Camp, Kalyan Puri, East Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Siya Thakur for all future purposes. 0040867036-1

LOST & FOUND

I, Anand Singh, S/o Anil Kumar Singh, R/o Flat No. 101, Opposite A-223, Dwarka, Sector-8, have lost my MBA Degree bearing Roll No. 1035070009, completed from Gautam Buddh Technical University, Lucknow, in Marketing and Finance. Mobile no. 8076236696 0040872820-4

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
Be it known to all that my Client Sh. Trick Singh S/o Late Sh. Gurbachan Singh, R/o A-32, Near Sheela Mandi, Vishnu Garden, New Delhi-110018, have severed all their relations and connections with their real daughter Mrs. Puneet Kaur and real son Mr. Charanjeet Singh and his wife Mrs. Meera Singh and their son Master Jaari Singh (aged 05 yrs.), they all are residing abroad, have departed and disowned from all their movable & immovable Properties and assets, with immediate effect, due to quarrelsome nature, acting beyond control, disobedient, show disrespect, irresponsible attitude towards my client. Whosoever deals with them in monetary form or in any other nature shall do so at his/her own cost, risk and responsibility. Sd/- Jai Veer Singh, Advocate Ch.No. 215-A, 2nd Floor, Services Indus. Bldg. Dist. Centre, Janak Puri, ND-58

PUBLIC NOTICE
Be it known to all that our Client, Government of Republic of France, through its Embassy in India at 2/50, Shantipath, Chandni Market, New Delhi-110021, have lost certain original/copy(s) of the following i.e., Perpetual Lease Deed dated 13.02.1954, Grt. Deed dated 29.02.1956, Old Building Plan(s) Sanctioned, Supplement Deed dated 19.05.1982, Relinquishment Deed dated 05.02.1996, Substitution Letter dated 05.02.1999 and 28.07.1997, Conveyance Deed dated 20.12.1999, NOCR from Ministry of External Affairs/Income tax authority/ RBI for purchase of immovable property in India, Sale Deed dated 25.01.2002, Latest Building Plan sanction(s) in Occupation/Completion Certificate, Form D pertaining to Freehold Property bearing Ch.No. 68, Block-17, Sector-14, New Delhi-110003. If found, please contact us at 92505-57345. AMAC LAW OFFICES LLP

PUBLIC NOTICE
My clients **Siddharth Parakh S/o Rajeev Parakh, and Smt. Neha Parakh W/o Siddharth Parakh** R/o H.No. F-183 Upper Ground Floor, Mangal Bazar, Near Geeta Bal Bharti School Laxmi Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, PO Laxmi Nagar, Distt. East Delhi Delhi-110092 have severed relations and debarred their Daughter **Tanisha Parakh** from all the movable & immovable properties due to their misconduct, my clients shall not be responsible for their act(s) in the future.

MOHIT BHARDWAJ
Advocate
Ch.No. G-513, Karkardooma Courts
Shahdara Delhi-110032
Mob.: 9811070701

PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform to general public that my clients **Sh. Rajeev Singh S/o Sh. Gyan Singh and Babila Chauhan w/o Sh. Rajeev Singh** R/o Sehgal Farms, Village Ananapur, Faridabad, have disowned their son namely **Sh. Rohan Chauhan** and his wife **Anjali Prasad** from all their movable & immovable assets and both my clients have severed all their relations from the said **Shri Rohan Chauhan** and his wife **Anjali Prasad**, henceforth any individual dealing with them would do so at his/her own risk and consequences and my above said clients shall not be liable for any of their acts/deeds.

Shiv Kumar Kohli (Advocate)
Ch. No.660, Saket Courts New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that the original property documents (GPA, Agreement to Sell, Affidavit, Receipt, Possession Letter, and With Deed) under E-Stamp Certificate No. DL62432501754159L (Dated 13/09/2013), execute between Sagar Sharma and Arma Khatoon) for property B-50/1, Top Floor, Gali No. 5, Mandawali Unchepar, Delhi-110092 were lost on 15/08/2026 between residence and local market. Finder/anyone with information please contact Parashuram S/o Shri Ramnath at 9015391474 or at B-50/1, Gali No. 5, Mandawali Unchepar, Delhi-110092.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that our client is negotiating for the purchase of Property No. A-88, Gaurav Nishi Sushil Arora S/o Late Shri Oni Parkash, Anna. Any person having any right, title, interest, claim, charge or objection in respect of the said property is hereby required to inform the said client by writing to the undersigned within 10 days from the publication of this notice along with supporting documents. Failing which, it shall be presumed that no such claim exists and our client shall proceed with the proposed transaction without any further reference to such claim.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Be it known to all concerned that my client Mr. Anant Palash, S/o Late Sh. Surjit, R/o H. No. 06, Khara No. 4/24, Vankim Baski, Khamrudan Nagar, PO. Nangal, District West Delhi, Delhi-110041, has severed all relations and connections with his sons, namely Sh. Sandeep Kumar and Sh. Sajjan Kumar, and their wives, Smt. Manisha and Smt. Sandhya respectively, who are residing separately. My client hereby disowns and debars the aforesaid persons from all his movable and immovable properties, assets and affairs and shall not be responsible or liable for any acts, deeds, transactions, omissions, liabilities or dealings undertaken by them hereafter. Any person dealing with the aforesaid persons shall do so at his/her own risk, cost and consequences, and my client shall not be liable for the same in any manner whatsoever.
S. K. SINGHAL (Advocate) Ch. No. 711, Lawyer's Chamber Black, Rohini Court, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE
It is notified that "Mark Veaneay DeSouza" and "Mark Veaneay DeSouza" are one and the same person. S/o Manuel Xavier DeSouza and Mary Benedict DeSouza, residing at D-10, Flat No. 7, Kaveri Apartment, Dilshad Colony, Delhi – 110095. "Veaneay" in Passport, Aadhar Card, and Marriage Certificate is a typographical error. He shall henceforth be known as Mark Veaneay DeSouza, as per his Birth and Baptism Certificates, for all official purposes.

PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform to the general public that my clients **Shri Harish Chander Kaushik**, son of the late **Shri Ja Kishan Kaushik**, and his wife **Smt. Aadesh Kaushik** (wife of **Shri Harish Chander**), residents of 1516, Navada Bazar, Gali Sahb Singh, Ram Mandir, Najafgarh, West Delhi, Delhi-110043, has severed all their relation with their son **Mr. Rahul Kaushik** and his wife **Mrs. Sheela** and disowned/debarred them from their all movable and immovable property/asset with immediate effect due to their disrespectful behavior and other activities and being out of my clients control. If anybody deals with them in any manner shall be doing so at his/her own risk, cost and consequences. My clients shall not be held liable or responsible for the same in any manner whatsoever.

PUBLIC NOTICE
All concerned are hereby informed through this Public Notice that my client **Sh. Subhash Chand S/o Late Charan Singh** R/o H.No.103, Street No.8, Dabar Enclave, Ravita, More, Jaffarpur Kalan, New Delhi-110073 has disowned and debarred his daughter namely **Sheetal Rani** (Divorce). Presently residing with me at the above given address from all my movable and immovable property and cancelled all my relations with her as the above said daughter is totally out of my control and used to harass and torture me continuously. My client shall not be held responsible for any of her acts, deed and things in whatsoever in any manner and if anyone deals with her in any manner whatsoever, shall be deal as per his/her own risk, cost and consequences.

J.S. DAGAR (ADVOCATE)
Off.: 624, Ground Floor, Studio Apartments, Dwarka, Sector-16B, New Delhi-110078

PUBLIC NOTICE
It is for the information of all general public that my clients **Mrs. Veena Kamboj S/o Sh. Aqun Singh and Sh. Aqun Singh S/o Sh. Heera Singh**, both residents of D-836, JJ Colony, Tripi, New Delhi -110062 have severed all kind of relationship with her son namely **Sh. Suraj Singh** and daughter in law **Smt. Vidushi Nigam** (W/o Sh. Suraj Singh) being disrespectful, disobedient, non-cooperative with their son **Sh. Suraj Singh** and daughter-in-law **Smt. Vidushi Nigam** with immediate effect. My clients have followed of wishes and cultural values followed by my clients. Their acts are intolerable behavior, my clients have severed all relations-social, familial, and emotional with their son **Sh. Suraj Singh** and daughter-in-law **Smt. Vidushi Nigam** with immediate effect. My clients have disowned **Sh. Suraj Singh** and **Smt. Vidushi Nigam** from all their movable and immovable properties, including ancestral, residents of 1516, Navada Bazar, Gali Sahb Singh, Ram Mandir, Najafgarh, West Delhi, Delhi-110043, has severed all their relation with their son **Mr. Rahul Kaushik** and his wife **Mrs. Sheela** and disowned/debarred them from their all movable and immovable property/asset with immediate effect due to their disrespectful behavior and other activities and being out of my clients control. If anybody deals with them in any manner shall be doing so at his/her own risk, cost and consequences. My clients shall not be held liable or responsible for the same in any manner whatsoever.

AMIT KUMAR (ADVOCATE)
Off.: 624, Ground Floor, Studio Apartments, Dwarka, Sector-16B, New Delhi-110078

PUBLIC NOTICE
All concerned are hereby informed through this Public Notice that my client **Sh. Subhash Chand S/o Late Charan Singh** R/o H.No.103, Street No.8, Dabar Enclave, Ravita, More, Jaffarpur Kalan, New Delhi-110073 has disowned and debarred his daughter namely **Sheetal Rani** (Divorce). Presently residing with me at the above given address from all my movable and immovable property and cancelled all my relations with her as the above said daughter is totally out of my control and used to harass and torture me continuously. My client shall not be held responsible for any of her acts, deed and things in whatsoever in any manner and if anyone deals with her in any manner whatsoever, shall be deal as per his/her own risk, cost and consequences.

J.S. DAGAR (ADVOCATE)

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Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N. C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.
Tender No. ELG-12-A08-2026-27, Name of work with its location & Completion Period : Agra Division:-
Electrification work in connection with Raising of 02 nos. platform to high level for recoupment of shortfall in Minimum Essential Amenities (MEA) at DMSR and JTKN halt stations under BHA-UDMR section. **Completion period : 08 months. Approx. Cost of the work : Rs. 1087364.08, * For full details and submission of bid please see the**

CROSSWORD

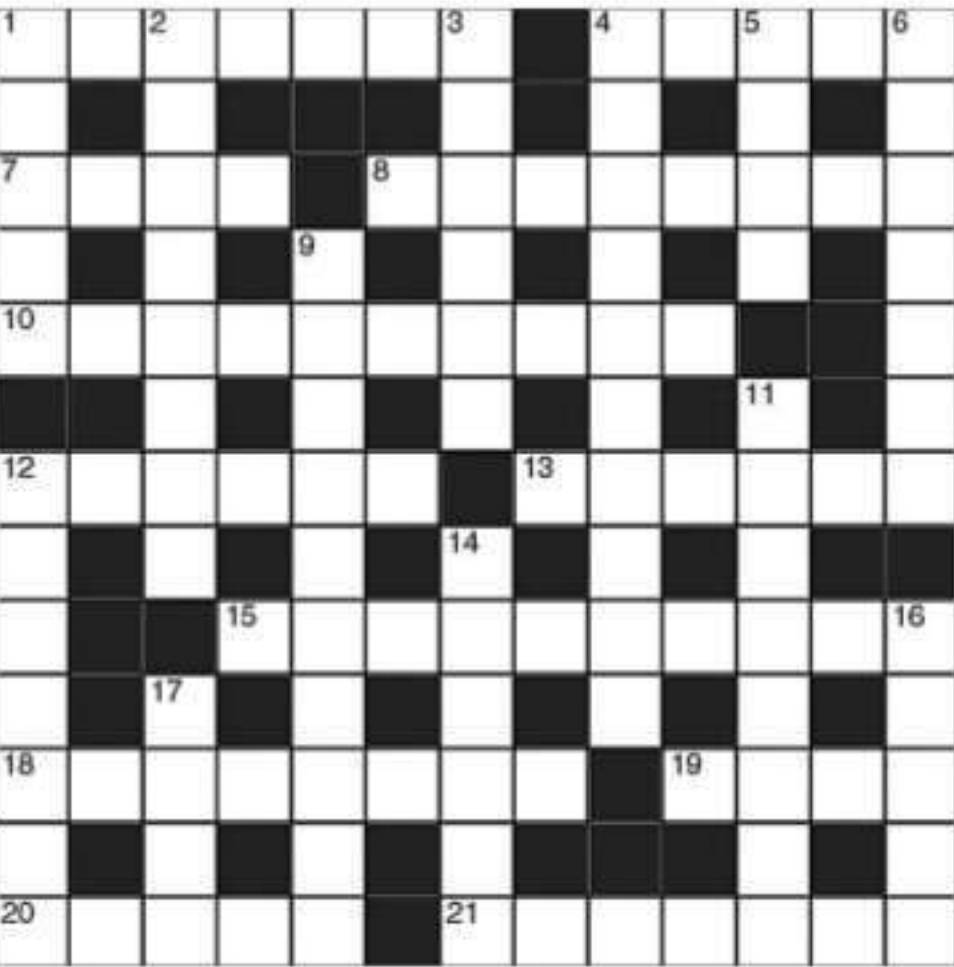
6070

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS



ACROSS
1 Get out of a tight situation (5,2)
4 Dreams about inspiring women (5)
7 Out-and-out row (4)
8 They will keep on watch in the ship (8)
10 One without a car needs a trip out (10)
12 Spot the dog is in free from danger (6)
13 Fashion design made one's name (6)
15 Conjuring appears a fashionable career (10)
18 Story of the underground (8)
19 Wager about a pound (4)
20 One out of bed seen going upstairs (5)
21 I sorted out the ones with views (7)

DOWN
1 A bit of a dust-up (5)
2 Monk who founded an order on Scottish mountain (8)
3 Depart agitatedly. It may explode! (6)
4 Chalice man spilt unthinking (10)
5 Looks up and down (4)
6 We object during pay out to hold up (7)
9 Moon starrer? Perhaps (10)
11 To her Ian may appear as a charmless character (4-4)
12 The usual object of retirement (7)
14 Cat goes under piano in spring (6)
16 Records some music (5)
17 Gives us directions for Customs? (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6069 ACROSS: 1 Crystal ball, 9 Inbred, 10 Range, 11 Tank, 12 Try again, 14 Napkin, 16 Anodes, 18 Tiresome, 19 Solo, 22 Orion, 23 Auditor, 24 Close season **DOWN:** 2 Robin, 3 Stem, 4 Adders, 5 Bargains, 6 Lanyard, 7 Distinction, 8 Tennis court, 13 Dissents, 15 Partial, 17 Smears, 20 Outdo, 21 Idea

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

_____ is not being emotional, but being able to express emotion - Kate Reid (6)

AGTAI HOOSYC

EKONT BEILOG

SOLUTIONS: Tagia, Token, Choosy, Oblige

ANSWER: Acting is not being emotional, but being able to express emotion - Kate Reid

CALVIN & HOBBS



BY BILL WATTERSON

MARVIN



BY TOM ARMSTRONG

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6414

9	7	4		8	5			
		6	3					
3		5		2		7	1	
		9		8		5	6	4
			9	3				
8	6	1		4	2			
5	9		6		4			8
					9	3		
4	2			7	9		6	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6413

3	5	1	4	9	7	6	2	8
2	6	8	5	1	3	7	4	9
9	4	7	8	2	6	1	3	5
8	3	4	1	6	5	9	7	2
1	2	5	7	4	9	3	8	6
7	9	6	2	3	8	4	5	1
5	1	9	3	7	2	8	6	4
6	8	3	9	5	4	2	1	7
4	7	2	6	8	1	5	9	3

CORPORATE BRIEFS



EIL celebrated India's 80th Independence Day with patriotic fervour at Engineers India Bhawan, New Delhi, and its Gurugram office. C&MD Atul Gupta hoisted the National Flag in the presence of directors, senior officials, employees and their families. Addressing the gathering, Gupta highlighted EIL's commitment to indigenous technology, PM Gati Shakti, green economy and engineering excellence. He outlined the company's five-pillar strategy of business growth, operational excellence, technical innovation, digital transformation and human excellence, aligned with the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. He also stressed employee health, fitness and wellbeing.

GAIL CMD Deepak Gupta hoisted the National Flag at the company's Corporate Office in New Delhi on Independence Day, in the presence of directors, senior officials, employees and their families. The gathering joined in singing Vande Mataram, commemorating its 150th anniversary, followed by the National Anthem. Addressing employees, Gupta highlighted GAIL's role in nation-building and underscored energy as the foundation of economic growth. He said GAIL's diversified LNG portfolio is strengthening India's energy resilience amid changing global dynamics and geopolitical challenges, adding that wherever energy reaches, development follows.



PNB organised a Walkathon under the "Har Ghar Tiranga Yatra" campaign to celebrate the 80th Independence Day to commemorate 150th anniversary of "Vande Mataram". The initiative was inspired by the Har Ghar Tiranga campaign by GOI, which aims to bring the Indian National Flag closer to the hearts of India citizens while paying tribute to the national song that has inspired generations of freedom fighters. The walkathon was led by ED M Paramasivam, ED Amit Kumar Srivastava, Chief Vigilance Officer, Raghvendra Kumar, and other senior officials. Speaking on the occasion, M Paramasivam, ED, PNB said: "As we mark 80 years of India's independence, this year holds special significance as we also commemorate 150 years of "Vande Mataram", song that stirred the soul of a nation and gave voice to the sacrifices of countless freedom fighters. Through this PNB "Har Ghar Tiranga Yatra", we pay homage to that enduring spirit of patriotism and unity.

NHPC celebrated India's 80th Independence Day at its Faridabad headquarters, with CMD Bhupendra Gupta hoisting the National Flag after a group rendition of the National Song, followed by the National Anthem. Addressing employees, Gupta highlighted NHPC's role in advancing energy security and self-reliance through clean power. He cited the commissioning of 1,000 MW of the 2,000 MW Subansiri Lower Hydroelectric Project and progress on the Dibang Multipurpose Project. He said hydropower will remain NHPC's core strength, while pumped storage, solar and wind will drive future growth. Gupta also stressed safety, quality, integrity and community welfare. Calling employees the company's greatest strength, he urged young recruits to contribute fresh ideas and promote greater use of Artificial Intelligence, digital technologies and innovation.



NBCC celebrated the 80th Independence Day at NBCC Bhawan, New Delhi, reaffirming its commitment to nation-building and Viksit Bharat 2047. CMD Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy highlighted landmark initiatives including the Amrapali projects, East Kidwai Nagar redevelopment, New Moti Bagh & World Trade Center, New Delhi. He urged employees to embrace innovation, technology and new-age solutions. The celebrations featured the National Flag hoisting, National Anthem and National Song. An employee-led cultural programme also unveiled the Official NBCC Anthem, alongside felicitation of competition winners and its writers and singers.



DM OFFICE, EAST DISTRICT On the occasion of 80th Independence Day, a grand Har Ghar Tiranga rally was organised at the District Magistrate (DM) Office, East District, with the joint collaboration of the District Magistrate Office, East District, and the Department of Women and Child Development (WCD), East District. The rally was led by Worthy District Magistrate, East District, Karanjit Vadodaria, along with the ADM, SDM & Tehsildar, Sadhana Singh, District Officer, WCD, East District. The event reflected the collective commitment of the District Administration and the Department of Women & Child Development towards promoting the values of national integration, unity and pride in the nation.

BSNL extends its warm greetings and best wishes to its customers, citizens, business partners, associates and employees on Independence Day. As India's trusted public sector telecom provider, BSNL remains committed to reliable, secure, affordable and inclusive digital connectivity, including in challenging geographical and climatic conditions. Guided by the vision of Atmanirbhar Bharat and Digital India, the company is building a resilient, future-ready network powered by indigenous technologies and customer-focused innovations. As part of its Independence Day initiatives, BSNL is introducing new customer-centric offerings to enhance digital services and improve access to advanced connectivity and entertainment. The company has ordered over 26,300 additional 4G BTS sites nationwide, expanding coverage across towns, villages and remote areas. Its 4G network has also been comprehensively optimised for improved coverage, speeds, call quality and customer experience.



DFCCIL celebrated the 80th Independence Day at its Noida Corporate Office, with MD Praveen Kumar as Chief Guest. The programme paid tribute to freedom fighters and featured a rendition of Vande Mataram. DFCCIL launched a Track Recording Car, OHE Recording Car and Bridge Inspection Vehicle to strengthen infrastructure monitoring and support predictive maintenance, improving safety, reliability and efficiency across the freight corridor network. The occasion also saw the release of updated publications and unveiling of a commemorative postal stamp marking completion of the entire Dedicated Freight Corridor network. The initiatives reflect DFCCIL's continued commitment to modernising railway infrastructure through advanced technology and improved monitoring systems. The celebrations highlighted DFCCIL's contribution towards building a safer, more reliable and efficient freight transportation network. The event also reinforced the organisation's focus on innovation and excellence in freight rail infrastructure.

HUDCO organised a Har Ghar Tiranga celebration as part of the nationwide campaign from August 9 to 17, 2026. Union Minister for Housing and Power, Manohar Lal, inaugurated the campaign kiosk in the presence of HUDCO CMD Sanjay Kulshrestha, IHC Director Prof K G Suresh, TERI DGI Dr Vibha Dhawan, officials, representatives and schoolchildren. The Minister urged citizens to proudly hoist the National Flag and described the Tiranga as a symbol of India's freedom, unity, identity and collective aspirations. He emphasised that the campaign provides an opportunity for citizens, institutions and communities to come together in expressing their respect for the National Flag and the values it represents. The celebration also aimed to inspire young citizens and encourage greater awareness of India's national heritage and democratic values. HUDCO will distribute over 5,000 National Flags through its IHC kiosk and regional offices nationwide, encouraging wider public participation in the campaign. The initiative seeks to strengthen the spirit of patriotism and collective participation across communities. It also reflects the shared commitment of institutions and citizens towards celebrating the nation with pride and unity.



welfare and road safety through community initiatives across India.

PNB celebrated India's 80th Independence Day at its Dwarka headquarters under the theme "Yuva Shakti for Viksit Bharat@2047", also commemorating 150 years of Vande Mataram. MD & CEO Ashok Chandra hoisted the National Flag and paid tribute to Lala Lajpat Rai, one of PNB's founders. Highlighting India's rapid economic transformation, Chandra said PNB, with over 10,000 branches, one lakh employees and 18 crore customers, is positioned to support the nation's development journey. He outlined priorities including technology-led banking, digital lending, AI, GenAI, quantum technology, financial inclusion and cyber resilience. PNB also disbursed ₹8.6 crore in scholarships to over 21,000 meritorious female students from SC/ST communities. The bank further supported education, child

GALLE TEST, DAY 3

India’s day: Early breakthroughs, resistance in middle, handy lead

Visitors held up by Dinusha-Dickwella century stand before ensuring they hold all aces

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 17

DAY THREE, generally considered the moving day in a Test, didn't exactly move the way India wanted. After they ended with 462 in their first innings, the Galle weather was kind to them, ensuring no time was lost. And when a collective effort from their attack reduced Sri Lanka to 90/5 by the 27th over, the visitors smelled a big opening. Bowl out the opposition quickly and enforce the follow-on, giving ample time to their bowlers to force a win. Instead, all-rounder Sonal Dinusha's maiden Test century and Niroshan Dickwella's 80 extricated Sri Lanka out of the hole, taking the team to 484 before being dismissed, ensuring India would have to bat again. With scattered thunderstorms predicted for the next two days, and the pitch on the slower side, India would need to play exceptional cricket to take a series lead.

Having taken stumps at 460/9 on Sunday, India's innings lasted only four more balls. So they didn't lose the advantage of letting their seamers make the most of the morning conditions. Thanks to the sweating under the covers, there was a bit of movement early on to go with the breeze. And immediately giving India the breakthrough was Mohammed Siraj, who made Nishan Fernando edge one to the cordon, where Devdutt Padikkal took a sharp catch. But the seamers didn't cause much trouble thereafter, and Shubman Gill turned to Manav Suthar, who struck with his first delivery, removing Dinesh Chandimal. Then Lahiru Udara gifted the spinner his second wicket before Kuldeep Yadav



Ravindra Jadeja (second from left) celebrating one of his three wickets with teammates. CREIMAS

and Ravindra Jadeja removed Kamindu Mendis and Dhana-
jaya de Silva respectively. Mendis was undone by the dip going with a drive, with Gill plucking a one-handed catch inches off the turf. De Silva was caught by KL Rahul, who ensured he stayed low at slip and got his fingers underneath the ball as it all began to unravel quickly for the home team.

Fightback

The challenge began only after half the side was sent back to the pavilion. As soon as Dickwella got in, he chose to go on the offence, with his sweep shots in particular upsetting the Indian spinners. Ahead of the Test, Dickwella's inclusion had become a big talking point, with questions raised over his career record (batting average 30.97, 21 50s and no centuries). Many asked why did the selectors go back to a 33-year-old who played his last Test in 2023. But more than the batting, Sri Lanka claimed it was Dickwella's glove work that brought him into the XI. With Dinusha cutting out risk and playing deliveries on

merit, Dickwella cut loose as and when he intended. At most times, it was the sweep shot he fell back on as the safest and most effective option. Mostly sweeping deliveries in the 3m range, he would either play them square or in front of square depending on the line.

Dinusha, on the other hand, mostly preferred slog-sweeps and reverse-sweeps, but the bulk of his runs came in singles and twos as he had only four boundaries and two sixes to show in his knock of 100, before being trapped in front by Jadeja. Despite having three tweakers, India would have wished to have an off-spinner in the XI. Kuldeep took the ball away from the left-hander, but being the slowest, and deliveries not getting enough venom off the pitch, both left-handers had no problem in making him toil. The liberal use of the sweep resulted in Kuldeep not hitting the right lengths. That he had no maiden to show and went at 4.64 runs an over was a telling statistic. He couldn't build much pressure. But it wasn't all doom for the wrist-spinner. When he attacked the line of the stumps, he posed questions.

Left is right

Jadeja and Suthar were relentless, but contrasting in their approach. Suthar was slower, while Jadeja who picked up his 350th Test wicket on Monday, did what he knows best - keeping it tight at all times. But Dickwella and Dinusha used his angle to their advantage. The 146-run stand for the sixth wicket looked set to be a bigger one. Once the Kookaburra went soft, the Indian spinners struggled for purchase and even the Galle strip was unusually docile. Maybe the presence of dead grass meant it didn't break as much as one expected, but it is known to be notorious from Day 4. So India would hope the spinners have a bigger role to play as it would encourage their attack. Once Prasidh Krishnare-moved Dickwella for 80, Sri Lanka's innings didn't move at a rapid pace. Although Dinusha did well to hold on to an end and coast to his maiden century, once the monopoly of the left-handers was broken, the spinners again came into play. With a 178-run lead on board, India would like it to

Scorecard

SRI LANKA vs INDIA
GALLE
TOSS: India won, chose to bat
INDIA (O/N 460-9)
Kuldeep Yadav not out 13 (14b, 2x4)
Prasidh Krishna c Dickwella b AM Fernando 2 (7b)
● **EXTRAS** (b 4, lb 3, w 1, nb 4) 12
● **TOTAL** (116.4 Overs) 462 all out
● **FOW:** 47-1 (Yashasvi Jaiswal, 10.6 ov), 236-2 (Shubman Gill, 61.5 ov), 307-3 (Rishabh Pant, 80.4 ov), 319-4 (KL Rahul, 84.1 ov), 357-5 (Devdutt Padikkal, 91.3 ov), 377-6 (Ravindra Jadeja, 98.1 ov), 432-7 (Dhruv Jurel, 109.1 ov), 447-8 (Mohammed Siraj, 112.6 ov), 447-9 (Manav Suthar, 113.1 ov), 462-10 (Prasidh Krishna, 116.4 ov)
● **BOWLING:** Asitha Fernando 17-4-1-63-2; Lahiru Kumara 13-1-76-0; Keshara Nuwantha 39-1-175-3; Prabath Jayasuriya 39-6-109-4; Dhananjaya de Silva 4-0-15-0; Sonal Dinusha 4-0-17-0

SRI LANKA

Nishan Fernando c Padikkal b Siraj 0 (2b)
Lahiru Udara c Jaiswal b Suthar 27 (44b, 6x4)
Dinesh Chandimal c Pant b Suthar 4 (16b)
Kamindu Mendis c Shubman Gill b Kuldeep 14 (25b, 1x4, 1x6)
Dhananjaya de Silva c Rahul b Jadeja 21 (41b, 4x4)
Sonal Dinusha lbw Jadeja 100 (168b, 1x4, 2x6)
Niroshan Dickwella c Pant b Prasidh 80 (115b, 7x4)
Keshara Nuwantha c Gill b Jadeja 2 (18b)
Prabath Jayasuriya c Jurel b Suthar 10 (43b, 2x4)
Lahiru Kumara st Pant b Suthar 10 (5b, 1x4, 1x6)
Asitha Fernando not out 0 (5b)
● **EXTRAS** (b 8, lb 2, w 2, nb 4) 16
● **TOTAL** (73.8 Overs) 284 all out
● **FOW:** 0-1 (Nishan Madushka, 0.2 ov), 27-2 (Dinesh Chandimal, 7.1 ov), 53-3 (Lahiru Udara, 13.5 ov), 59-4 (Kamindu Mendis, 16.1 ov), 90-5 (Dhananjaya de Silva, 26.1 ov), 236-6 (Niroshan Dickwella, 61.4 ov), 243-7 (Keshara Nuwantha, 66.4 ov), 274-8 (Prabath Jayasuriya, 77.5 ov), 274-9 (Sonal Dinusha, 78.1 ov), 284-10 (Lahiru Kumara, 79.4 ov)
● **BOWLING:** Mohammed Siraj 9-3-29-1; Prasidh Krishna 14-0-47-1; Manav Suthar 21-4-1-76-4; Kuldeep Yadav 14-0-65-1; Ravindra Jadeja 21-5-57-3

swell to 350 in quick time, thereby giving their attack enough time to bowl the hosts out, weather gods permitting.



Henry Croft (C) celebrates England's third goal against India in Amsterdam. HOCKEY INDIA

Fulton’s India pay price for defensive approach, go down 2-4 to England

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 17

IT WAS a classic case of need versus choice. At the Paris Olympics, India had little choice but to retreat deep into their own half against Great Britain. Down to nine players for 43 minutes, it was survival. Against England at the World Cup, with 11 players on the field and a lead to protect, the same approach was a choice. Craig Fulton's men stationed themselves deep in their own half, occupying only about 40 per cent of the field. They stayed compact, bent so low that their knuckles brushed the surface and sticks kissed the turf, and seemed happy to send England into wider areas.

It was the strategy that earned them a famous win two summers ago. On Monday at the World Cup, it might just have handed them a costly defeat. The immediate consequence of the 4-2 loss in Amsterdam is that India must now beat Pakistan on Wednesday to ensure themselves a place in the second round. They haven't lost to their neighbours in a decade. But pressure and Pakistan are capable of unpredictable things. If India do get the result they need on Wednesday and advance, the impact of missing out on the three points they could have carried forward in the race for the semifinals could still be felt.

Initial high press India did not start with the low block. Instead, they were the initiators in the opening exchanges and controlled proceedings. They were adventurous enough to commit numbers forward and press high even after England started to find their footing. That approach also left them vulnerable.

In the 13th minute, England turned defence into attack in the blink of an eye. India believed they had forced their opponents into a corner, but a lofted ball from the back, travelling almost half the length of

Pool D

	P	W	D	L	GD	Pts
England	2	2	0	0	5	6
India	2	1	0	1	0	3
Wales	2	0	1	1	-2	1
Pakistan	2	0	1	1	-3	1

India must now beat Pakistan to ensure themselves a place in the second round

the field, was beautifully controlled by Stuart Rushmere. Harmanpreet Singh and Amit Rohidas were in the vicinity, but the rules prevented them from infringing on his space until the ball was fully under the attacker's control. Rushmere, who displayed remarkable deftness throughout the game, needed only a couple of touches to slide the ball towards Nicholas Bandurak inside the Indian circle. Bandurak was unmarked and, even though Sumit desperately tried to recover, the England forward calmly slotted the ball past goalkeeper Mohith HS. The goal injected a sense of urgency into India, who responded immediately after the quarter break. Harmanpreet led the comeback. Venturing forward from the left flank, he unleashed a powerful reverse hit that caught the foot of Ben Fox and earned India a penalty corner. The captain then finished the move he had started, sending a fierce drag-flick into the top-right corner and giving James Mazarelo no chance. India found their stride and, in the 24th minute, took the lead. The move started with what appeared to be an inconsequential pass from Abhishek Nain to Hardik Singh to restart play on the left. Hardik beat an England defender to enter the circle before finding Abhishek near the baseline. His drilled cross evaded both an outstretched Mazarelo and a backtracking defender before reaching Dilpreet Singh at the far post for a simple finish. India had found the balance

between defensive discipline and attacking intent. They disappeared into the dressing room with the lead, a greater share of possession and more shots on goal. When they returned for the second half, they appeared to abandon their attacking ethos altogether and retreat into an ultra-defensive shape. England cash in It gave England, who had looked uncomfortable whenever India drove forward, far more time on the ball. India maintained their compact shape impressively, forcing England to constantly search for new ways through. They alternated between aerial balls and sharp, low crosses from the wings while repeatedly switching flanks in search of openings. But the trade-off was relentless pressure. Eventually, England's persistence paid off, and India's lead disappeared in the space of four minutes. Rushmere smartly deflected a low cross to beat Mohith in the 38th minute and level the scores. Four minutes later, he was involved again, controlling another high ball before pushing it into the circle for Henry Croft, whose fierce shot on the turn beat the stranded Indian goalkeeper. India tried to change things in the fourth quarter, pressing high straight from the restart, but it was too little, too late. In their search for an equaliser, they left gaps at the back, and Bandurak punished them again in the 54th minute. India looked their most dangerous when they attacked. They lost control the moment they stopped trying to. RESULTS: England 4 bt India 2; Wales 3 drew with Pakistan 3

Suthar a throwback to Indian spinners of 1970s, 80s: Siva

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 17

LAXMAN SIVARAMAKRISHNAN understands the hype and excitement around left-arm spinner Manav Suthar, who had figures of 4 for 76 from 21.4 overs as Sri Lanka were bowled out for 284 in the first innings, on Day 3 at Galle. "He is a throwback to old school, the Indian spinner one got to witness in the 1970s and 1980s," he tells *The Indian Express*. While much of the focus on Suthar has been on his release position, where the seam is angled perfectly toward first slip, the ball dipping and drifting before it reaches the batsman, Sivaramakrishnan says there is plenty more in the spinner that makes him complete. From the time Suthar burst onto the domestic circuit, he has been earmarked as the one to



Manav Suthar picked up four Sri Lankan wickets on Day 3. CREIMAS

carry India's spin legacy forward. In his brief Test career so far, the 24-year-old has shown plenty of promise to live up to that. On Day 3 at Galle, he struck with his first delivery, removing the experienced Dinesh Chandimal with a ball that angled in, made the batsman play, then spun just enough to take his glove on the way to Rishabh

You watch him just before he releases the ball. There is a rockback catapult, which you don't see in spinners these days"

LAXMAN SIVARAMAKRISHNAN,
FORMER INDIA LEGSPINNER ON MANAV SUTHAR'S ACTION.

Pant. Through the day, he kept posing questions to the hosts. While the seam position has remained the talking point, according to Sivaramakrishnan it's what happens before that which makes Suthar special. "You watch him just before he releases the ball. There is a rockback catapult, which you don't see in spinners these days. You

saw it with Bishan Singh Bedi, Erapalli Prasanna and S Venkataraghavan, but these days spinners don't do it because they rush through with their stride," Sivaramakrishnan says. Having taken to coaching in Chennai and Bengaluru, Sivaramakrishnan knows Suthar is a rarity. There are plenty of left-arm spinners on the domestic circuit, but few have caught the eye like Suthar. "He mostly bowls with a pronounced seam, but when he slips in the scrambled seam, he creates doubts into batsmen's minds," the ex-India spinner says. At Galle, across the last 10 Tests, the average turn on offer on Day 3 has been 4.23 degrees. Suthar, despite being a finger spinner, was getting 6. "His delivery stride is short, which means he has got the right balance, and the ideal hip drive that allows wonderful transfer of

weight from back leg to front leg," Sivaramakrishnan says. A year ago, when Suthar arrived at BCCI's Centre of Excellence, something was off in his bowling. With a long delivery stride, he was struggling with control and balance, which kept him out of the Duleep Trophy and three matches for India A. It took him only three sessions to get the delivery stride and release point right. "Suthar's deliveries are arriving from above the eyeline of the batsman. It is classic old school," Sivaramakrishnan explains. Once Suthar releases the ball, the rest of the story unravels. "Since his seam is pronounced, he will get turn, and because of the release point, there is extra bounce. He bowls on one leg, and the balance is perfect. When there is sync between back leg and front leg, you are in control of the line and length," he adds.



Navneet Kaur was India's standout player in their 2-2 draw with China in the Women's World Cup on Sunday. HOCKEY INDIA

dian hockey's greatest talent factories, producing over 80 internationals and eight Indian captains, including Rani Rampal. Navneet grew up watching two other former captains, Ritu Rani and Surinder Kaur, train under him. Before she was one

of his students, she was an observer. "He was very strict about discipline and demanded complete focus during training. Otherwise, you'd have to run laps of the ground," Navneet said. "If he saw potential in a player, he would pay extra attention. But he was never biased. All he wanted was to create opportunities for girls through hockey." Baldev had spotted the spark in her, and by 2013, Navneet was seen as one of India's brightest young prospects, even featuring in the bronze medal-winning team at the Junior World Cup. But her early years in senior hockey were far from straightforward. Although she made her debut in 2014, Navneet had only 16 appearances till 2017, when she started consistently featuring in the squad. Since then, she

has played 196 times and scored 95 goals. The uncertainty of being in and out of the squad forced Navneet to rethink her game. "I realised I had to play with more smartness and understand tactics. In India, players have skills, but in today's hockey, you have to understand the game and know how to play," she said. Fitness became equally important. "Without fitness, the tactics you're learning are not useful. So I think I've focused the most on the smartness of hockey." That intelligence is reflected in the way she plays. Unlike forwards who wait inside the circle for opportunities to arrive, Navneet prefers to create them herself. She likes receiving the ball while on the move, taking on defenders and accelerating into spaces before disappearing. China couldn't

contain that unpredictability. Quiet performer Navneet was among the team's best players at the Asia Cup, followed by an outstanding performance at the World Cup qualifiers in Hyderabad, where she was named Player of the Tournament, and during the triumphant FIH Nations Cup campaign in June. Yet, despite crossing 200 international appearances and playing a key role in India's run to the Tokyo Olympics semifinals, she has rarely sought the spotlight. She has kept showing up. And on a day when India needed a gritty show to begin their World Cup campaign, it was fitting that Navneet — the girl who grew up in a cricket-loving household but couldn't escape the pull of hockey — was the one leading the way.

● FORGED IN SHAHBAD'S HOCKEY NURSERY

Making of Navneet: From a cricket-loving home to India’s World Cup spark

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 17

IF NAVNEET Kaur had grown up anywhere other than Shahbad, she might never have become a hockey player. Cricket dominated her home. Her father was an avid follower of the sport, and one of her earliest sporting idols was India's captain, Harmanpreet Kaur. But growing up in Shahbad — the small Haryana town that has produced an assembly line of international hockey players — made a different future almost inevitable. Baldev's influence In Shahbad, hockey isn't a sport children discover. It's the sport that finds them. "My father wanted me to play cricket; he likes the sport a lot. But where I grew up in

Shahbad, everyone played hockey. I thought, 'Okay, there's no cricket here, but if you want to go into sports, then try hockey,'" Navneet told *The Indian Express* from Amsterdam. She had another, more compelling reason: coach Baldev Singh, who was conferred the Padma Shri this year. "He has created many excellent international players. So that's why I started playing hockey," she said. On Sunday at the Women's Hockey World Cup, the 30-year-old reminded everyone why both Shahbad and Baldev continue to shape some of India's finest players. With India holding Olympic silver medallists China to a 2-2 draw in their Pool D opener, ending a run of four straight defeats against the Asian heavyweights, the experienced forward produced a performance

that was as influential as it was energetic. She scored, created openings, led the press and constantly forced China onto the back foot. A few times, she even tracked all the way back into India's half to win possession and relieve the pressure on her defenders. India needed all of that. And they will need more of it over the next four days, with matches against South Africa and England set to determine whether they progress. When she first walked onto a hockey field, Navneet had little idea what a World Cup even was. "I went to the ground just looking for an opportunity to play. I had no idea I'd end up playing here... or even get selected," she said. That journey began under Baldev, the man who transformed Shahbad into one of In-

BWF WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Ayush keeps the big hits coming

In beating the defending champ Shi Yuqi in the first round of Worlds, he has shown himself to be one for the bright lights

Shivani Naik
New Delhi, August 17

THE RUNNING joke in Bengaluru among his training group of sparrers and coaches was that Ayush Shetty would check into the Delhi hotel for the Badminton World Championships and scotch-tape a poster on the long mirror. '17th August will be a very bad day for Shi Yuqi', the scrawled graffiti was to say.

The 21-year-old badminton star from Mangaluru almost didn't see the manifestation play out when the Chinese defending champ and World No.1 dragged out his own end to a tantalising score of 21-14, 13-21, 21-19. But August 17 did end up as a wretched day for contemporary badminton's most complete shuttle, the elegant Yuqi. Every step of his first-round exit was serenaded and sweated by an adoring crowd that watched the 6-ft-4 Indian soar at the Indira Gandhi arena, with a smash that took out the fancied Chinese.

Yuqi joined Lee Chong Wei in 2017 and Viktor Axelsen in 2021 in the ignominy of a first-round exit by a top name, though Ayush, ranked No.22, is way past being dubbed an upstart.

"I'm feeling great, it's a really special win and I'm super happy with the way I played today," Ayush said. "I knew it would be a really tough match and I really had to work very hard. I was mentally prepared, physically as well."

The signs were evident on Saturday when Yuqi refused to talk to the Indian media, choosing a \$5000 fine instead. He had refused to speak to the Chinese press pack too. In training, the Chinese coaches stood on wooden crates to mimic the steep Ayush smash that comes from eight feet high. But nothing could prepare the rhythmic shuttle for the cacophony of an aggressive Ayush and the throbbing Indian fortress. The reigning champion has had mental blocks against double Olympic champ Axelsen. There's no res-

pite in sight though, as the similarly towering Ayush - like a ghost from the past - starts whacking at him. The day had started with a hearty breakfast - Ayush's favourite meal. Then Indonesian coach Irwansyah ran him through the tactics - something that was sorely missing at the Asian Championships final. Making the final was great. Yet, the towering shuttle needed a formal coronation

“I was telling myself to calm down because I got nervous. He got close and managed to get back every shuttle. Everything I did, he somehow managed to retrieve it. So I was just telling myself to calm down and be aggressive.”

AYUSH SHETTY
ON SHI YUQI'S MINI-COMEBACK

that tips him to be a massive star of the future. It had to be Delhi. Having skipped lunch, Ayush chomped into Yuqi for his end meal.

Coach Sagar Chopda recalls the discussion before Ayush stepped onto the court. "Ayush asked Irwansyah what the court drift was like, because he was sitting for the Sindhu match before that," he said. Once that was clear, Ayush went about using the floaty lifts and clears that muddled Yuqi's ability to connect smashes as the winds did their trick. Delhi was pressing its home advantage. "The tricky thing about drift is it messes with the timing of shots. That's what Sindhu and Ayush were told - to find the timing and feel on the shots," coach Vimal Kumar explained.

Yuqi looked visibly tentative when both receiving and send-

ing out the lobbed lifts.

Too close for comfort

The final game was Ayush's wicked gift to Delhi. He led 17-6 before he panicked, rushed and made a hash of the advantage.

"I was telling myself to calm down because I got nervous. He got close and managed to get back every shuttle," the Indian said. "Everything I did, he somehow managed to retrieve it. So I was just telling myself to calm down and be aggressive."

As five match points whittled down to 1, Delhi's partisan crowd shored up the nervy youngster. "I was super happy at how the crowd was standing up in the end in the stands cheering for me," he acknowledged.

Ayush was exhausted towards the end which explains the errors. Yuqi had read his cross-court pushes and was waiting for them.

That was when the Indian pulled out a stroke he reserves for clutch. A forehand cross-flick, brought out judiciously for the last point to push Yuqi away from the net. Not only was he aggressive in his attack as he took IG Stadium on a roller-coaster, he also took a leaf out of Lakshya Sen's defence and was ready for the opponent's push onto his body. He was told to be wary of the side drift and at the endgame, to stop looking for cheap points. "One good rally," his coaching bench kept repeating. A country that's been accustomed to Sindhu and Satwiksairaj's big smashes now has another glorious big booming hit to follow. Delhi will never forget the day Ayush made August 17 miserable for the Chinese stalwart. The No.1 it might be but it's still only Round 1 for Ayush.

"I'm focusing on the next opponent at this point. Everyone is super tough and I have to be at my best on all days. I'm feeling great today. But I want to keep my head down. I'm happy with the win today. I did well. But I want to go much further," he added.



Ayush Shetty defeated Chinese World No. 1 Shi Yuqi 21-14, 13-21, 21-19 on Day 1 of the BWF Badminton World Championships in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

How a tactical lift brought Chinese giant to his knees



Shi Yuqi struggled to read the shuttle trajectory from one side of the IG arena in the opening game of his 1st round loss. PTI

Shivani Naik
New Delhi, August 17

THE FLICK-LIFT was the bait. World champion Shi Yuqi was beat.

The game was badminton-chess. It ended with the Delhi World Championships finding a sensational premiere show, as unseeded Ayush Shetty took out Shi Yuqi. India has a new boom-box to belt out bangers. The win though came from a lilting lift.

The Chinese World No.1, the defending World champion, arguably the most complete shuttle in men's singles currently, is known to problem-solve through all riddles. Ayush's big booming smash that originates from a height of eight feet wasn't even a cryptic puzzle. It was watermarked on this India-China Round 1 contest the moment the draw threw up an unseeded, dangerous opponent in the Chinese champ's path. The 64" Indian was expected to rain down steep scorchers from nose-bleeding altitude. What the Chinese might not have expected was for the Indian to flip the axis. He had rich, deep, screaming smashes alright. It sent Mexican waves of goosebumps through the watching galleries at the Indira Gandhi stadium. But more than the smashes, Ayush had the tactical, tricky, tingling lifts.

Chinese lured

The bait of a shot that launches the shuttle into an inviting hitting orbit, beckoning Yuqi to slam it down, was tantalisingly elusive that the Chinese was lured into belting it down, but the high lift denied him the sweet-spot to strike it deep. Or even cross the net striking it against the wind. The pressure was bound to build when Yuqi's smashes got stifled. "Lifting really worked well," Ayush said. Coach Sagar Chopda explained how opponents tended to push Ayush to backhand back corner followed with a cross. The lifts and clears upturned the pressure on Yuqi instead. "It was just about popping the shuttle high. But he pulled it off well," he said.

It was a riveting contest because Ayush had been decimated in the Asian Championship final when exhaustion and incoherent strategy ended matters in a whimper. The high lift was the first course-correction. It pushed the world-beating Chinese to the edge. Forcing Yuqi to lift was the prologue to the plan. 3-0 up means little against a shuttler as formidable as Yuqi. But it was in going to 4-1 that the weak Yuqi lift was smothered into the

ground with the first of Ayush howitzers. Reading conditions of shuttle trajectory from one side at IG was something Yuqi struggled considerably with.

It also led to a spate of errors at the net where Yuqi's backhand control tends to be impeccable. He logged at least half a dozen such mistakes in the opening game.

Mid-game change

The Chinese was forced into Plan B as early as 7-3 in the first. He increased the pace mid-rally trying to swamp Ayush. But the Indian was up to the task. Not only did he get onboard the flat, fast exchange, he ended with a regal cross-court smash kill that left Yuqi on one knee.

The Ayush floaters to the backline kept coming and teasing the Chinese and his judgment on the lines. Just to probe his defence ain't shabby at all, the Indian dove around plenty before inducing a Yuqi error at 9-4. The Indian reached 11-5, with yet another tactical lift, followed by a return that evaded an outstretched forehand. It was a recurring theme to get to 16-9.

Yuqi was struggling to digest that both his control-play, the sort the Chinese rely on, with emphasis on rhythm, and his chaos in increasing the rally pace were really not troubling Ayush. If anything, the Indian replied in kind. When Yuqi's midcourt lift was punished giving Ayush the opening game, the crowd sensed the new Shetty on the block was onto something. The 21-14 scoreline was impressive. Before the sides switched, Yuqi did most of the talking rather than the coach-flailing his racquet-wielding hand. He pulled the second back 21-13. But the decider promised to be a humdinger.

One knew Ayush had arrived when the passage from 17-7 up to 18-14 had Indian fans jumping and wincing at his errors and exhaling with cheers as he edged closer to the 21-point mark. Yuqi threw everything he had in his consistency repertoire at double clip in the closing stages. The rushed pace almost did Ayush in as the score reached 20-19. The man has a penchant for drama. A medical timeout, tangled toes, a sitter at the net, Ayush contrived to find a way to drag this to the edge of the cliff.

The final point was neither a steep smash nor a loopy clever lift. It was a tired push - helped in staying in bounds by his tired arm and the wind against him. Winning seemed destiny. A star was born. The Asian Championships final was avenged. The World No.1 was evicted in Round 1. The lift took off sensationally.

Sindhu headlines five wins for India on Worlds Day 1

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, August 17

A BADMINTON World Championships in front of the home crowd is an opportunity not every shuttle gets, and double Olympic medallist PV Sindhu soaked it in with an easy win over Sophia Noble of Ireland. Buoyed by the home crowd, Sindhu won 21-7, 21-11 in a 30-minute match.

"Till yesterday, I was very excited to get on the court. I had butterflies while entering the court today but the crowd cheering and the whole environment gave me goosebumps," Sindhu told the media after the win.

Asked if playing in front of the home crowd added pressure,

she said, "Pressure is everywhere and I think here it is a privilege to play in front of my people."

It was one-sided from the start. The five-time World Championships medallist even experimented with some shots during the match. After winning the first game with ease, Sindhu went to the tougher side and adjusted to the drift and conditions. "Yeah, the opponent pushed me in the second half but I was experimenting with my shots and adjusting to the conditions. So, I tried my drops and smashes," Sindhu said.

Sindhu comes into the tournament on the back of the Japan Open Super 750 title, confidence that will matter with a potential clash against world number



PV Sindhu made light work of Sophia Noble in a 21-7, 21-11 win. PTI

three Wang Zhi Yi of China looming. India's most decorated shuttle at the World Championships, she is eyeing a sixth medal

in the event, and an end to a seven-year wait. Her last medal came at the 2019 edition, when she won the title and became the

first Indian shuttle to do so.

Treesa-Gayatri win

Returning from an injury layoff, the women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand started on a winning note, beating Paula Lopez and Lucia Rodriguez of Spain in straight games, 21-9, 21-13.

The Indian duo are coming back from a long layoff, with Treesa out for more than three months. "It was tough to stay away for 2.5 months from the court, and when we entered the court, it was a thrilling moment for us," Gayatri said after the win.

The other two pairs in contention, Simran Singh and Kavipriya Selvam in women's doubles, and Hariharan Amasu-

karan and Arjun MR in men's doubles, also won their opening games, making it five wins from five for India. Hari and Arjun played early in the day and took time to adjust to the conditions before their opponents, Scott Guilded and Paul Reynolds of Ireland, retired due to a back injury to Guilded. "There was some side drift and that is why the Irish pair started getting their length right. They had to retire unfortunately, but it is a good start for us, and that too in front of the home crowd," Arjun said.

Lakshya Sen and Unnati Hooda will headline the Indian contingent on Day 2. Lakshya faces Collins Valentine Filmon of Austria, and Unnati faces Thet Thar Thuzar of Myanmar.

• NORWEGIAN EFFICIENCY

Mourinho documentary inspired Carlsen to clinical Esports World Cup crown

Mayank Chaudhary
Paris, August 17

DENIS LAZAVIK wasn't too upset with himself when he walked into the content hub for his post-game interactions following his loss in the Esports World Cup final to Magnus Carlsen. After all, there is no shame in losing to the world's best.

The Belarusian teenager was the breakout star of the Paris event, taking down Ian Nepomniachtchi, Nodirbek Abdusattorov, and Hikaru Nakamura on his way to the final. But there, he found a dead end. Carlsen swept past him without dropping a single game, successfully defending his EWC title in clinical fashion.

While Carlsen adding another championship to his long list of accolades should come as no surprise, what stood out most was the efficiency with which he oper-

ated. He steamrolled the field even while battling illness.

Carlsen went unbeaten against a series of elite opponents, which had Andrei Espenkenko, Hans Niemann, Nihal Sarin, Alireza Firouzja, and Lazavik, to cruise to his second straight Esports World Cup title. In many of those matchups, he simply gave his opponents no room to breathe, let alone make progress.

Not the same player

Lazavik observed that Carlsen is not the same player he once was. He no longer enjoys fighting in complex positions; instead, he wants to shut the door and move on. "Like a couple of years ago, he was trying to play more fighting chess, he was enjoying it more. Now I feel he doesn't like to play so much. He just trades everything and he is just way better in the endgame. So he doesn't try to create any complexity for him,"

Lazavik told *The Indian Express*.

Carlsen didn't disagree with Lazavik's observation; rather, he embraced it. The Norwegian explained that his approach in Paris was a deliberate choice, not a sign of fading ambition.

He said, "I started watching the Mourinho documentary on Netflix the other day. They were talking about the first season that they were just winning 1-0 every match. And I was thinking, well, that sounds pretty nice, doesn't it? It's certainly the case that in this tournament I stayed very, very true to not trying to do much."

"I obviously wanted to save energy when I could. There were some boring games because of that, but that's how it is. I don't know if it's a general change, but for this tournament it was a very conscious choice."

Being the face of the Esports World Cup as a global brand ambassador, Carlsen



Magnus Carlsen went unbeaten against elite opponents in his dominant run to win the Esports World Cup title. EWC

had a tonne of commitments towards the event like fan meet-and-greets, press conferences, side events. But he chose to save energy and

didn't oblige to most of them, keeping his game the priority.

Carlsen said, "My main thought leading into this tournament was that I was going to

“My main thought leading into this tournament was that I was going to be a lot more conservative with my choices. Especially considering the match format here.”

MAGNUS CARLSEN
ON CONSERVING ENERGY.

be a lot more conservative with my choices. Especially considering the match format here. Obviously with feeling under the weather as well, following that path became a more obvious choice as well."

His recent performance at Norway Chess had raised questions about his form, his mental

space, and even his future. He lost an unprecedented four games, two of which came against the eventual champion, India's R Praggnanandhaa.

Motivation flux

Carlsen admitted that his motivation fluctuates, but he was firm in his belief that he wasn't going to let a poor showing in Norway define his Paris campaign.

"Norway Chess was an unusual tournament in the sense that I lost the first round in a fair, fighting game against Alireza. It was a bit of trying to catch up after that. And I probably did some things there, played in ways that didn't necessarily optimise my chances. But I kind of wanted to create chances, and I ended up in a lot of positions which I'm not used to. And I got beaten a lot of times. And I made sure not to do the same things here, that's for sure. But

it's hard to compare completely because they're very different formats."

"However, I wasn't going to play poorly here because I played poorly in other tournaments. My motivation comes and goes a little bit at times. But for this one specifically, it's something that I've wanted to do for a long time. I enjoyed last year a lot, and I was always going to do everything in my power to win this one," he added.

Carlsen came to Paris sick, tired, and carrying the weight of expectation. He left with another trophy and the same quiet certainty that no one is catching him anytime soon.

Or as he said, "This is certainly a very big title for me. It's something I've been thinking about for a long time, and I really, really wanted to get this one."

(The writer is in Paris at the invitation of the Esports Foundation)